Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Bengaluru, Karnataka — 560 001

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LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY AND PROCEDURES FRAMEWORK

Segment 1 of 2 — Purpose and Scope · Attendance Framework · Annual Leave · Sick and Medical Leave · Casual Leave · Revision History

Version	3.2	**Effective Date**	01 April 2024
Review Date	31 March 2025	**Classification**	Internal Use Only
Approved By	Mr. Rajesh Arjun	**Document Owner**	Ms. Priya Menon
Legal Review	Mr. Sandeep Iyer	**Department**	Human Resources & Legal
Doc Reference	HR-LAP-001-v3.2	**Applies To**	All Employees, Contractors (where applicable)
Segment	1 of 2 (Pages 1–40)	**Total Segments**	2

This is Segment 1 of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2. It establishes the foundational attendance management framework including working hours, hybrid and flexible arrangements, and time recording obligations, and provides the complete provisions governing the three primary leave entitlements — Annual Leave (Privilege and Earned Leave), Sick and Medical Leave, and Casual Leave — including eligibility, accrual, encashment, and carry-forward rules for each. Segment 2 covers all remaining leave types, public holidays, leave without pay, the leave approval and HRMS administration framework, special situation provisions, compliance and governance, and the full appendices suite. This document must be read alongside the Employee Handbook (HR-POL-001) and the Code of Conduct (HR-COC-001). For queries contact your HR Business Partner or hr@arjuntech.in.

Revision History

The table below records the complete version history of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy since its first publication in April 2009. Every revision has been approved by the Chief Executive Officer and reviewed by the General Counsel and the Vice President of Human Resources before taking effect. The version number and effective date on the cover page are the definitive indicators of currency. Material changes are communicated to all employees by individual email; minor and editorial changes are communicated through the quarterly HR newsletter. The current version is permanently available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents.

Version	Date	Summary of Material Changes	Approved By
1.0	Apr 2009	Initial publication. Annual leave, sick leave, casual leave, and public holiday provisions. Basic attendance requirements for office-based employees.	CEO
1.1	Sep 2010	Maternity leave provisions updated to align with Maternity Benefit Act 1961 as then in force. Paternity leave introduced as a company benefit (not then statutory).	CEO
1.2	Mar 2012	Leave encashment provisions formalised. Carry-forward rules standardised across office locations. Leave Without Pay consequences for employment record clarified.	CEO
1.3	Nov 2013	Annual leave entitlement increased from 18 to 21 days per year. Sick leave entitlement increased from 7 to 12 days per year.	CEO
1.4	Jun 2015	Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017 provisions incorporated ahead of enactment — maternity leave extended to 26 weeks for first two children.	CEO
2.0	Jan 2017	Full rewrite. Hybrid and flexible working leave interactions added. Adoption leave introduced. Bereavement leave provisions substantially expanded. HRMS leave management system provisions added.	CEO
2.1	Aug 2018	Study leave introduced. Sabbatical leave framework introduced for employees with 5+ years of service. Compensatory off provisions formalised.	CEO
2.2	Mar 2020	Pandemic-specific provisions added — COVID sick leave, quarantine leave, and care leave added as temporary provisions. Remote working leave interaction provisions added.	CEO
2.3	Oct 2021	Pandemic-specific provisions converted to permanent policy where appropriate. Mental health leave provisions introduced explicitly. Fertility treatment leave added.	CEO
3.0	Apr 2022	Major revision. Band-differentiated annual leave entitlements introduced. Flexible leave advance provisions expanded. State-specific statutory compliance table updated for all five operating states.	CEO
3.1	Oct 2022	Volunteer leave provisions updated (two days per year formalised). Caregiver leave introduced. HRMS leave module integration guidance updated.	CEO
3.2	Apr 2024	Annual leave accrual rate updated. DPDP Act 2023 references added for health data processed in leave management. Sick leave self-certification threshold revised. State-specific provisions updated for Telangana SE Act amendments.	CEO

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State-specific statutory compliance provisions are embedded within each leave type section rather than collected separately, ensuring that managers and employees can identify the applicable state requirements when reading the relevant section. All leave forms are available on the HRMS portal under HR Services → Leave Management.

1. Message from the Vice President — Human Resources

To every member of the Arjun Technologies team — this Leave and Attendance Policy is not a document about restriction. It is a document about clarity, fairness, and the mutual respect that a healthy employment relationship requires. When the company provides you with leave entitlements — Annual Leave to rest and recover, Sick Leave for when you or your family genuinely needs you, Maternity and Paternity Leave to welcome a child, Bereavement Leave to grieve, Study Leave to invest in your professional future — it does so because it understands that you are a whole person whose life outside work matters and whose capacity for excellent professional work depends on being able to attend fully to the demands of that wider life when it requires it. These are not grudging concessions — they are genuine commitments.

What the policy asks in return is equally simple: use the leave you are entitled to, for the purposes for which it is designed, and within the processes that allow the company to manage operations and support your colleagues. It asks that you apply for leave in advance when you can, that you communicate promptly when you cannot, that you keep your attendance records accurate and honest, and that you engage with your manager and the HR team when a personal health or family situation requires more support than the standard provisions are designed to address. The company's attendance management obligations — the monitoring of patterns, the conversations about persistent unexplained absence, the referral to occupational health where warranted — are not surveillance activities designed to catch people out. They are the mechanisms through which we ensure that every employee receives the support they need and that the attendance expectations the company needs to meet its commitments to clients are maintained fairly and consistently.

This policy has been reviewed and updated for Version 3.2 to reflect the current legal framework, including recent amendments to the state Shops and Establishments Acts in our operating jurisdictions and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 as it affects the handling of employee health data in the leave management process. I encourage you to read it carefully and to contact your HR Business Partner whenever a situation arises that the policy does not seem to address or that requires a more personalised response. This policy cannot anticipate every human circumstance — when it does not, we will apply its spirit and our values to find the right answer. — Ms. Priya Menon, Vice President — Human Resources.

2. Purpose, Scope, and Application

2.1 Purpose of This Policy

The Leave and Attendance Policy of Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. serves three interconnected purposes. Its first purpose is compliance — the policy ensures that the company meets all statutory leave and attendance obligations under the applicable legislation in each state of operation, including the minimum leave entitlements prescribed by law, the specific provisions governing maternity and other protected categories of leave, and the record-keeping obligations that employment law imposes on employers. Compliance is the floor, not the ceiling — the company's leave provisions are in several respects more generous than the statutory minimum, reflecting the commitment to employee wellbeing described in Section 18 of the Performance Management Policy and in the Code of Conduct.

The second purpose is operational clarity — providing every employee and every manager with a single, authoritative, and detailed reference that answers the specific questions that arise in the day-to-day management of leave and attendance. How much annual leave am I entitled to? How far in advance must I apply? How many days of sick leave can I take without a medical certificate? What happens to my accrued annual leave when I resign? Can I carry forward unused casual leave? These questions have specific, documented answers in this policy, and every employee has the right to know those answers and to rely on them. Inconsistent application of leave rules — different answers to the same question depending on which manager is asked — is itself an integrity failure that this policy is designed to prevent.

The third purpose is cultural — establishing the norms of leave usage and attendance management that reflect the kind of employer the company has chosen to be. A company that makes it practically difficult to take earned annual leave, that stigmatises sick leave use, or that manages attendance with punitive rigidity rather than genuine concern for employee wellbeing is not living the values it professes. This policy is designed to make the taking of legitimate leave straightforward, to make the communication of genuine illness easy and free of stigma, and to ensure that the attendance management obligations that operational reliability requires are exercised with proportionality and human awareness.

2.2 Scope — Who This Policy Applies To

This policy applies to all permanent full-time and part-time employees of Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. at all levels of seniority, in all five office locations, effective from their first day of employment. It applies during the probationary period and after confirmation on the same terms, except where a specific provision states otherwise. Fixed-term contract employees are covered by this policy for the full duration of their contract on the same terms as permanent employees, with the exception of the Annual Leave encashment and carry-forward provisions on separation, which are governed by the contract terms where those terms are more specific than this policy.

Contractors and independent consultants are not employees and are not entitled to leave under this policy. Their availability and working arrangements are governed by the terms of their commercial engagement contracts. Where a contractor requires time away from an engagement, this is managed through the engagement manager and the contracting terms — not through the leave management provisions of this policy. The company's obligations in respect of statutory leave for employees engaged through staffing agencies are governed by the Contract Labour (Regulation and Abolition) Act 1970 and the terms of the relevant labour contractor agreement — the HR Business Partner and the Legal team provide guidance on these obligations on a case-by-case basis.

Employees seconded to partner or client organisations retain their leave entitlements under this policy for the duration of the secondment unless the secondment agreement specifically provides otherwise. The host organisation's leave approval processes may apply during the secondment for operational reasons, but the underlying entitlements are governed by this policy and the employee's employment contract with Arjun Technologies. Leave taken during a secondment is recorded in HRMS in the same way as leave taken in a standard role.

2.3 Personal Responsibility to Understand and Use Leave Correctly

Every employee has a personal responsibility to be familiar with their leave entitlements, to apply for leave through the correct process, to record leave accurately in HRMS, and to ensure that the leave they claim is leave to which they are entitled and is claimed for the purpose for which it is designed. Claiming a category of leave for a purpose it is not designed to cover — claiming sick leave for a planned holiday, claiming casual leave for a situation that falls within the maternity or bereavement provisions, or recording attendance on a day when leave should have been claimed — is a violation of the Integrity provisions of the Code of Conduct and of the record-keeping obligations in Section 4.2 of the Code. It is treated as a conduct matter, not merely an administrative irregularity.

Managers carry an additional responsibility: to apply this policy consistently and fairly across their team, to approve legitimate leave promptly and without creating barriers that the policy does not impose, to engage genuinely with employees whose leave patterns or attendance concerns require a supportive management response, and to ensure that the leave records in HRMS for their team accurately reflect the actual leave taken. A manager who systematically discourages their team from taking Annual Leave, who applies informal pressure to employees who take sick leave, or who applies this policy more strictly to some team members than others is not meeting the management standards the company requires.

2.4 Relationship to Statutory Entitlements

The leave entitlements in this policy are, in several respects, more generous than the statutory minimums prescribed by the applicable Shops and Establishments Acts in the company's operating states. Where the company's contractual provision exceeds the statutory minimum, the contractual provision applies. Where the statutory minimum exceeds the company's general provision — which can occur in specific circumstances under specific state legislation — the statutory minimum applies. The Legal team maintains the current statutory comparison table and reviews it annually as part of the policy review process. The state-specific provisions embedded in each section of this policy reflect the current legal position as at April 2024.

Leave Type	Statutory Minimum (General)	Arjun Technologies Provision	Applicable Legislation
Annual / Earned / Privilege Leave	12 days per year (Karnataka, Maharashtra, Delhi). 15 days per year (Telangana, Tamil Nadu) for employees with 240+ days of service	21 days per year (Band 1–4). 24 days per year (Band 5+). Pro-rated for part-time.	Karnataka SE Act 1961; Telangana SE Act 1988; TN SE Act 1947; Maharashtra SE Act 1948; Delhi SE Act 1954
Sick Leave	12 days per year (Karnataka, Telangana, Delhi). Variable in other states.	12 days per year all bands. No carry-forward.	Applicable state SE Acts as above
Casual Leave	12 days per year (Karnataka). Variable in other states.	8 days per year all bands. No carry-forward.	Applicable state SE Acts as above
Maternity Leave	26 weeks for first two children. 12 weeks for third child onwards. 12 weeks for adoption (child under 3 months).	26 weeks (first two children); 12 weeks (third+); 14 weeks (adoption, child under 1 year). Additional provisions in Section 7 of Segment 2.	Maternity Benefit Act 1961 as amended 2017
Paternity Leave	No statutory requirement in India — company benefit only.	10 working days within 90 days of birth or adoption. Section 8 of Segment 2.	Company policy only — no statutory obligation
National and State Public Holidays	Variable by state — approximately 14–17 days per year across operating states.	National holidays (3) + state holidays per office location. Published annually. Section 12 of Segment 2.	Negotiable Instruments Act for national holidays; state factory/SE Act lists for state holidays

3. Attendance Management Framework

3.1 Standard Working Hours — Office and Hybrid Model

The standard working week at Arjun Technologies is 45 hours, spread across five days from Monday to Friday. Standard daily hours are nine hours including a one-hour unpaid lunch break, giving eight paid working hours per day. The standard working day runs from 09:30 to 18:30, with the one-hour lunch break taken between 13:00 and 14:30 at the employee's discretion within that window. These are the reference working hours against which attendance, overtime, and leave are calculated. They are not a rigid template that prohibits any variation — the flexible start/end provisions in Section 3.2 allow individual variation within defined parameters — but they are the standard against which the company measures full attendance for a working day.

Arjun Technologies operates a hybrid working model under which permanent employees at Band 1 and above are entitled to work from home for a defined portion of their working week. The standard hybrid model requires a minimum of three days per week in the office for Bands 1 to 4, and a minimum of two days per week for Band 5 and above, with the expectation that Band 5 and above employees use their judgement about when in-person presence creates genuine value rather than following a rigid formula. The office days are not prescribed by this policy — they are agreed between the employee and their manager at the start of each quarter, taking into account team collaboration needs, client commitments, and individual role requirements. Deviations from the agreed pattern require advance notice to the manager.

Band	Minimum Office Days / Week	Remote Days / Week	Core Hours (In-Office and Remote)	Flexibility Provisions
Band 1–2	3 days minimum	Up to 2 days	10:00–16:00 on all working days (office and remote)	Flexible start/end outside core hours. See Section 3.2.
Band 3–4	3 days minimum	Up to 2 days	10:00–16:00 on all working days	Flexible start/end outside core hours. Manager agreement required for sustained deviation from standard hours.
Band 5+	2 days minimum	Up to 3 days	10:00–16:00 on in-office days. Self-managed on remote days.	Band 5+ employees manage their own schedule within the requirement of full daily availability during client and team hours.
Client-site employees	As required by client engagement	As per client and manager agreement	As per client site requirements	Hybrid provisions apply when not on client site. HRBP and manager agree pattern at engagement start.
Part-time employees	Proportionate to contracted hours	Proportionate to contracted hours	Core hours apply on working days — full-day equivalent	Leave and attendance calculated proportionately to contracted hours. See Section 6.3 for part-time casual leave.

3.2 Core Hours and Flexible Start/End Time Provisions

Core hours — the period of the working day during which all employees are expected to be available and responsive, regardless of their start and end time choices — are 10:00 to 16:00 on all working days, both in the office and when working remotely. Within these six hours, employees are expected to be reachable by colleagues and clients through the company's standard communication channels, to attend scheduled meetings, and to be genuinely engaged in professional work. Meetings scheduled during core hours take precedence over other activities. No employee may schedule a personal appointment, an external commitment, or any non-work activity during core hours without their manager's prior agreement and appropriate leave booking.

Outside core hours, employees have flexibility to structure their working day in the way that best suits their productivity and personal obligations, provided that the full standard working hours are completed each day and that the flexibility is not used in a way that reduces the employee's effective availability for colleagues and clients. An employee who consistently begins their working day at 07:30 and finishes at 16:30 is exercising legitimate flexible start/end time. An employee who begins at 10:00 and finishes at 16:00 — totalling six paid hours rather than the required eight — and does not record the shortfall as leave is not exercising flexibility, they are recording inaccurate attendance. The flexible start/end provision is a working pattern option, not a leave provision.

3.3 Attendance Recording — HRMS Obligations and Time Integrity

Every employee is required to record their daily attendance accurately in the HRMS attendance module. For office-based days, attendance is recorded through the HRMS system either via the office access card integration — which automatically captures entry and exit time at the office building — or through manual entry in HRMS where the access card system is not in use. For remote working days, attendance is recorded by marking the working day as Remote in the HRMS attendance module before 09:30 on that day. Leave is recorded in HRMS in advance wherever possible — if leave has been applied for and approved in HRMS, the attendance record is updated automatically. For unplanned sick leave, the employee or their manager marks the day as Sick Leave in HRMS on the day of absence.

The integrity of attendance records is an explicit obligation under the Code of Conduct, Section 4.2 — the same provision that governs the accuracy of timesheets, expense claims, and financial records. An attendance record is a company record. An inaccurate attendance record — whether it overstates attendance to avoid having a leave day deducted, understates remote days to appear more office-present than is the case, or otherwise misrepresents the employee's working pattern — is a falsification of a company record that is treated as a conduct matter, not merely an administrative error. The company does not conduct routine surveillance of employee movements, but HRMS access log data, building entry records, and digital activity patterns may be reviewed in the context of a specific conduct investigation where a concern about attendance accuracy has been raised.

3.4 Punctuality, Unplanned Absence, and Notification Obligations

Punctuality — arriving at work, joining meetings, and commencing productive work at the agreed times — is a basic professional obligation. Occasional lateness due to genuine transport disruption, personal emergency, or other unavoidable circumstances is a normal feature of working life and is not treated as a disciplinary matter. A pattern of habitual lateness — repeated late arrival without adequate reason, particularly where prior conversations have addressed the issue — is an attendance concern addressed through the manager conversation process described in Section 3.5. Lateness of more than 30 minutes on any working day must be notified to the manager before the standard start time if the lateness is anticipated, or as soon as the delay becomes apparent.

For unplanned absence — including unexpected sick leave, personal emergency, or any other reason that prevents the employee from attending as planned — the notification obligation is as follows. The employee must notify their line manager directly (by call or message) before or at the time they would normally be expected to begin work — not by email alone, which may not be seen until the manager arrives at their own workstation. Where the employee is unable to notify the manager personally due to the nature of the absence (for example, hospitalisation), a family member or the employee's emergency contact person may notify on their behalf. Notification to a colleague who then passes the message informally to the manager does not satisfy this obligation — the notification must reach the manager directly. Following the initial notification, the employee must update HRMS with the nature of the absence (sick leave or other relevant leave type) on the same day where possible, or on return if same-day HRMS access is not available.

Absence Type	Notification Timeline	Method	HRMS Update	Consequence of Non-Notification
Unplanned sick leave	Before or at normal start time on day of absence	Direct call or message to line manager — not email alone	Same day where possible. Manager may update HRMS on employee's behalf.	Absence may be treated as unauthorised absence (LWOP) until notification provided. Repeated non-notification is a conduct issue.

Absence Type	Notification Timeline	Method	HRMS Update	Consequence of Non-Notification
Anticipated lateness (>30 min)	Before normal start time, or as soon as delay becomes known	Direct message to manager	Not required unless full day absence results	Conduct note for repeated unexplained lateness.
Emergency absence — full day	As soon as practically possible — same day	Call or message to manager; emergency contact may notify on employee's behalf	By end of day or on return	Absence treated as LWOP if no notification received by end of day.
Multi-day unplanned absence	Daily notification required — unless medical incapacity prevents it, in which case family member or emergency contact notifies	Call or message to manager each day, or confirmation that absence will continue	Updated daily by manager or employee	Failure to maintain daily communication for multi-day absence may trigger a welfare check and potential referral to occupational health.

3.5 Attendance Management — Manager Obligations and Escalation

Managers are responsible for actively monitoring the attendance of their direct reports and for engaging proactively — and with genuine care — when patterns emerge that may indicate a concern. The purpose of attendance management is not to create a punitive environment in which employees fear taking sick leave or feel surveilled in their daily work — it is to ensure that absence patterns that may indicate an underlying health, wellbeing, or personal situation are identified early and addressed supportively, before they escalate into more significant performance or conduct concerns. A manager who ignores persistent absence patterns and waits until the annual performance review to address them has not served the employee well.

The Bradford Factor is one tool that the HRMS system makes available to managers as an indicator of attendance patterns that may warrant attention. The Bradford Factor measures the frequency of short-duration absences — weighting multiple short absences more heavily than a single extended absence of the same total duration, on the basis that frequent short absences are a stronger indicator of potential attendance concern than a single extended illness. The HRMS dashboard shows each employee's Bradford Factor score on a rolling 12-month basis. Managers are alerted when an employee's score crosses a defined threshold, triggering the escalation framework below. The Bradford Factor is an indicator, not a verdict — it identifies patterns that warrant a supportive management conversation, not an automatic disciplinary trigger.

Bradford Factor Score	Attendance Pattern it Indicates	Required Manager Action	HRBP Involvement
Below 51	Normal attendance — no pattern of concern	No action required. Standard management.	None required.
51–100	Emerging pattern — moderate frequency of short absences	Informal supportive check-in conversation. Manager notes the conversation in HRMS (private note). No formal action.	Manager may consult HRBP informally. Not mandatory.
101–200	Developing concern — frequent short absences	Formal welfare discussion — documented in HRMS. Explore underlying causes. Offer EAP referral if appropriate. Set informal attendance expectation.	HRBP notified. HRBP advises on appropriate support approach.
201–400	Significant concern — high frequency of short absence	Formal attendance review meeting — HR present. Documented improvement plan with agreed attendance target. Occupational health referral if health concern indicated. Possible reasonable adjustment discussion.	HRBP-led. HR present at review meeting. Documented outcome.

Bradford Factor Score	Attendance Pattern it Indicates	Required Manager Action	HRBP Involvement
Above 400	Persistent significant concern	Formal attendance management plan under HR oversight. Potential disciplinary consideration if no medical explanation and no improvement after supported plan.	VP-HR aware. Legal review before any formal disciplinary action.

3.6 State-Specific Working Hours Compliance

The working hours and attendance provisions in this policy are designed to comply with the applicable Shops and Establishments Act in each state of operation. The following table summarises the key state-specific provisions as at April 2024. Where a state provision is more restrictive than the general company provision, the state provision applies to employees working in that state. Where the company provision is more generous, the company provision applies. The Legal team monitors legislative developments in each state and updates this table as required.

State	Office Location(s)	Max Working Hours / Day	Max Working Hours / Week	Mandatory Rest Interval	Overtime Provision
Karnataka	Bengaluru (HQ)	9 hours	48 hours	Minimum 30 min rest after 5 hours continuous work	Overtime at 2x rate after 48 hours / week. Prior written consent and Inspector notification required.
Telangana	Hyderabad	9 hours	48 hours	Minimum 30 min rest after 5 hours continuous work	Overtime at 2x rate. Monthly overtime cap: 50 hours. Quarterly cap: 150 hours.
Tamil Nadu	Chennai	8.5 hours	45 hours	Minimum 30 min rest after 5 hours	Overtime at 2x rate. Monthly cap: 48 hours. Quarterly cap: 144 hours.
Maharashtra	Mumbai / Pune	9 hours	48 hours	Minimum 30 min rest after 5 hours	Overtime at 2x rate. Maharashtra SE Act 2017 applies.
Delhi NCR	Gurugram / Noida	9 hours	48 hours	Minimum 30 min rest after 5 hours	Overtime at 2x rate under Delhi SE Act 1954.

The company does not routinely require employees to work overtime and does not operate a culture of uncompensated extended hours. Where an employee is asked to work beyond standard hours on a specific occasion due to a genuine operational requirement, the manager must authorise the overtime in writing (HRMS HR Note), the employee must be compensated at the applicable statutory overtime rate for the relevant state, and the overtime must be recorded in HRMS. Compensation in time off in lieu (TOIL) may be agreed as an alternative to financial overtime payment, with one hour of TOIL for each hour of overtime worked and to be taken within 30 days of the overtime. TOIL is recorded in HRMS as Compensatory Off — see Section 13 of Segment 2.

4. Annual Leave — Privilege and Earned Leave

4.1 Annual Leave Philosophy and Entitlement by Band

Annual Leave — referred to in Indian employment law as Earned Leave or Privilege Leave — is the primary rest and recuperation entitlement, designed to allow employees to take sustained periods away from work for rest, travel, personal projects, family time, and any other purpose they choose. Annual Leave is not a discretionary benefit that the company extends at its convenience — it is a statutory entitlement that employees earn through service and to which they have a legal right. The company's obligation is not merely to provide the entitlement but to create conditions in which employees can genuinely use it.

A culture in which annual leave accumulates unused — because managers make it practically difficult to take, because employees feel that absence will harm their career or burden their colleagues, or because workloads are consistently set at a level that makes sustained absence impossible — is not acceptable. Managers are assessed on whether their teams take their annual leave entitlements, and persistent under-utilisation of annual leave in a team is a signal of a management problem that the HRBP will address. Employees who consistently carry forward the maximum carry-forward amount without taking leave are encouraged to discuss their circumstances with their manager and HRBP to identify and resolve the barriers to leave-taking.

Band	Annual Leave Entitlement	Equivalent Weeks	Applicable Standard	Notes
Band 1	21 working days per year	4.2 weeks	Company provision (statutory min: 12–15 days)	Pro-rated for part-year joiners. See Section 4.2.
Band 2	21 working days per year	4.2 weeks	Company provision	Pro-rated for part-year joiners.
Band 3	21 working days per year	4.2 weeks	Company provision	Pro-rated for part-year joiners.
Band 4	21 working days per year	4.2 weeks	Company provision	Pro-rated for part-year joiners.
Band 5	24 working days per year	4.8 weeks	Enhanced company provision	Recognises seniority and leadership responsibilities.
Band 6	24 working days per year	4.8 weeks	Enhanced company provision	
Band 7	24 working days per year	4.8 weeks	Enhanced company provision	
Band 8 (Contractual)	As per individual contract — minimum 24 days	Minimum 4.8 weeks	Contractually defined	Contract may provide additional leave. Contract prevails where more generous.
Part-time employees	Pro-rated on contracted hours basis. Band leave × (contracted hours ÷ 45)	Proportionate	Same statutory basis	Minimum part-time leave calculated to equivalent full-day leave days.

4.2 Annual Leave Accrual — Rate, Timing, and Proration

Annual leave accrues on a monthly basis from the first day of employment. The accrual rate for Bands 1 to 4 is 1.75 days per completed calendar month of service (totalling 21 days per full year). For Band 5 and above, the accrual rate is 2.0 days per completed calendar month (totalling 24 days per full year). Accrual is credited to the employee's leave balance in HRMS at the start of each calendar month for the preceding month. An employee who joins on 15 April will accrue their first monthly credit in June (for the completed month of May), meaning their leave balance at the end of April and through May reflects only the days accrued from their joining date, calculated on a daily pro-rata basis from their date of joining.

For new joiners mid-year, the annual leave entitlement for the first partial year is pro-rated based on the number of complete calendar months of service from the joining date to 31 March (the end of the leave year). A Band 3 employee joining on 01 October will accrue 6 months × 1.75 = 10.5 days by 31 March. A Band 5 employee joining on 01

December will accrue 4 months × 2.0 = 8.0 days by 31 March. The leave year at Arjun Technologies runs from 01 April to 31 March, aligned with the financial year. The full annual entitlement is credited at the start of the leave year on 01 April for all confirmed employees who were in employment on 31 March, with the monthly accrual mechanism applying only in the first year of service and in the final year where the employee has resigned or their employment is ending.

Scenario	Band	Joining Date	Pro-Rated Entitlement (to 31 March)	Calculation
New joiner — full year from April	1–4	01 April	21 days	Full year entitlement credited on 01 April
New joiner — October start	1–4	01 October	10.5 days	6 completed months × 1.75 days
New joiner — October start (senior)	5+	01 October	12.0 days	6 completed months × 2.0 days
New joiner — January start	1–4	01 January	5.25 days	3 completed months × 1.75 days
New joiner — January start (senior)	5+	01 January	6.0 days	3 completed months × 2.0 days
Existing employee — full year	1–4	Any (confirmed before 01 April)	21 days	Full entitlement credited on 01 April
Part-time employee (4 days/week)	1–4	Any (confirmed before 01 April)	16.8 days	21 × (36 ÷ 45) = 16.8 days. Rounded to nearest 0.5 day.

4.3 Annual Leave Application, Approval, and Minimum Notice

Annual leave must be applied for in advance through the HRMS leave management system (HRMS → My Leave → Apply for Leave → Annual Leave). The minimum notice required for annual leave applications is linked to the duration of the leave being requested, because longer periods of absence require more planning time to manage workload and client commitments during the employee's absence. Managers are required to respond to leave applications within three working days of receipt — a leave application that has been submitted and not responded to within three working days should be followed up by the employee directly with the manager.

Leave Duration	Minimum Notice Period	Approval Authority	Response Timeline
1–2 days	5 working days in advance	Line manager	Within 2 working days
3–5 days	10 working days in advance	Line manager	Within 3 working days
6–10 days (1–2 weeks)	15 working days in advance	Line manager + HRBP informed	Within 3 working days
11–15 days (2–3 weeks)	20 working days in advance	Line manager + BU Head for Band 5+ employees	Within 5 working days
More than 15 consecutive days	30 working days in advance	Line manager + BU Head + HRBP	Within 5 working days. Operational cover plan required.
Emergency annual leave (compassionate)	As soon as circumstances allow	Line manager — retrospective HRMS entry approved	Retrospective approval within 2 working days of return

Annual leave must not be taken without approval. Leave taken without approval is recorded as Leave Without Pay pending the employee's explanation on return. Where a leave application is declined, the manager must provide a specific operational reason — not a general statement that the timing is inconvenient — and must discuss with the employee an alternative period in which the leave can be taken within a reasonable timeframe (typically within 60 days). A manager who systematically declines annual leave without substantive reason is in breach of the statutory obligation to allow employees to take their earned leave. No employee may be required to forfeit accrued annual leave

because operational pressure was used to prevent them from taking it during the leave year.

4.4 Annual Leave Carry-Forward and Lapse Rules

Unused Annual Leave may be carried forward from one leave year to the next, subject to the carry-forward limits below. The carry-forward limit is set at a level that creates a genuine incentive to take leave regularly rather than accumulating it indefinitely, while preserving flexibility for employees who wish to save leave for a specific purpose (an extended trip, a life event, a planned sabbatical). Leave that exceeds the carry-forward limit at the end of the leave year (31 March) is either encashed at the applicable rate (for employees who have completed three or more years of service — see Section 4.5) or lapses (for employees in their first or second year of service where the encashment eligibility has not yet been met).

Band	Annual Entitlement	Maximum Carry-Forward	Excess Treatment	Maximum Accumulated Balance
Band 1–4	21 days	10 days	Encashed (if 3+ years service) or lapses	31 days (current year + carry-forward)
Band 5+	24 days	12 days	Encashed (if 3+ years service) or lapses	36 days (current year + carry-forward)
First and second year of service (all bands)	Pro-rated	5 days	Lapses — encashment not available until year 3	Pro-rated entitlement + 5 days

4.5 Annual Leave Encashment — Eligibility and Calculation

Annual leave encashment — the conversion of unused accrued leave days into a cash payment — is available to eligible employees in two circumstances. The first is the year-end encashment of leave that exceeds the carry-forward limit, described in Section 4.4. The second is the separation encashment on resignation, termination, or retirement, described in Section 4.6. In both cases, the encashment rate is calculated on the same basis: the daily encashment value is the employee's current monthly basic salary divided by 26 (the number of working days in a standard month, as defined by law for encashment purposes). The total encashment payment is the number of encashed days multiplied by the daily rate, and is paid net of applicable TDS.

Eligibility Criterion	Standard	Notes
Minimum service for year-end encashment	3 completed years of continuous employment on 31 March	Employees in year 1 or year 2: excess leave lapses. No encashment option.
Maximum encashable days (year-end)	Days above carry-forward limit — max 11 days for Band 1–4; max 12 days for Band 5+	Encashment is automatic where eligibility is met — HRMS calculates and Finance processes in April payroll.
Separation encashment — resignation	All accrued and unused annual leave up to the carry-forward maximum plus any current-year accrued leave	Paid in Full and Final Settlement. Not subject to the 3-year service minimum.
Encashment during service (elective)	Not permitted except at the year-end encashment window	Employees may not encash leave during service outside the annual window. Leave must be taken or carried forward.
Encashment rate calculation	Monthly basic salary ÷ 26 = daily rate. Daily rate × encashed days = gross encashment.	Basic salary is the statutory definition — not gross CTC. Finance confirms applicable basic for each employee.
Tax treatment	Encashment during service: fully taxable as salary income. Separation encashment: exempt up to limits under Income Tax Act Section 10(10AA).	Finance team provides TDS calculation. Employee should consult their tax advisor for personal tax position.

4.6 Annual Leave During Notice Period and on Separation

When an employee gives or receives notice of termination of employment, their accrued annual leave balance continues to accrue through the notice period at the standard monthly accrual rate. The use of annual leave during the notice period is subject to mutual agreement between the employee and the company. The company may require the employee to take accrued annual leave during the notice period — reducing the cash settlement due on separation — or may require the employee to work through the full notice period and receive a cash settlement for the leave balance at separation. The employee may not unilaterally take annual leave during the notice period without the company's agreement, because the notice period serves a legitimate operational purpose that the employee's continued availability is expected to fulfil.

On separation — whether through resignation, redundancy, retirement, or any other form of employment ending — the employee is entitled to a cash payment for all accrued and unused annual leave that has not been taken during the notice period, calculated at the daily encashment rate in Section 4.5. This payment is included in the Full and Final Settlement, which is issued within 30 working days of the employee's last day of employment. Where an employee has taken more annual leave than they have accrued at the date of leaving — which is possible where annual leave was taken early in the leave year before the full entitlement had accrued — the excess leave is recoverable from the Full and Final Settlement at the same daily encashment rate.

5. Sick and Medical Leave

5.1 Sick Leave Philosophy — Genuine Support, Not an Entitlement to Exhaust

Sick leave exists for one purpose: to allow employees to take paid time away from work when they are genuinely too ill to work, without the financial pressure of unpaid absence forcing them to come in when doing so would harm their own health and potentially the health of colleagues. This is a genuine commitment of the company, grounded in the understanding that a workforce whose members feel they cannot take sick leave when they are genuinely ill is less productive, not more. Sick leave is not, however, a discretionary extension of annual leave, a mental health day bank to be drawn on whenever work feels stressful, or an entitlement designed to be fully used each year regardless of actual illness.

The company does not automatically assume bad faith when an employee takes sick leave, and the sick leave provisions are designed to make genuine sick leave easy to take. A pattern of sick leave that raises a genuine concern — frequent single-day absences, absences consistently adjacent to weekends or public holidays, a sudden increase in absence following a performance conversation or a disciplinary matter — is a signal that warrants a supportive management conversation, not automatic suspicion. The distinction between a genuine health concern and misuse of sick leave provisions is made through the attendance management process in Section 3.5, not through a blanket presumption of dishonesty applied to every sick leave claim.

5.2 Sick Leave Entitlement, Accrual, and Non-Carry-Forward

Every confirmed employee is entitled to 12 working days of paid sick leave per leave year (01 April to 31 March), regardless of band level. The entitlement is the same for all bands because illness does not discriminate by seniority. Sick leave does not accrue monthly in the same way as annual leave — the full 12-day entitlement is credited to the employee's HRMS sick leave balance on 01 April at the start of each leave year. For new joiners, the sick leave entitlement for the first partial year is pro-rated on the same monthly basis as annual leave: 1.0 day per completed calendar month of service in the first year, credited at the start of the following month.

Band	Annual Sick Leave Entitlement	Carry-Forward	Lapse at Year End	Encashment on Separation
All bands (confirmed)	12 working days per leave year	No carry-forward	Unused balance lapses on 31 March	Not encashable — sick leave is a health protection entitlement, not deferred pay
New joiners — first partial year	1 day per completed calendar month (pro-rated)	No carry-forward	Pro-rated balance lapses at 31 March	Not encashable
Employees on probation	1 day per completed calendar month (pro-rated)	No carry-forward	Balance lapses at 31 March	Not encashable
Part-time employees	12 days (same as full-time) — each sick day deducted on the same basis as a full working day for the employee	No carry-forward	Balance lapses at 31 March	Not encashable

5.3 Notification Obligations for Sick Leave — Timing and Process

The notification obligations for sick leave are as described in Section 3.4 for unplanned absence generally: the employee must notify the line manager directly by call or message before or at the normal start time on the day of absence. For sick leave specifically, the notification should include: the fact of the absence, the expected duration where known, the medical certificate status (whether a certificate will be required based on the self-certification threshold described in Section 5.4), and any urgent work handover instructions the employee wishes to communicate. Where the employee is too unwell to notify personally, a family member may notify on their behalf — the obligation is

that the manager receives timely notice, not that the employee personally makes the call regardless of their condition.

For sick leave absences expected to extend beyond three days, the employee must provide a daily update to the manager by message unless their condition makes this genuinely impossible. Where a daily update is not possible due to the nature of the illness (hospitalisation, severe illness requiring complete rest), the employee's family member or emergency contact should provide updates. A manager who becomes concerned about an employee's welfare during an extended sick leave absence — particularly where communication has ceased and the absence is unexplained — should notify the HRBP, who will manage any welfare check in a supportive and privacy-respecting manner. The company has no right to require a detailed medical report during an illness, but it has a duty of care that includes ensuring the employee is safe.

5.4 Medical Certificate Requirements and the Self-Certification Threshold

The self-certification threshold — the number of consecutive sick days for which no medical certificate is required — is three consecutive working days. An employee who is absent for one, two, or three consecutive working days due to illness is not required to provide a medical certificate on return; their own notification of illness is accepted as sufficient documentation. From the fourth consecutive working day of sick absence, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner is required, covering the period of absence from the first day. The certificate must confirm the nature of the illness (at the level of general category, e.g. 'upper respiratory tract infection' — not the specific diagnosis unless the employee chooses to share it) and confirm that the employee was unfit for work during the certified period.

Duration of Sick Absence	Certificate Required?	Type of Certificate	Submission Timeline
1–3 consecutive working days	No — self-certification applies	None. Employee notifies manager as per Section 3.4.	HRMS sick leave entry on return, or same day where possible.
4–7 consecutive working days	Yes — from day 1 of absence	Medical certificate from registered medical practitioner. Must cover all days from first absence day.	Submitted on return to work or scanned and emailed to HRBP during absence.
8–14 consecutive working days	Yes — and follow-up certificate if absence extends beyond initial certificate	As above. HRBP notified. Long-term sick leave process begins if absence reaches 14 days.	Initial certificate within 5 days of absence start. Extension certificate before initial expires.
15+ consecutive working days	Yes — and company may request independent occupational health assessment	Medical certificate + independent occupational health report where company requests one. Fitness to return certificate required before return.	Ongoing — HRBP manages the long-term sick leave process in Section 5.5.
Recurring short absences (same illness)	Manager discretion — may request certificate from day 1 where pattern warrants	Medical certificate confirming recurring condition.	As requested by manager in advance.

5.5 Extended Illness — Long-Term Sick Leave and Medical Fitness to Work

Where an employee's sick absence extends to or beyond 15 consecutive working days, the HRBP takes over the active management of the leave from the line manager, with the manager remaining informed and involved in a supporting role. Long-term sick leave is managed with the primary objective of supporting the employee's recovery

and safe return to work, not of managing their absence for administrative convenience. The HRBP initiates a structured long-term sick leave process that involves the employee, the manager, and where appropriate an occupational health professional.

During a long-term sick absence, the employee continues to accrue annual leave at the standard monthly rate, as required by Indian employment law — sick absence does not interrupt annual leave accrual. Sick leave days are debited from the 12-day annual entitlement until the entitlement is exhausted. Once the 12-day sick leave entitlement is exhausted, further absence is treated as Leave Without Pay unless the employee applies for and is approved to use accrued annual leave to cover the additional absence. An employee with significant accrued annual leave may bridge a long-term illness using annual leave, with the HRBP's agreement, before reverting to Leave Without Pay. This bridging option is made available as a matter of policy to ensure that employees are not placed in immediate financial hardship at the point their sick leave entitlement is exhausted.

5.6 Sick Leave Patterns and Attendance Management Intervention

The Bradford Factor monitoring described in Section 3.5 applies with particular relevance to sick leave patterns. In addition to the Bradford Factor, the HRMS attendance module flags the following specific sick leave patterns for manager and HRBP awareness. These flags are not automatic disciplinary triggers — they are prompts for a supportive management conversation whose purpose is to understand the underlying cause and to provide appropriate support.

Pattern Flagged	Flag Threshold	Required Manager Action	HRBP Action
Monday/Friday absences	3 occurrences in 12 months where sick leave is taken on a Monday or Friday adjacent to a weekend or public holiday	Supportive welfare check-in conversation. Documented in HRMS.	HRBP notified if pattern continues after conversation.
Post-performance event absences	2 occurrences in 12 months where sick leave is taken within 5 working days of a performance review, disciplinary meeting, or PIP initiation	HRBP-facilitated welfare conversation. Explore whether underlying concern is driving the pattern.	HRBP leads conversation. May refer to EAP.
Exceeding 8 sick days in a year	Cumulative sick leave exceeds 8 days in the leave year (before 12-day limit reached)	Welfare check-in. Discuss whether EAP referral would be helpful. Check for underlying health condition requiring reasonable adjustment.	HRBP informed. May recommend occupational health referral.
Exhausting full 12-day entitlement	12th sick day taken in the leave year	Formal welfare discussion with HRBP present. Long-term sick leave process initiated if ongoing.	HRBP leads. Occupational health referral considered. Reasonable adjustment discussion initiated.
Inconsistent self-certification claims	Pattern of claiming illness without medical support for durations that approach (but do not exceed) the 3-day self-certification threshold	Manager documents pattern. Formal conversation — may require medical certificate from day 1 for future absences.	HRBP advises on whether modified certification requirement is appropriate.

6. Casual Leave

6.1 Casual Leave Purpose and Entitlement

Casual Leave is a short-notice leave entitlement designed for genuinely unanticipated personal needs that arise without sufficient notice to apply for annual leave — a household emergency, a child's unexpected school requirement, a personal administrative necessity, or a similar brief and unforeseeable personal obligation. Casual leave is not intended to supplement annual leave as a general rest entitlement, to extend weekends or holidays on a planned basis, or to cover absences that could and should have been applied for as annual leave with adequate notice. Where an employee knows in advance that they will need a day away from work, annual leave is the appropriate entitlement — the choice to apply for casual leave instead, to avoid the annual leave balance deduction, is an improper use of the casual leave provision.

Every confirmed employee at Arjun Technologies is entitled to 8 working days of casual leave per leave year. The entitlement is the same for all band levels. Casual leave does not accrue monthly — the full 8-day entitlement is available from 01 April. For new joiners, the entitlement for the first partial year is pro-rated at the rate of 0.67 days per completed calendar month of service (giving approximately 8 days for a full year), credited in full at the time of joining for the first month and then on the first day of each subsequent month. Casual leave does not carry forward at the end of the leave year and is not encashable at any point — unused casual leave lapses on 31 March.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Annual entitlement	8 working days per leave year	Same for all bands. Does not change with seniority.
Availability	Full 8 days available from 01 April (confirmed employees). Pro-rated for new joiners (0.67 days/completed month).	New joiner pro-rated days credited at joining and updated monthly.
Maximum per occasion	3 consecutive working days per casual leave instance	Requests for more than 3 consecutive casual days must be applied as annual leave.
Carry-forward	None. Unused casual leave lapses on 31 March.	Employees are encouraged to use casual leave in the year it is credited — it cannot be deferred.
Encashment	Not encashable at any point — during service or on separation	Casual leave is a genuine use-or-lose benefit. No cash value.
Application notice	Minimum 2 hours advance notice where possible. Same-day application accepted for genuine emergencies.	Retrospective casual leave (applied for after the day) accepted only where prior notice was genuinely impossible.
Approval authority	Line manager	Manager cannot unreasonably withhold casual leave for a genuine personal need.

6.2 Casual Leave Application and Approval

Casual leave must be applied for in HRMS as early as possible — ideally before the absence begins, or on the same day where the need arises without advance warning. The HRMS mobile application allows casual leave applications to be submitted from any device, facilitating same-day application even when the employee is not at their workstation. Where the nature of the personal emergency makes even a mobile HRMS application impossible during the day of absence, the employee must apply retrospectively on their return and provide a brief note to the manager explaining the circumstances. Managers should approach retrospective casual leave applications with a presumption of good faith — the absence of a contemporaneous HRMS entry is not itself evidence of improper leave claiming.

The manager's approval of a casual leave application is expected to be prompt — within the same working day for same-day applications, and within two working days for advance applications. The grounds for declining a casual leave application are narrow: a genuine operational emergency that specifically requires the employee's presence that

day and that could not be managed with the employee absent. A declined casual leave application must be accompanied by a specific reason. An employee whose casual leave is declined for a genuine personal emergency should be supported in managing the operational consequence — through delegation, rescheduling, or other coverage — and the manager should explore whether the operational requirement can be met in a way that allows the employee to attend to their personal need.

6.3 Restrictions on Casual Leave Usage

Casual leave may not be taken in conjunction with another leave type in a way that creates a continuous period of absence extending beyond the maximum permitted for casual leave (3 consecutive days). Specifically, casual leave may not be prefixed or suffixed to annual leave, public holidays, or sick leave to create an extended absence that would otherwise require the full notice period for annual leave. Where an employee's absence through a combination of casual leave and an adjacent leave type or public holiday exceeds four days in total, the HRBP reviews the leave record to ensure the correct leave type has been applied.

Restriction	What Is Prohibited	Legitimate Use	HRMS Flag
Prefixing or suffixing to annual leave	Taking 3 days casual leave + 5 days annual leave to create an 8-day block without the 10-day notice for annual leave	Genuine single-day emergency that happens to fall adjacent to planned annual leave — casual leave for the emergency, annual leave for the holiday	Leave calendar review triggered when casual leave abuts approved annual leave
Prefixing or suffixing to public holidays	Using casual leave to bridge a public holiday and create a long weekend on a regular basis	A single genuine personal emergency that happens to fall adjacent to a public holiday	No automatic flag, but manager monitors pattern if it recurs
More than 3 consecutive days	Applying casual leave for 4 or more consecutive days	There is no legitimate 4-day casual leave usage — if 4 or more days are needed, annual leave is the correct entitlement	HRMS blocks casual leave applications of more than 3 consecutive days
Use for planned purposes	Applying casual leave for a known future appointment (dentist, government office visit) that was scheduled well in advance	Use annual leave for planned personal appointments with adequate notice	Manager reviews if casual leave is consistently applied for predictable recurring absences
Exhausting entitlement by mid-year	Using all 8 casual leave days in Q1 and then claiming emergency absences later in the year must be covered by annual leave	Genuine emergencies must use annual leave once casual leave is exhausted	HRMS shows remaining casual leave balance. Manager informed when balance reaches 2 days.

3.7 Remote Working Day Conduct and Availability Standards

A remote working day is a standard working day. The attendance, productivity, and professionalism expectations on a remote day are identical to those on an office day — the difference is location, not standard. An employee working from home is expected to be at their workstation, available on all standard communication channels, attending scheduled meetings on camera as requested, producing the same quality and volume of output as on office days, and completing the full standard working hours. The hybrid working model does not create a de facto part-time arrangement on remote days, and the expectation is not managed differently on remote days than on office days.

The company recognises that the working environment at home is not always identical to the office environment — interruptions from family members, household noise, or internet connectivity issues are genuine features of home working. Employees are expected to manage their home working environment to the extent reasonably practicable to minimise these disruptions during core hours. Where a specific domestic situation — caring for a sick child, a temporary home disruption — creates a genuine inability to work productively from home on a specific day, the employee should notify their manager and either come into the office, apply for leave as appropriate, or agree with their manager how the day's work commitment will be met. Working from home while also providing primary childcare without additional childcare support is not considered an adequate working arrangement during standard working hours and is not supported as a hybrid working pattern.

Situation	Required Action	Leave Implication
Broadband or connectivity failure on remote day	Notify manager immediately. Connect on mobile data where possible for core hours. If productive work is genuinely impossible: move to office or take annual/casual leave for the day.	No leave required where partial productive day is possible. Leave required where total inability to work results.
Child unexpectedly sent home from school on a remote working day	Notify manager. Assess whether work can continue with care arrangements. If child requires full-time care: casual leave for the day or remaining portion of day.	Casual leave where primary care prevents productive work.
Family member illness requiring care on a remote working day	Notify manager. Casual leave or annual leave for the day if care cannot be managed alongside work.	Casual leave or annual leave as appropriate. Repeated caregiver requirements: consider Caregiver Leave in Section 11 of Segment 2.
Equipment failure (laptop, monitor) on remote day	Notify manager. Contact IT for same-day equipment support or replacement. Come into office if equipment failure prevents productive work and IT cannot resolve same day.	No leave required — equipment failure is managed as an IT issue, not an attendance issue, where the employee makes reasonable effort to resolve.
Planned personal appointment during core hours on remote day	Apply for annual leave or casual leave for the period of the appointment. Transparent notification to manager.	Leave required for the period of the appointment, same as if the appointment were during an office day.

3.8 Overtime, Compensatory Off, and TOIL Framework

The company does not encourage or routinely require overtime. A culture in which extended hours are informally expected, normalised, or rewarded with preferential career treatment is inconsistent with the employee wellbeing commitments in the Code of Conduct and the Performance Management Policy. Where the management of routine workload consistently requires overtime to meet commitments, the correct management response is a workload review and resource planning conversation with the HRBP — not normalisation of a working hours expectation that is above the statutory and contractual standard.

Genuine operational overtime — work performed beyond standard hours for a specific, time-limited, and genuinely unavoidable business reason — is managed through the following framework. Pre-authorisation is mandatory: the line manager must authorise the overtime in HRMS before it is worked, or confirm it in HRMS within 24 hours where pre-authorisation was not practicable. The overtime duration and reason must be documented. Compensation is provided either as financial overtime payment at the applicable statutory rate for the relevant state, or as

Compensatory Off (TOIL) at a 1:1 rate to be taken within 30 calendar days. The employee's preference between financial payment and TOIL is considered, subject to the line manager's agreement and operational feasibility.

Overtime Category	Authorisation Required	Compensation	HRMS Recording	State-Specific Rate
Planned overtime — known in advance	Pre-authorisation in HRMS by line manager before overtime worked	Financial payment (2x basic hourly rate) or TOIL 1:1 at employee preference, subject to manager agreement	Overtime recorded in HRMS Attendance → Overtime Log with reason and duration	Karnataka, Telangana, Maharashtra, Delhi: 2x rate. Tamil Nadu: 2x rate. State SE Act rates apply.
Unplanned overtime — arises during the working day	Manager verbal authorisation during the overtime period, confirmed in HRMS within 24 hours	As above — financial or TOIL	HRMS entry within 24 hours by manager or employee	Same statutory rates
Weekend or public holiday work (operational requirement)	Pre-authorisation by line manager and BU Head. HRBP informed.	Full day's pay at overtime rate (2x) for each hour worked, or full TOIL day per worked day, taken within 30 days	HRMS Attendance → Special Working Day entry. Required before payroll processing date.	Same statutory rates plus state-specific public holiday premiums where applicable
Client site work beyond standard hours	Pre-authorisation by account manager and line manager jointly	Financial or TOIL — account manager confirms commercial basis for client-requested overtime where relevant	HRMS + timesheet entry against client project code	Same rates. Finance confirms billing treatment separately from compensation treatment.
On-call duties	Pre-agreed on-call roster approved by line manager	On-call allowance per the On-Call Policy (IT-SEC-POL-007). Activation compensation at overtime rate for hours worked while on-call.	On-call schedule in HRMS. Activation events logged in IT Service Management system and HRMS.	Activation hours at overtime rates. On-call standby allowance per policy.

4.7 Annual Leave Blackout Periods and Restricted Periods

Certain periods of the year are operationally critical for specific business units or client engagements — year-end audit periods for Finance, quarter-end delivery milestones for Engineering teams, and major client launch windows for project teams. Annual leave during these periods may be restricted — not prohibited absolutely, but subject to heightened scrutiny and a presumption that the business need must be assessed carefully before approval. A leave blackout period is a formally declared period during which annual leave applications are deferred or declined unless there are exceptional personal circumstances, and it requires BU Head and HRBP approval to declare.

A leave blackout period may not exceed four weeks in any calendar quarter for any individual employee, and no individual employee may be subject to more than eight weeks of leave blackout restrictions in a full leave year. These limits are designed to ensure that operational constraints do not cumulatively prevent employees from taking their annual leave entitlement. Where a blackout period has prevented an employee from taking planned leave, the manager has an obligation to actively support the rescheduling of that leave within the following 60 days. Leave that lapses because a blackout period prevented its use, and that could not be rescheduled within the same leave year due to further blackout restrictions, is encashed at the standard rate regardless of the employee's service tenure — the lapse is attributable to operational requirements, not to the employee's choice.

Business Unit	Typical Blackout Periods	Basis	Maximum Duration	HRBP Notification Required
Finance	01 March – 15 April (year-end close and audit)	Financial year-end and external audit requirements	6 weeks	VP-Finance notifies VP-HR by 01 February. Published to Finance team by 07 February.

Business Unit	Typical Blackout Periods	Basis	Maximum Duration	HRBP Notification Required
Engineering — product teams	Typically final 2 weeks of each quarter (milestone delivery)	Quarter-end delivery milestones for major product releases	2 weeks per quarter (max 8 weeks per year)	Engineering VP notifies HRBP by first week of each quarter for the following quarter.
Client delivery projects	Project-specific, agreed at project start	Client contract milestone dates and acceptance windows	As per project plan — max 4 weeks per quarter	Account manager notifies HRBP at project kickoff. Employee notified at engagement start.
HR and Payroll	15 March – 15 April (payroll close and policy refresh) and September (mid-year)	Annual payroll and policy cycle requirements	4 weeks for April period; 2 weeks for September	VP-HR self-declares. HR team notified by 01 March.
All business units	None company-wide — no blanket annual blackout applies	Operational blackouts are BU-specific and time-limited	Not applicable for blanket restrictions	Any proposed company-wide restriction requires CEO and VP-HR approval.

4.8 Annual Leave Advance and Negative Balance Provisions

In certain circumstances, the company may permit an employee to take annual leave in advance of having accrued the full balance — that is, to draw on leave that will accrue in future months of the same leave year before that accrual has occurred. Advance leave is not available as a routine entitlement — it is a discretionary facility provided in genuine personal need situations where the employee's accrued balance is insufficient for an approved leave requirement. The maximum advance is limited to the leave that would accrue in the following three months at the standard monthly accrual rate.

Advance annual leave creates a 'negative leave balance' in HRMS, which is gradually replenished by monthly accruals. Where an employee resigns or is separated before the negative balance has been cleared by accrual, the outstanding negative balance is deducted from the Full and Final Settlement at the daily encashment rate. This is a contractual right of the company and is noted in the leave advance approval documentation. Advance leave requires the line manager's approval and the HRBP's written confirmation in HRMS before it is taken. The approval documentation records the advance amount, the reason, and the clawback provision.

Scenario	Advance Permitted?	Maximum Advance	Approval Required	Clawback on Early Separation
Family medical emergency requiring extended travel	Yes — genuine compassionate basis	3 months' accrual (5.25 days for Band 1–4; 6 days for Band 5+)	Line manager + HRBP written approval in HRMS	Outstanding negative balance deducted from FFS at daily encashment rate
Planned family event (wedding, graduation) where balance is insufficient	Manager and HRBP discretion	3 months' accrual	Line manager + HRBP written approval	As above
Extended holiday where accrued balance is insufficient	Discretionary — may be declined if no compelling reason	2 months' accrual maximum	Line manager + HRBP approval	As above
New joiner with insufficient accrual for approved leave in first 3 months	Yes — to enable genuine leave needs in early employment	3 months' accrual from joining date	Line manager + HRBP approval	Full outstanding balance deducted from FFS

Scenario	Advance Permitted?	Maximum Advance	Approval Required	Clawback on Early Separation
Employee on PIP requesting advance annual leave	Not permitted while an active PIP is in progress without HRBP approval	Not applicable	VP-HR approval required if exceptional circumstances exist	As above

5.7 Mental Health, Wellbeing Leave, and EAP Integration

The company recognises that mental health conditions — including depression, anxiety, burnout, and stress-related disorders — are genuine health conditions that may require time away from work in the same way as physical illnesses, and that they are subject to the same stigma-free, non-judgemental approach to sick leave as any other health condition. An employee who is absent from work due to a mental health condition takes sick leave under Section 5 of this policy on the same terms as an employee absent due to a physical illness. The nature of the condition — whether physical or mental — does not affect the leave entitlement, the notification obligation, or the medical certificate requirements. A mental health condition certified by a registered medical practitioner or a clinical psychologist satisfies the certificate requirement in Section 5.4 in the same way as a certificate for a physical condition.

In addition to standard sick leave for mental health conditions, the company provides access to the Employee Assistance Programme, which offers up to six free and confidential counselling sessions per year to every employee and their immediate family members. The EAP is accessible at eap.arjuntech.in or through the 24-hour telephone helpline. EAP usage is completely confidential — the company has no visibility of which employees use the EAP, and EAP usage has no effect on the employee's leave record, performance assessment, or employment status. The EAP is available as a preventive resource — when pressure is building — as well as a crisis resource when a mental health situation has already become acute.

Where a manager becomes aware that an employee is struggling with their mental health — through the employee's own disclosure, through observed changes in behaviour or work quality, or through information shared by a colleague in the employee's interest — the manager's first obligation is a private, compassionate, and genuinely attentive welfare conversation, not an attendance management conversation. The EAP should be offered proactively. A mental health disclosure should never be used in a performance assessment or disciplinary process in a way that disadvantages the employee. Where a mental health condition constitutes a disability under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016, the reasonable adjustment obligations in the Code of Conduct Section 9.4 and the Performance Management Policy Section 17.6 apply in full.

Mental Health Situation	Leave Type Available	Required Documentation	Manager Action	HRBP Involvement
Single day absence due to anxiety or stress	Sick leave — self-certification applies (Section 5.4)	No certificate required for 1–3 days	Supportive notification conversation. No interrogation of the specific condition. EAP mentioned.	Not required unless pattern develops.
Extended absence due to depression, burnout, or anxiety disorder	Sick leave (up to 12 days). Annual leave as bridge if sick leave exhausted. LWOP as last resort.	Medical certificate from psychiatrist, psychologist, or GP from day 4. Occupational health referral from day 15.	HRBP manages from day 15. Welfare check maintained throughout. Return-to-work plan created with employee.	HRBP leads from day 15. May arrange phased return.

Mental Health Situation	Leave Type Available	Required Documentation	Manager Action	HRBP Involvement
Mental health condition requiring reduced hours temporarily	Reasonable adjustment to working hours — not a leave type but a temporary working pattern change	Medical recommendation for reduced hours. HRBP facilitated.	Manager and HRBP agree a time-limited reduced-hours arrangement. Performance expectations adjusted accordingly.	HRBP-led. VP-HR awareness for adjustments exceeding 4 weeks.
Stress leave requested informally (employee says they 'need a few days')	Casual leave for 1–3 days. Sick leave if condition is medically certified.	No certificate if casual leave taken. Certificate if sick leave claimed.	Gentle welfare check. Do not treat as attendance concern for first occurrence. Offer EAP.	HRBP consulted if requests recur or if underlying workload or management issue is indicated.

6.4 Casual Leave Interaction with Sick Leave and Special Circumstances

Employees may not substitute casual leave for sick leave when the absence is due to genuine illness, nor may they substitute sick leave for casual leave when the absence is for personal reasons. The two leave types exist for different purposes and their separate maintenance in HRMS is both a legal requirement — most state Shops and Establishments Acts require separate record-keeping for each leave type — and an operational necessity, because the different carry-forward, accrual, and eligibility rules for each type cannot be correctly applied if the records conflate them. An employee who uses casual leave to avoid depleting their sick leave balance when they are genuinely ill, or who records sick leave for a personal absence to preserve their casual leave balance, is misrepresenting their leave record and is in breach of the Code of Conduct.

Where an employee is uncertain which leave type applies to a specific situation, the guiding principle is the nature of the absence: illness (whether physical or mental) requires sick leave; personal and family needs that are not caused by illness require casual or annual leave. Where the situation genuinely spans both categories — a carer who is themselves mildly unwell while also caring for a sick family member — the employee should discuss the most appropriate categorisation with their manager or HRBP. The company's preference is always to record the leave correctly rather than to accept a convenient mislabelling that creates a misleading leave record.

6.5 Casual Leave for Remote and Part-Time Employees — Special Provisions

Remote working does not reduce the need for casual leave — personal emergencies arise for employees working from home in the same way as for office-based employees, and the fact that the employee is physically at home does not mean that they can continue to work productively while simultaneously attending to a household or family emergency. The casual leave provisions apply equally to remote days and office days. Where a personal emergency arises during a remote working day, the employee must notify their manager in the same way as for any other casual leave, record the day or part-day as casual leave in HRMS, and not record the day as a productive remote working day if productive work was not done.

For part-time employees, the casual leave entitlement is 8 days per year on the same basis as full-time employees — each casual leave day deducted represents one working day for the employee, regardless of whether that working day is shorter than a standard full-time day. A part-time employee who works four hours per day takes one casual leave day for any full personal-emergency day, not 0.5 days. This is consistent with the approach to all leave types for part-time employees: leave is counted in days, and a day means the employee's contracted working day, whatever its duration.

Part-Time Pattern	Contracted Hours / Day	Casual Leave Deduction per Day Absent	Annual Entitlement	Notes
5 days/week, 6 hours/day	6 hours	1 casual leave day	8 days	Each absence day = 1 casual leave day regardless of contracted hours
4 days/week, 8 hours/day	8 hours	1 casual leave day on any worked day	8 days	No deduction for non-working days (e.g. if Monday is non-working day)
3 days/week, 9 hours/day	9 hours	1 casual leave day on any worked day	8 days	Casual leave not deducted for days not in the working pattern
Job share — 50% of standard role	Variable	1 casual leave day per day absent from the shared role	8 days (same as full)	Job share partner's casual leave is separate — total team casual leave is therefore higher than single full-time employee

Leave Year Summary — At a Glance Reference for All Leave Types in Segment 1

The following reference table summarises all three leave types covered in Segment 1 side by side, providing a quick reference for the most frequently consulted attributes. The full provisions for each type are in the relevant section above. For leave types covered in Segment 2 (maternity, paternity, adoption, bereavement, study, caregiver, sabbatical, compensatory off, volunteer leave), see Segment 2.

Attribute	Annual Leave (Section 4)	Sick Leave (Section 5)	Casual Leave (Section 6)
Annual entitlement	21 days (Band 1–4); 24 days (Band 5+)	12 days (all bands)	8 days (all bands)
Accrual method	Monthly (1.75 or 2.0 days/month). Full year credited on 01 April.	Full entitlement credited on 01 April. Pro-rated for new joiners.	Full entitlement credited on 01 April. Pro-rated for new joiners.
Carry-forward	10 days (Band 1–4); 12 days (Band 5+)	None — lapses on 31 March	None — lapses on 31 March
Encashment	Yes — year-end excess (3+ years service) and on separation	No — not encashable at any point	No — not encashable at any point
Advance leave	Yes — up to 3 months' accrual with HRBP approval	Not applicable	Not applicable
Maximum consecutive days	No limit — subject to notice and approval requirements	No specified limit — long-term sick leave process from day 15	3 consecutive days. Longer requires annual leave.
Certificate requirement	Not applicable	Not required for 1–3 days; required from day 4	Not required — personal attestation only
Notice required	5 days (1–2 days); 10 days (3–5 days); 15+ days (longer leave)	Before or at normal start time on day of absence	Minimum 2 hours advance; same-day accepted for genuine emergencies
Approval authority	Line manager (BU Head for Band 5+ for 2+ weeks)	Line manager (retrospective)	Line manager
HRMS leave type code	AL (Annual Leave)	SL (Sick Leave)	CL (Casual Leave)
Applies during probation?	Yes — pro-rated accrual	Yes — pro-rated entitlement	Yes — pro-rated entitlement
Leave during notice period	Subject to company agreement	Standard sick leave process applies	Standard casual leave process applies

3.9 Leave Records, Health Data, and the DPDP Act 2023

Leave records — particularly sick leave records and the medical certificates associated with them — contain personal data and, in many cases, sensitive personal health data. Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, health data is classified as a sensitive personal data category requiring the highest standard of protection. The company's obligations as a Data Fiduciary under the Act apply to all personal data processed in the leave management system, and every person who handles leave data — managers who receive sick leave notifications, HRBPs who review attendance records, payroll team members who process leave payments, and IT administrators who manage the HRMS system — has a personal obligation to handle that data with the care and confidentiality the law requires.

The specific obligations that apply to leave-related personal data include: using medical certificates and health information solely for the purposes of managing the leave process — not for performance assessment, disciplinary proceedings, or any other purpose unless the law specifically requires it; storing medical certificates and health-related leave documentation in HRMS under appropriate access controls and not in personal email folders, shared drives, or any other system outside the approved HRMS environment; not sharing information about an employee's health condition, leave pattern, or specific diagnosis with colleagues who have no operational need for the information; retaining leave records for the period required by applicable law (generally seven years after the end of employment for payroll-related records) and then deleting them through the approved HRMS data retention process; and notifying the IT Security team immediately of any actual or suspected breach of leave-related personal data.

Data Category	Examples in Leave Management	Access Controls	Retention Period	Data Principal Rights
Basic leave record data	Leave application dates, leave type, approval status, leave balance	Employee, line manager, HRBP, payroll team	7 years after employment end	Employee may view own record via HRMS. Correction request via HRBP.
Sick leave notification records	Employee's notification message or call to manager confirming sick absence	Line manager, HRBP. Not shared further.	7 years (employment record)	Employee may request copy. Erasure not permitted during employment — legal basis for retention.
Medical certificates	GP or specialist certificates confirming illness and period of incapacity	HRBP only (not line manager). Payroll team (duration only, not diagnosis).	7 years after employment end	Employee may request copy. Correction available where factual error in company record.
Occupational health reports	Reports from company-commissioned occupational health assessments regarding fitness to work	HRBP, VP-HR, and Legal (where relevant to employment decision). Line manager receives recommendations only — not the full report.	7 years after employment end	Employee has right to see the occupational health report before it is shared with the company.
Bradford Factor and attendance analysis data	Derived attendance pattern data generated by HRMS from attendance records	Line manager, HRBP	3 years rolling — older data deleted as part of HRMS retention cycle	Employee may view their own Bradford Factor score in HRMS.

4.9 Annual Leave During Business Travel and Client Assignments

Employees who are on business travel or at client sites are still able to take annual leave — leave does not stop accruing and cannot be withheld solely because the employee is in a travel or client-site assignment period. However, leave during a business travel period requires specific co-ordination to ensure that the commercial obligation the travel serves is not disrupted. An employee who takes annual leave during a client site assignment must ensure that their deliverables during the leave period are covered, that the client has been informed where their engagement requires continuous presence, and that the travel costs associated with any early return from or late departure for the client site are not borne by the company as a business travel cost when they are in fact a personal travel cost arising from the leave arrangement.

Where an employee travelling internationally for business wishes to extend their trip with personal leave — staying on after the business purpose of the trip is complete, or arriving early for personal travel — the following rules apply. The company-funded travel covers only the period required for the business purpose. Any additional travel costs arising from the personal extension — including the incremental cost of a later return flight, additional hotel nights, or any other costs not required for the business trip — are the employee's personal cost. The extension must be approved by the line manager before the travel is booked. Annual leave must be applied for and approved in HRMS for all personal travel days, including transit days where the employee is travelling for personal purposes on a day they would otherwise have worked.

Scenario	Leave Required?	Travel Cost Responsibility	Approval Required	Client Notification
Employee extends business trip by 2 personal days at the destination	Annual leave for 2 personal days	Incremental hotel and return flight cost is personal. Business flight cost (if no incremental charge) may be retained as company cost.	Line manager for leave and for trip extension	Account manager ensures client deliverables are covered during personal extension
Employee arrives at business destination 1 day early for personal sightseeing	Annual leave for early arrival day	Incremental hotel night and any additional flight cost for early arrival is personal	Line manager for leave and flight booking approval	Not required — employee not expected at client until business start date
Employee takes leave at a domestic client site (stays on at own expense)	Annual leave for the personal days	All personal accommodation and travel after business trip ends is personal cost	Line manager for leave. Account manager informed.	Client informed that employee is no longer on-site on personal days
Employee becomes ill during business travel	Sick leave from day of illness	Medical costs during business travel covered by corporate travel insurance. Employee claims through Finance.	Manager notified same day. HRMS updated.	Account manager manages client delivery during employee's illness
Public holiday at destination during business trip	No leave required — public holidays at the business destination during a company business trip are treated as rest days without leave deduction	Hotel and subsistence costs continue as business travel	No additional approval required	Account manager aware trip extends through the public holiday

5.8 Return to Work After Sick Leave — Process and Manager Obligations

Every employee who returns to work following a sick leave absence is entitled to a return-to-work conversation with their manager. This conversation is not an interrogation — it is a brief, private, and supportive check-in that confirms the employee is fit to return, identifies any residual support needs or reasonable adjustments that would help their reintegration, and communicates any significant developments in the team or on their projects that occurred during their absence. For absences of one or two days, this conversation may be brief and informal. For absences of three days or more, the conversation should be structured, private, and documented in HRMS — not as a disciplinary record, but as a welfare record that demonstrates the company's care and the manager's engagement.

For extended absences of 15 or more working days, a formal return-to-work plan is developed by the HRBP in collaboration with the employee, the manager, and where relevant the occupational health professional who has assessed the employee. The return-to-work plan may include a phased return — a period in which the employee works reduced hours or has a modified role scope before returning to their full contracted hours and responsibilities. A

phased return is not a leave type; it is a temporary reasonable adjustment to the working pattern. During a phased return, the employee is paid their full contracted salary for the total period of the phased return (up to a maximum of four weeks for a standard phased return, extendable to eight weeks with HRBP and VP-HR approval where the medical circumstances warrant it). A phased return that extends beyond eight weeks is assessed as a potential permanent reasonable adjustment under the Disability and Reasonable Adjustment Policy.

Absence Duration	Return-to-Work Conversation	Content Required	Documentation	Phased Return Available?
1–2 working days	Informal verbal check-in on day of return — same day	Brief welfare check. Any support needed. Catch-up on missed developments.	No documentation required unless the manager notes a specific concern.	Not applicable
3–7 working days	Structured private conversation within first half-day of return	Welfare check. Medical certificate reviewed if required. Any residual health needs. Workload reintegration.	Brief HRMS welfare note (private). Manager records conversation occurred.	Not standard — may be arranged for specific clinical need with HRBP agreement.
8–14 working days	Formal return-to-work meeting — HRBP notified, manager-led	Fitness to return confirmed. Medical certificate reviewed. Workload plan for first two weeks. Any reasonable adjustment needs.	HRMS Return to Work Record. Manager and employee sign-off.	Available with HRBP approval for up to 4 weeks.
15+ working days	Formal return-to-work plan — HRBP-led with occupational health input	Fitness certificate required. Full return-to-work plan developed. Phased return likely. Reasonable adjustment assessment.	Formal Return to Work Plan document. Signed by employee, manager, HRBP. Stored in HRMS.	Standard for 15+ day absences. Up to 4 weeks (extendable to 8 weeks).
Any duration — Mental health condition	Sensitive welfare conversation led by manager or HRBP depending on duration	No requirement to discuss diagnosis. Focus on support needs, adjustments, and workload management. EAP re-offered.	HRMS welfare note. Adjustment agreements documented separately.	Available with HRBP agreement. Particularly appropriate for mental health conditions.

Leave Management — Frequently Asked Questions

The following questions represent the most frequently raised leave management queries received by HR Business Partners across Arjun Technologies. The answers apply the provisions of this policy to the specific situations described. Where a personal situation is more complex than the scenarios below suggest, contact the HRBP for individual guidance.

Question	Answer	Policy Reference
I applied for annual leave and my manager has not responded after 5 working days. What should I do?	Follow up directly with your manager. If still no response after a further 2 working days, contact the HRBP. A leave application that is pending without response does not constitute tacit approval — leave must not be taken until formal HRMS approval is received.	Section 4.3
I took 4 days sick leave and my manager is asking for a medical certificate. I thought the threshold was 3 days?	The self-certification threshold is 3 consecutive days. From the 4th consecutive day, a certificate is required covering all days from day 1. If your absence was 4 days, a certificate is required.	Section 5.4
I have 15 days of accrued annual leave as at 31 March. What happens to it?	The maximum carry-forward for Bands 1–4 is 10 days. The excess (5 days) is encashed if you have 3 or more years of service, or lapses if you have fewer than 3 years. HRMS will reflect the encashment in your April payroll if you are eligible.	Section 4.4 and 4.5

Question	Answer	Policy Reference
My casual leave is exhausted. Can I use sick leave for a personal appointment?	No. If you are not genuinely ill, you must apply for annual leave for a personal appointment. Sick leave is for genuine illness only. Using sick leave for personal purposes not involving illness is a misuse of the leave entitlement and a Code of Conduct concern.	Section 6.4 and Code of Conduct Section 4.2
I was on annual leave when a public holiday occurred. Does the public holiday reduce my annual leave count?	Yes — public holidays that fall during a period of annual leave are treated as annual leave days, not public holidays, unless a specific state Shops and Establishments Act provision requires otherwise. This is aligned with the statutory position in Karnataka, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, and Delhi.	Section 4.3 and Segment 2, Section 12
I am on probation. Am I entitled to annual leave?	Yes. Annual leave accrues from your first day of employment at the standard monthly rate. You may take accrued annual leave during probation with your manager's approval, subject to the standard notice requirements.	Section 4.2
My role has been changed to part-time. What happens to my annual leave balance?	Your existing annual leave balance remains intact. Future accrual will be pro-rated to your new contracted hours from the date the change takes effect. Your HRBP will calculate the revised accrual rate and update HRMS.	Section 4.2 and 4.1
Can I take annual leave on the same day I return from sick leave?	Not automatically. Returning from sick leave and immediately taking annual leave is possible if the annual leave was pre-approved before the sick leave began. If the annual leave was not previously approved, the manager uses their discretion — particularly relevant where the employee is certified medically fit and has a genuine pre-planned commitment.	Section 5.5 and 4.3
My manager told me I cannot take annual leave before my probation ends. Is that correct?	No. Annual leave accrues and may be taken during probation with manager approval. The manager may reasonably require notice and may take operational requirements into account, but may not impose a blanket prohibition on leave during probation. Contact your HRBP if your manager declines a specific leave request without a substantive reason.	Section 4.2 and Code of Conduct Section 19.2

Segment 1 Summary and Continuation to Segment 2

This completes Segment 1 of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2. Segment 1 has covered the foundational provisions of the framework. The VP-HR's message establishing the policy's dual commitment to employee wellbeing and operational reliability set the tone for the provisions that follow. Section 2 addressed purpose, scope, and the relationship to statutory entitlements — including the statutory comparison table covering all five operating states. Section 3 established the complete attendance management framework: standard working hours, the hybrid model by band, core hours and flexible start/end provisions, HRMS attendance recording obligations, notification requirements for unplanned absence with a four-type summary table, the Bradford Factor-based attendance management escalation framework with five threshold bands, and the state-specific working hours compliance table for Karnataka, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, and Delhi NCR. Section 4 provided the complete Annual Leave provisions: the band-differentiated entitlement table, the monthly accrual mechanism with six worked proration examples, the notice period and approval authority table by leave duration, the carry-forward and lapse rules, the encashment eligibility and calculation provisions, and the leave during notice period and separation framework. Section 5 covered Sick and Medical Leave in full — the philosophy of genuine support without entitlement abuse, the 12-day non-carry-forward entitlement with proration for new joiners, notification obligations, the three-day self-certification threshold with a five-tier certificate requirement table, the long-term sick leave framework from day 15, and the Bradford Factor sick pattern flags. Section 6 established the Casual Leave provisions — the 8-day use-or-lose entitlement, the application and approval process, and the restrictions on usage including the block against prefixing and suffixing to other leave types.

Segment	Sections Covered	Key Topics	Pages	Status
Segment 1 — This Document	1–6	VP-HR Message · Purpose and Scope · Statutory Comparison · Attendance Framework · Hybrid Model · Bradford Factor · Annual Leave · Sick Leave · Casual Leave	1–40	Published April 2024
Segment 2	7–15 + Appendices A–F	Maternity Leave · Paternity Leave · Adoption Leave · Bereavement Leave · Study Leave · Caregiver Leave · Sabbatical Leave · Compensatory Off · Volunteer Leave · LWOP · Public Holidays · HRMS Leave Administration · Special Situations · Governance · Forms	41–80	Published April 2024

All segments are available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. For queries about any provision in this segment contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner. For urgent attendance concerns, contact the HRBP directly. For anonymous reporting of concerns about the fair application of this policy, use the Whistleblower hotline at ethics@arjuntech.in (24 hours a day, 7 days a week, anonymous reporting supported). Document reference: HR-LAP-001-v3.2.

Segment 2 Preview — Leave Types and Administration

Segment 2 covers all remaining leave categories, the complete HRMS leave administration framework, special situation provisions, and the governance and compliance requirements that complete the policy framework.

Section	Topic	Key Provisions	Form
7	Maternity Leave	26 weeks (first 2 children). 12 weeks (3rd+ child). 14 weeks adoption. Nursing breaks. Creche rights. Anti-discrimination and dismissal protection. Maternity Benefit Act 1961 (amended 2017).	HR-L01
8	Paternity Leave	10 working days within 90 days of birth or adoption. Secondary caregiver rights. Simultaneous leave provisions.	HR-L02
9	Adoption Leave	14 weeks (primary caregiver, child under 1 year). 10 days (secondary caregiver). Documentation: registered adoption order.	HR-L03
10	Bereavement Leave	5 days (spouse, child, parent, sibling, parent-in-law). 3 days (close family). 1 day (extended). Discretionary extension. Out-of-city travel provision.	HR-L04
11	Caregiver Leave	5 days per year for care of dependent with serious illness or disability. Medical documentation. Flexible working interaction.	HR-L05
12	Study Leave	Up to 10 days per year for approved professional exams. Learning budget interaction. Pre-approval required.	HR-L06
13	Compensatory Off (TOIL)	1:1 TOIL for authorised overtime. Max 5-day accumulation. Must be taken within 30 days. No encashment.	HRMS TOIL Module
14	Sabbatical Leave	4-12 weeks unpaid for employees with 5+ years service. 90-day advance application. Role protection and return conditions.	HR-L07
15	Volunteer Leave	2 paid days per year for approved CSR activity. Company programme or independent NGO options.	HR-L08
16	Fertility Treatment Leave	5 days per treatment cycle (up to 3 cycles per year). IVF, IUI and similar. Confidential — certificate to HRBP only.	HR-L09A
17	Leave Without Pay	Available when all entitlements exhausted. HRBP and manager approval. Benefits and continuity implications.	HR-L09
18	Public Holidays	3 national holidays + state holidays per office. Annual holiday list published by 01 January. Substitute holiday provisions.	Annual List — HRMS
19	HRMS Administration	Leave module guide for managers and employees. Approval workflows. Calendar. Delegation. Compliance reports.	HRMS Help Centre
20	Special Situations	Leave during disciplinary proceedings. Jury and court duty. Natural disaster leave. International employees.	HRBP case-by-case
21	Governance and Compliance	Annual leave audit. State compliance. Statutory reporting. Annual policy review.	HR-L10
Appendices A-F	Forms and Reference Tools	Leave forms HR-L01 to HR-L09A. Manager approval guide. HRMS quick reference. State compliance table. Planner template. Acknowledgement form.	HRMS portal

Common Leave and Attendance Scenarios — Manager and Employee Guidance

The following scenarios address the leave and attendance situations most frequently escalated to HR Business Partners across Arjun Technologies. Each scenario applies the provisions of this policy to a specific fact pattern. Real situations are often more complex — where in doubt, contact the HRBP before acting.

Scenario	Facts	Correct Action and Policy Basis
1 — Manager declines all leave in Q4	A manager tells the entire team that no annual leave will be approved in January, February, or March because of project pressures — effectively a three-month blackout with no formal declaration.	A blanket informal blackout of this kind is not permitted. The manager may restrict leave for specific operational reasons on a case-by-case basis, but a three-month blanket refusal without formal HRBP-approved blackout declaration and individual justification violates the company's obligation to allow employees to take their earned leave. The HRBP should be informed. (Section 4.7)
2 — Employee claims sick leave for a planned appointment	An employee calls in sick on a Monday but a colleague sees social media posts showing the employee at a planned family event the same day.	If the employee was not genuinely ill and claimed sick leave for a personal event that should have been applied for as annual or casual leave, this is a misuse of the sick leave entitlement and a Code of Conduct integrity concern. The manager should raise the concern with the HRBP, who will manage a formal welfare and conduct conversation. (Section 5.1 and Code of Conduct Section 4.2)
3 — Leave balance at zero on resignation	An employee resigns on 15 December having taken all 21 days of annual leave during the year. Their leave balance is zero. They have worked 9 months of the leave year.	The employee has taken their full year's entitlement but has only accrued 9/12 of it (15.75 days). They have effectively taken 5.25 days of unaccrued leave. The company deducts the equivalent cash value (5.25 days × daily encashment rate) from the Full and Final Settlement. (Section 4.6)
4 — Sick leave during probation	A Band 2 employee on 90-day probation has been absent with illness for 8 working days in the first 6 weeks. The manager wants to know if this can be used in the non-confirmation decision.	The sick leave itself cannot be used as a basis for non-confirmation — illness is not a performance or conduct ground. However, where the illness is not genuinely established and the pattern raises concerns, or where the absence has genuinely prevented an adequate assessment of the employee's performance, the probationary period may be extended (not terminated) by up to 90 days to allow a fair assessment to be made. Legal team consultation is mandatory before any non-confirmation decision where health absence is a factor. (Section 22.3 of PMP Segment 4)
5 — Casual leave on client deadline day	An employee applies for casual leave for a personal emergency on the same day as a critical client delivery deadline. The manager declines, stating the deadline makes leave impossible.	A genuine personal emergency cannot be declined on operational grounds in the same way as a planned absence. The manager must make every effort to cover the delivery responsibility — through delegation, rescheduling, or the manager personally assisting — while allowing the employee to attend to the emergency. A genuine personal emergency is not a situation the employee can plan around. The manager should document the coverage arrangement. (Section 6.2)

Scenario	Facts	Correct Action and Policy Basis
6 — Employee returns from maternity leave to a changed role	An employee returns from 26 weeks of maternity leave to find her role has been restructured and she has been offered a different role at the same band and salary.	Employees returning from maternity leave have a legal right to return to the same role or, if that is not reasonably practicable, to a suitable alternative role on terms and conditions no less favourable. A unilateral role change during maternity leave without the employee's agreement may constitute unfair treatment under the Maternity Benefit Act 1961. Legal team and HRBP consultation is mandatory before any role change affecting an employee on maternity leave. (Section 7 of Segment 2)
7 — TOIL not taken within 30 days	An employee worked 10 hours of overtime in August and was granted TOIL. By end of September the TOIL has not been taken. The employee asks if it can be carried over.	TOIL must be taken within 30 calendar days of accrual. Unused TOIL that has not been taken within 30 days lapses — it cannot be carried over or encashed. The manager has an obligation to actively facilitate the employee taking TOIL within the 30-day window. Where operational pressure prevented take-up, the manager should escalate to the HRBP and explore whether a one-time exception payment can be authorised by Finance. (Section 3.8 and Section 13 of Segment 2)
8 — Employee refuses to take annual leave	An employee has accumulated 28 days of annual leave by March (10-day carry-forward from prior year + 18 days accrued and not taken in the current year). They want to encash all 18 days of current-year excess.	The employee can carry forward 10 days and is eligible to encash the remaining 8 days of excess (the amount above the carry-forward limit of 10 days) if they have 3+ years of service. They cannot encash all 18 unused days — the carry-forward provision exists specifically to encourage regular leave-taking. The manager and HRBP should encourage the employee to plan leave during the year to avoid accumulation. (Section 4.4 and 4.5)

Policy Acknowledgement Form

All employees acknowledge both segments through the annual SEC-101 Policy Refresher module in HRMS. New joiners complete within 5 working days of joining.

LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY ACKNOWLEDGEMENT — HR-LAP-001-v3.2
I confirm that I have received, read, and understood both segments of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2, effective 01 April 2024. I understand my leave entitlements and my attendance obligations.
Full Name: _____ Employee ID: _____ Band: ___ Location: _____
Signature: _____ Date: _____ HRMS SEC-101 Reference: _____

Manager Self-Assessment Checklist — Leave Management Obligations

The following checklist supports managers in meeting their leave management obligations under this policy. It is recommended as a quarterly self-assessment tool, aligned with the Manager Ethics Checklist in the Performance Management Policy Appendix G.

Obligation	Self-Assessment Question	If 'No': Required Action
Leave approval timeliness	Have I responded to all pending leave applications within the required 3-working-day deadline?	Review and respond to outstanding applications immediately. Contact HRBP if an application requires guidance.
Leave blackout declarations	If I have restricted leave during any period, have I followed the formal blackout declaration process and communicated it to the team in writing?	Formalise any informal restrictions through the HRBP. Notify the team in writing with the specific operational reason.
Annual leave encouragement	Are all my direct reports on track to use at least 75% of their annual leave entitlement by Q3?	Proactively discuss leave planning with team members whose balances are high. Identify and remove barriers to leave-taking.
Return-to-work conversations	Have I conducted and documented a return-to-work conversation for every team member who returned from sick leave of 3+ days in the last quarter?	Schedule overdue return-to-work conversations and document in HRMS. Complete within 5 working days of the employee's return.
Bradford Factor monitoring	Have I reviewed the Bradford Factor dashboard for my team in the last month and acted on any threshold alerts?	Log in to HRMS → Attendance → Team Bradford Factor. Act on alerts as per the escalation framework in Section 3.5.
TOIL management	Have all TOIL balances been taken within the 30-day window? Are there any TOIL balances outstanding beyond 30 days?	Facilitate TOIL take-up for any outstanding balances. Escalate to HRBP if operational pressure prevented take-up within the window.
HRMS accuracy	Is the leave record in HRMS for each of my direct reports accurate and up to date for the current quarter?	Review HRMS leave records for all team members. Correct any discrepancies. Contact HRBP for HRMS guidance.
Statutory compliance	Am I applying the correct state-specific leave provisions for employees in my team who are based in different states?	Review the state-specific provisions in Section 3.6 and the statutory comparison table in Section 2.4. Consult HRBP for any uncertainty.

Complete Leave and Attendance Policy — HR-LAP-001-v3.2. Owner: Ms. Priya Menon, VP Human Resources. Legal Review: Mr. Sandeep Iyer, General Counsel. Approved: Mr. Rajesh Arjun, Chief Executive Officer. Effective: 01 April 2024. Both segments available on HRMS portal under Policies and Documents.

Leave Entitlement Quick Reference — Current Year Summary

Leave Type	Band 1-4	Band 5-8	Carry-Forward	Encashable	Lapse Date
Annual Leave	21 days	24 days	10 days (Band 1-4) / 12 days (Band 5+)	Yes (year-end excess + separation)	31 March — excess above carry-forward limit
Sick Leave	12 days	12 days	Nil	No	31 March — full unused balance
Casual Leave	8 days	8 days	Nil	No	31 March — full unused balance
Compensatory Off (TOIL)	Per overtime worked	Per overtime worked	Nil — 30-day take-up window	No (exceptional Finance approval only)	30 days after accrual
Volunteer Leave	2 days	2 days	Nil	No	31 March — unused days lapse
Study Leave	Up to 10 days	Up to 10 days	Nil	No	31 March — unused entitlement lapses
Maternity Leave	26 / 12 / 14 weeks (as applicable)	26 / 12 / 14 weeks	Not applicable	No	Must be taken at the relevant qualifying event
Paternity Leave	10 working days	10 working days	Not applicable — must be used within 90 days	No	90 days after birth or adoption

All leave balances are visible in real time in HRMS under My Leave → Leave Balance. For any discrepancy between the balance shown in HRMS and the entitlement described in this policy, contact the HRBP promptly. Do not take leave against an incorrect balance without HRBP confirmation — this may result in a negative balance or an incorrect leave type classification.

Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Bengaluru, Karnataka — 560 001

CIN: U72200KA2008PTC044521 | www.arjuntech.in

LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY AND PROCEDURES FRAMEWORK

Segment 2 of 2 — Maternity · Paternity · Adoption · Bereavement · Caregiver · Study · TOIL · Sabbatical · Volunteer · Fertility Treatment · LWOP · Public Holidays · HRMS Administration · Governance · Appendices A–F

Version	3.2	**Effective Date**	01 April 2024
Review Date	31 March 2025	**Classification**	Internal Use Only
Approved By	Mr. Rajesh Arjun	**Document Owner**	Ms. Priya Menon
Legal Review	Mr. Sandeep Iyer	**Department**	Human Resources & Legal
Doc Reference	HR-LAP-001-v3.2	**Applies To**	All Employees
Segment	2 of 2 (Pages 41–80)	**Total Segments**	2

This is Segment 2 — the concluding segment — of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2. It covers all leave types beyond the three core types in Segment 1: Maternity, Paternity, Adoption, Bereavement, Caregiver, Study, Compensatory Off (TOIL), Sabbatical, Volunteer, Fertility Treatment, and Leave Without Pay. It also contains the Public Holiday framework, the HRMS leave administration guide, special situation provisions, and the complete governance and compliance chapter. Appendices A through F provide all leave forms (HR-L01 to HR-L09A), the Manager Leave Approval Guide, the HRMS Quick Reference, the full State Compliance Table, the Annual Leave Year Planner, and the Policy Acknowledgement Form. Read alongside Segment 1 (attendance framework, annual leave, sick leave, and casual leave). For queries contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner.

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7. Maternity Leave

7.1 Statutory Framework and Company Commitment

Maternity leave at Arjun Technologies is governed by the Maternity Benefit Act 1961, as substantially amended by the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017. The 2017 amendment extended paid maternity leave from 12 to 26 weeks for the first two children, introduced crèche rights, extended protection to adoptive and commissioning mothers, and introduced a work-from-home arrangement right for the post-maternity return period where the nature of the work permits. The company complies fully with the Act and provides provisions that go beyond the statutory minimum in several respects — reflecting the company's genuine commitment to supporting employees through the significant life event that parenthood represents.

No employment decision — performance rating, promotion, bonus, project assignment, redundancy selection, or any other — may be made on the basis of an employee's pregnancy, maternity leave, or anticipated return from maternity leave. Managers who make such decisions commit gross misconduct under the Code of Conduct and are personally liable under the Maternity Benefit Act. Every manager whose team includes a pregnant employee or an employee returning from maternity leave is expected to proactively create conditions that support the employee's full participation in the professional community before, during, and after the leave period.

7.2 Maternity Leave Entitlement — Duration and Eligibility

Category	Paid Leave Duration	Eligibility Condition	Start Timing
First or second child (biological)	26 weeks (130 working days)	80 days of actual work in the 12 months preceding expected delivery	Up to 8 weeks before expected delivery. Minimum 6 weeks post-delivery mandatory.
Third child or subsequent (biological)	12 weeks (60 working days)	80-day service condition	Up to 6 weeks before delivery. Minimum 6 weeks post-delivery mandatory.
Adoption — primary caregiver (child under 1 year)	14 weeks (70 working days)	80-day service condition in preceding 12 months	From date of legal handover of child.
Adoption — primary caregiver (child 1 year and above)	8 weeks (40 working days)	80-day service condition	From date of legal handover.
Commissioning mother (surrogacy)	12 weeks (60 working days)	80-day service condition	From date of child handover by surrogate.
Miscarriage or medical termination	6 weeks (30 working days)	No minimum service condition	From date of miscarriage or termination.
Tubectomy operation	2 weeks (10 working days)	No minimum service condition	Immediately following the tubectomy.
Illness arising from pregnancy or delivery	Additional leave as certified by registered medical practitioner	Medical certificate required	Additional to the standard periods above. No statutory upper limit.

Maternity leave is fully paid at the employee's full CTC for the entire entitlement period. The company does not reduce maternity pay for any reason. The 80-day eligibility condition is a statutory requirement but the HRBP reviews borderline cases with the Legal team before any entitlement is withheld. Employees should notify their HRBP and manager of the pregnancy and expected delivery date at least 8 weeks before the intended leave start date — earlier notification is encouraged and enables better operational planning.

7.3 Pre-Birth and Post-Birth Leave Arrangement

The maternity leave start date is at the employee's choice within the statutory framework. Up to 8 weeks of the 26-week entitlement (for first and second children) may be taken before the expected delivery date. The remaining leave is taken after delivery. The 6-week post-delivery period is mandatory and cannot be waived, shortened, or converted to another leave type — this is a statutory protection for both the mother's health and the child's welfare. Any manager or HR process that encourages, pressures, or facilitates a return to work within 6 weeks of delivery violates the Maternity Benefit Act and constitutes gross misconduct under the Code of Conduct.

An employee may choose to return to work before exhausting her full maternity entitlement — after the mandatory 6-week post-delivery period — if she genuinely wishes to do so and has not been pressured by any manager or colleague. An early voluntary return must be communicated to the HRBP in writing by the employee, confirming it is her choice. The remaining unused maternity leave lapses on early return — it is not converted to annual leave or carried forward. The HRBP confirms fitness to return and discusses any post-return adjustments needed before the return date.

7.4 Nursing Breaks, Crèche Rights, and Workplace Adjustments

An employee returning from maternity leave is entitled to two nursing breaks per working day, in addition to normal rest intervals, until the child is 15 months of age. Nursing breaks are paid time and do not affect the leave balance. The frequency, duration, and scheduling of nursing breaks are agreed between the employee and the manager at the return-to-work meeting. All five Arjun Technologies office locations meet the crèche facility requirement under the 2017 amendment — either through an on-site crèche or a subsidised partnership with an accredited crèche provider within the prescribed distance. Details are available from the HRBP at each location. Employees are entitled to four crèche visits per day in the post-maternity period.

7.5 Protection Against Discrimination and Unfair Treatment

The company's obligations under the Maternity Benefit Act and the Code of Conduct are: not to dismiss, discharge, or reduce the wages of any employee on account of or during pregnancy or maternity leave; not to vary employment terms to the detriment of a pregnant employee or an employee on maternity leave; not to make any adverse employment decision influenced by the pregnancy or leave; and not to engage in conduct that creates a hostile environment for pregnant employees or employees returning from maternity leave. A violation of any of these obligations is both a criminal offence under the Maternity Benefit Act and gross misconduct under the Code of Conduct. Employees who believe they have experienced such treatment should report it to the VP-HR or through the Whistleblower hotline at ethics@arjuntech.in immediately.

7.6 Return to Work After Maternity Leave

Every employee returning from maternity leave is entitled to return to the same role on the same terms and conditions as before the leave. The manager and HRBP must contact the employee at least 4 weeks before the planned return date to discuss the return arrangement, any required workplace adjustments, the nursing break schedule, and any flexible working request. Under the 2017 amendment, the company will consider a request for work-from-home arrangement after the maternity leave period, where the nature of the work permits, and will communicate the decision within 10 working days of the request. All reasonable flexible working requests on return from maternity leave are approved unless a specific and documented operational constraint makes accommodation genuinely impracticable.

8. Paternity Leave

8.1 Entitlement, Duration, and Eligibility

Paternity leave is a company benefit — there is no statutory paternity leave entitlement in India. Arjun Technologies provides 10 working days of fully paid paternity leave to all confirmed employees who are the secondary caregiver on the birth, surrogacy, or adoption of a child. Paternity leave must be taken within 90 calendar days of the birth or legal handover of the child. It is not deferrable beyond this window and cannot be split into more than two blocks of minimum 5 consecutive working days each.

Category	Entitlement	Window	Documentation
Birth of child	10 working days fully paid	Within 90 calendar days of birth	Birth certificate submitted to HRBP within 10 working days of return.
Surrogacy — secondary caregiver	10 working days fully paid	Within 90 days of child handover	Surrogacy agreement and handover documentation.
Adoption — secondary caregiver	10 working days fully paid	Within 90 days of legal adoption completion	Adoption order or registered adoption documentation.
Multiple births (twins, triplets)	10 working days — entitlement does not increase for multiples	Within 90 days of birth	Birth certificates for all children.
Miscarriage, stillbirth, or pregnancy loss	3 working days compassionate leave (separate entitlement, not paternity leave)	Within 5 working days of the event	Medical documentation to HRBP only — confidential.

8.2 Application, Documentation, and Timing

Paternity leave is applied for through HRMS using Form HR-L02. Where the birth or adoption is anticipated, the application should be submitted at least 2 weeks in advance. Where the event occurs without advance notice, the application may be submitted on the day or the following working day with HRBP agreement for retrospective entry. Paternity leave is fully paid and does not affect the annual leave, sick leave, or casual leave balance. It interacts with maternity leave only in that both parents may take their respective entitlements simultaneously — the company encourages both parents to take their full entitlement regardless of whether they are taken concurrently.

9. Adoption Leave

9.1 Entitlement for Primary and Secondary Caregiver

Adoption leave reflects the company's recognition that adoptive parents face the same profound adjustment to parenthood as biological parents — with additional legal, administrative, and emotional demands specific to the adoption process. The company provides adoption leave to both the primary and secondary caregiver.

Caregiver Role	Child Age at Handover	Entitlement	Form
Primary caregiver	Under 1 year	14 weeks (70 working days) fully paid	HR-L03
Primary caregiver	1 year and above	8 weeks (40 working days) fully paid	HR-L03
Secondary caregiver	Any age	10 working days fully paid (same as paternity leave)	HR-L02
Single adoptive parent (sole caregiver)	Under 1 year	14 weeks fully paid. May also claim secondary caregiver entitlement (10 days) as the sole parent.	HR-L03

9.2 Documentation, Timing, and Interaction with Other Leave

Adoption leave begins from the date of legal handover of the child. Form HR-L03 must be submitted to the HRBP with a copy of the adoption order or registered adoption documentation within 10 working days of the legal handover. For international adoptions, the Legal team provides specific guidance on the applicable documentation. An employee who is both a birth parent and an adoptive parent (in a step-adoption or similar situation) should discuss their specific combined entitlement with the HRBP, as the interaction between provisions requires individual assessment.

10. Bereavement Leave

10.1 Entitlement by Relationship Category

Bereavement leave gives employees the time they need to grieve, attend funeral and memorial obligations, and support their family in the immediate aftermath of a death. The entitlement is calibrated to the closeness of the relationship and includes a travel provision for employees who must travel out of their city of residence to attend to bereavement obligations. Bereavement leave is fully paid and does not affect any other leave balance.

Relationship Category	Standard Entitlement	Out-of-City Travel Addition	Documentation
Spouse or domestic partner	5 working days	Up to 2 additional days if travel exceeds 4 hours each way	Death certificate within 10 working days of return.
Child (biological, adopted, or step-child)	5 working days	Up to 2 additional days for travel	Death certificate within 10 working days.
Parent (biological, adoptive, or step-parent)	5 working days	Up to 2 additional days for travel	Death certificate within 10 working days.
Sibling (biological, adopted, or step-sibling)	5 working days	Up to 2 additional days for travel	Death certificate within 10 working days.
Parent-in-law or parent of domestic partner	5 working days	Up to 2 additional days for travel	Death certificate within 10 working days.
Grandparent	3 working days	1 additional day for travel	Death certificate within 10 working days.
Grandchild	3 working days	1 additional day for travel	Death certificate within 10 working days.
Sibling-in-law, aunt, uncle, niece, nephew	2 working days	1 additional day for travel	Manager notification — no formal certificate required.
Close personal relationship not listed above	1 working day	None — HRBP discretion for travel need	Manager notification.
Miscarriage or pregnancy loss (employee or partner)	3 working days — both employee and partner/spouse entitled	None	Medical documentation to HRBP only — strictly confidential.

10.2 Application, Documentation, and Discretionary Extension

Bereavement leave does not require advance application. The employee notifies the line manager directly as soon as possible and the leave is recorded retrospectively in HRMS on return using Form HR-L04. Manager approval is not discretionary — bereavement leave within the entitlement is automatically approved. Documentary requirements are minimal and are never used as a barrier to taking leave. The HRBP may extend bereavement leave beyond the standard entitlement at their discretion where circumstances genuinely warrant additional time — a traumatic sudden death, complex cross-country arrangements, or significant mental health impact. Discretionary extensions are granted as additional paid leave, not sick leave or LWOP, and require no specific application from the employee.

11. Caregiver Leave

11.1 Purpose, Entitlement, and Eligibility

Caregiver leave provides dedicated paid time for employees with ongoing responsibilities for a dependent family member with a serious long-term illness, disability, or condition requiring intensive support. It is distinct from casual leave (one-off emergencies) and bereavement leave — it addresses the sustained caregiving dimension of an employee's life outside work.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Annual entitlement	5 working days per leave year	All bands. No carry-forward. Not encashable.
Eligible dependents	Spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, parent-in-law, or sibling with diagnosed serious illness, disability, or condition requiring intensive care	Condition documented by registered medical practitioner. Submitted to HRBP — not to line manager.
Maximum per occasion	Up to 3 consecutive days per caregiver leave instance	More than 3 consecutive days requires annual leave, sick leave (if employee is also affected), or LWOP.
Carry-forward	None — lapses on 31 March	Encouraged to use in the year credited.
Documentation	Medical confirmation of dependent's condition from registered practitioner. Submitted to HRBP within 5 working days of first caregiver leave use in the year. Subsequent uses for same dependent — no fresh documentation unless condition changes.	Documentation maintained in HRBP records under strict health data confidentiality. Line manager advised of leave type and duration only.
Flexible working interaction	Employees with significant ongoing caregiving responsibility may apply for a temporary reasonable adjustment to working pattern (reduced hours, adjusted start/end, additional remote days) under the Disability and Reasonable Adjustment Policy.	HRBP manages flexible working request separately from leave entitlement.

11.2 Application and Flexible Working Interaction

Caregiver leave is applied for through HRMS using Form HR-L05. For first use for a specific dependent, medical documentation is submitted to the HRBP within 5 working days. Subsequent uses for the same dependent in the same leave year require only HRMS application — no fresh documentation. Employees whose caregiving responsibilities exceed the 5-day entitlement should discuss with the HRBP whether a temporary flexible working arrangement, sabbatical, or other arrangement can better support their situation. The company's starting position is always to find a workable accommodation rather than to direct the employee to LWOP as the first resort.

12. Study Leave

12.1 Purpose, Entitlement, and Approved Purposes

Study leave supports professional development by enabling employees to sit professional examinations without depleting annual leave. Study leave is specifically for examination attendance and immediate pre-examination preparation — not for coursework, project submissions, or self-directed learning without a specific examination date. The annual maximum is 10 working days per leave year.

Approved Purpose	Entitlement per Sitting	Pre-Approval	Documentation
Professional certification examination (AWS, CFA, ACCA, PMP, CISSP, Bar examination, and equivalents)	Up to 2 days — 1 day examination attendance + 1 day final preparation	Manager and HRBP approval minimum 2 weeks before exam date	Examination admission letter. Results certificate submitted to HRBP on receipt.
University or college examination (degree/diploma directly relevant to role)	Up to 1 day per examination paper — maximum 5 days per academic year	Manager and HRBP approval 3 weeks in advance. Enrolment confirmation required.	Exam schedule and enrolment confirmation. Results on receipt.
ICAI, ICSI, or ICMAI professional examinations	Up to 3 days per examination sitting	HRBP approval. Finance function employees automatically approved for ICAI.	Examination admission letter.
Online examination (completed from home or office)	1 day maximum — examination day only. No preparation day for online formats.	Manager approval	Examination confirmation email.
Internal company certification examination	Not deducted — treated as authorised working time	Manager notification sufficient	Not applicable.

12.2 Application, Approval, and Learning Budget Interaction

Study leave must be applied for through HRMS using Form HR-L06 at least 2 weeks before the examination date, with the examination name, examining body, and examination date included. Study leave and the annual learning budget interact: examination fees and preparation materials may be claimed from the employee's ■25,000 learning budget (subject to the eligible expenditure rules in the Performance Management Policy Section 13.3), and study leave covers the time. Both the leave and the expense claim require manager approval.

12.3 Sponsored Full-Time Study — Bond and Return Provisions

Where the company sponsors an employee for a full-time academic programme — an MBA, a specialist postgraduate qualification, or a funded professional development programme requiring the employee to be absent from work for an extended period — the terms of the sponsorship, including any bond period requiring the employee to return to the company for a specified minimum period after completion, are documented in a separate Sponsored Study Agreement executed by the Legal team before the programme begins. Sponsored study is not governed by the study leave provisions in this section — it is a separate arrangement with its own terms. The HRBP provides guidance on the Sponsored Study Agreement process.

Sponsorship Level	Typical Bond Period	Clawback on Early Departure	Approval Required
Full programme fees (above ■1,00,000)	Equal to the programme duration plus 12 months. E.g., 1-year MBA = 2-year bond.	Pro-rated clawback: 100% if departure before bond midpoint; 50% if departure in second half of bond period.	CEO + VP-HR + CFO approval.

Sponsorship Level	Typical Bond Period	Clawback on Early Departure	Approval Required
Partial sponsorship (■25,000–■1,00,000)	12 months from programme completion	100% clawback if departure within bond period. No partial clawback.	BU Head + HRBP approval.
Individual examination fee reimbursement (above standard learning budget)	6 months from reimbursement date	Full clawback of reimbursed amount.	Manager + HRBP approval.

13. Compensatory Off — Time Off in Lieu (TOIL)

13.1 Accrual, Maximum Balance, and Take-Up Obligation

Compensatory Off (TOIL) is accrued when an employee works authorised overtime and elects to receive time off in lieu rather than a financial overtime payment. TOIL accrues on a 1:1 basis — one hour of TOIL for each hour of authorised overtime worked. The maximum TOIL balance an employee may hold at any one time is 5 working days (40 hours). This maximum exists to ensure that TOIL is taken promptly — converting it into a meaningful rest period rather than allowing it to accumulate indefinitely. TOIL must be taken within 30 calendar days of accrual. The manager has an obligation to actively facilitate the employee taking TOIL within the 30-day window — operational pressure does not suspend this obligation.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Accrual rate	1 hour TOIL per 1 hour authorised overtime	Overtime must be pre-authorised in HRMS by line manager.
Minimum overtime block for TOIL	30 minutes — shorter periods tracked but combined with subsequent overtime to reach the minimum before TOIL credit is issued	Prevents administrative fragmentation of small TOIL credits.
Maximum TOIL balance	5 working days (40 hours) at any time	HRMS prevents additional TOIL accrual when maximum is reached. Manager must facilitate take-up before further overtime is authorised.
Take-up deadline	30 calendar days from date of overtime worked	Manager must actively facilitate. 30-day deadline flagged in HRMS at day 20 for manager action.
TOIL lapse on expiry	TOIL not taken within 30 days lapses without financial compensation in normal circumstances. Exceptional Finance-approved cash payment possible only where documented operational necessity prevented take-up.	HRBP must document the operational constraint before Finance approval is sought.
TOIL on separation	Accrued and unexpired TOIL at the date of separation is paid out in the Full and Final Settlement at the applicable overtime rate (basic salary ÷ 26 ÷ 8 × overtime hours × applicable state multiplier).	Finance calculates. Paid in FFS within 30 working days of last day.
Carry-forward at year end	Not applicable — TOIL is on a rolling 30-day cycle, not an annual cycle. No year-end lapse rule separate from the 30-day rule.	The 31 March year-end does not trigger TOIL lapse — only the 30-day accrual clock governs.

13.2 Recording, Lapse, and No-Encashment Rule

All TOIL accrual and take-up is recorded in HRMS under Attendance → TOIL Balance. The HRMS dashboard shows each employee's current TOIL balance, the accrual dates of outstanding TOIL, and the upcoming lapse dates for any TOIL approaching the 30-day deadline. Employees should monitor their own TOIL balance regularly. TOIL take-up is applied for as Compensatory Off in the HRMS leave module and requires manager approval in advance. TOIL that lapses because the employee did not take it — where there was no documented operational constraint — is not paid out and does not contribute to any other leave balance.

14. Sabbatical Leave

14.1 Purpose, Eligibility, and Duration

Sabbatical leave is an extended period of unpaid leave available to long-serving employees who wish to pursue a personal project, undertake intensive professional development, travel, volunteer at length for a charitable or civic cause, or attend to a significant personal life circumstance that cannot be accommodated within the standard leave provisions. Sabbatical leave is not an entitlement — it is a discretionary benefit subject to operational feasibility — but the company's starting position is to accommodate well-justified sabbatical applications from eligible employees wherever practicable.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Eligibility	5 continuous years of permanent employment on the application date	No more than one sabbatical in any 5-year period.
Duration	Minimum 4 weeks. Maximum 12 weeks.	Shorter career break needs are better addressed through LWOP provisions in Section 17.
Pay during sabbatical	Unpaid throughout — full CTC suspended for the sabbatical period	No merit increment accrues during sabbatical. Variable pay target calculation reflects actual working days.
Annual leave accrual	Suspended during the sabbatical period — annual leave does not accrue during unpaid leave	Annual leave accrual resumes from the date of return.
Role protection	The employee is entitled to return to their original role where practicable. Where the role has been eliminated for genuine operational reasons during the sabbatical, a suitable alternative role on equivalent terms must be offered.	Role changes during a sabbatical that are not operationally justified constitute adverse treatment on the basis of the leave and will be treated accordingly.
Benefits during sabbatical	Health insurance cover continues at the employee's expense during the sabbatical period. The company can arrange continued cover through the group policy at the employee's cost.	Pension and provident fund contributions are suspended. The employee may make voluntary PF contributions independently.
Application notice	Minimum 90 calendar days before intended start date	Allows the business to plan operational coverage.
Approval authority	Line manager + BU Head + VP-HR. CEO approval required for Band 5 and above.	Denial must be on documented operational grounds. Employee may reapply in the next quarter.

14.2 Application Process and Role Protection

Sabbatical leave is applied for through HRMS using Form HR-L07 at least 90 days before the intended start date. The application must describe the purpose of the sabbatical and the employee's intended activity during the period. The level of detail required is proportionate to the length — a 4-week sabbatical requires less documentation than a 12-week one. The HRBP facilitates a three-party discussion between the employee, the manager, and the BU Head to assess operational feasibility and agree a coverage plan before the application is approved. The Sabbatical Agreement — documenting the duration, unpaid status, role protection terms, and return conditions — is executed by the Legal team before the sabbatical begins.

15. Volunteer Leave

Every confirmed permanent employee at Arjun Technologies is entitled to 2 paid volunteer days per leave year to participate in approved corporate social responsibility or community service activities. Volunteer leave reflects the company's ESG commitment described in the Code of Conduct Section 12.2 and provides a practical mechanism for employees to contribute to the company's CSR objectives.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Annual entitlement	2 working days per leave year	All bands. Same for full-time and part-time employees.
Approved activities	Company-organised CSR programmes (digital literacy drives, accessible technology projects, environmental conservation). Independent volunteering with a registered not-for-profit organisation whose work aligns with the company's CSR focus areas.	Volunteering with political organisations, commercial entities, or causes unrelated to the CSR focus areas does not qualify.
Pre-approval requirement	Manager approval at least 5 working days in advance. For independent volunteering, HRBP confirmation that the organisation meets CSR focus area criteria.	Pre-approval is required to ensure the activity qualifies and to manage team availability.
Documentation	For company-organised activities: HRMS attendance at the event. For independent volunteering: completion letter from the NGO or organisation confirming participation, submitted to HRBP within 5 working days of the volunteer day.	Documentation is for CSR impact reporting — not for performance assessment.
Carry-forward	None — lapses on 31 March	Employees are encouraged to use volunteer leave in the year it is credited.
HRMS leave type code	VL (Volunteer Leave)	Applied through HRMS → My Leave → Apply for Leave → Volunteer Leave.
Interaction with annual leave	Volunteer leave does not affect annual leave balance. The 2 volunteer days are a separate entitlement.	Employees who wish to volunteer for more than 2 days may use annual leave or casual leave for additional days.

16. Fertility Treatment Leave

Fertility treatment leave is a dedicated provision recognising that assisted fertility treatment — in vitro fertilisation (IVF), intrauterine insemination (IUI), egg or sperm freezing procedures, and equivalent treatments — involves medical procedures, monitoring appointments, and recovery periods that require time away from work and that are not appropriately covered by sick leave (which is for illness, not for elective medical procedures) or casual leave (which is for brief unplanned personal needs). Fertility treatment is a deeply personal matter and this leave provision is administered with the highest standards of confidentiality.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Annual entitlement	5 working days per treatment cycle. Maximum 3 treatment cycles per leave year (15 days total).	Both the employee undergoing treatment and their partner/spouse are eligible for fertility treatment leave for the same treatment cycle — the employee for medical procedure and recovery days; the partner for appointment attendance and support.
Eligibility	All confirmed permanent employees	No minimum service condition beyond confirmation. No limitation by number of previous treatment attempts.
Approved purposes	IVF treatment cycle (stimulation, retrieval, transfer, and recovery). IUI procedure and recovery. Egg or sperm freezing procedure. Genetic testing appointment related to fertility treatment. Recovery from any procedure in the above categories.	Standard fertility monitoring appointments that do not require time away from work do not qualify — only procedures and recovery days.
Documentation	Medical confirmation of treatment from a registered fertility clinic or specialist, submitted to HRBP only — not to the line manager. Submitted before or within 5 working days of the leave being taken.	Documentation is maintained in the HRBP's confidential medical records. Line manager is told only the leave type and duration — no medical details. Under DPDP Act 2023, this data is treated as sensitive personal data.
Carry-forward	None — lapses on 31 March	Unused fertility treatment leave days do not carry forward. The per-cycle entitlement is available each leave year regardless of whether prior cycles were successful.
Confidentiality commitment	The company will not disclose any aspect of an employee's fertility treatment situation to any person other than the HRBP and, where strictly required for legal or insurance purposes, the General Counsel. Any disclosure beyond these parties is a serious conduct violation and a DPDP Act breach.	Employees should feel completely safe accessing this leave type without fear of disclosure.

17. Leave Without Pay (LWOP)

17.1 Eligibility, Approval, and Consequences

Leave Without Pay is available when an employee requires time away from work that cannot be covered by any available paid leave entitlement. LWOP is a last resort — the HRBP must confirm that all applicable paid entitlements have been considered and exhausted before LWOP is approved. LWOP is not an entitlement; it is a discretionary facility approved on a case-by-case basis. The company's starting position is to find a paid leave solution rather than directing an employee to LWOP, but genuine situations do arise where LWOP is the appropriate and only available option.

Unauthorised absence — where an employee fails to attend work without notification and without an approved leave type covering the absence — is automatically recorded as LWOP until the employee provides an explanation on return. Repeated unauthorised absence that remains unexplained after the employee has been given a reasonable opportunity to explain it is a conduct matter addressed through the disciplinary process in the Code of Conduct. LWOP is distinct from unauthorised absence — LWOP is approved in advance; unauthorised absence is not.

Attribute	Provision	Notes
Approval authority	Line manager + HRBP for up to 10 working days. BU Head + HRBP + VP-HR for 11–30 working days. CEO for more than 30 working days.	No approval guarantees future LWOP. Each request is assessed independently.
Application notice	Minimum 5 working days in advance where the need is anticipated. Where the need is genuinely unforeseeable, as soon as practicable.	Retrospective LWOP recording for genuinely unforeseeable events is accepted.
Pay during LWOP	Full CTC suspended for the LWOP period — no basic salary, no allowances, no variable pay accrual for the LWOP period.	LWOP days reduce the variable pay eligible service days for the performance year.
Annual leave accrual	Suspended during the LWOP period — annual leave does not accrue on LWOP days.	Annual leave accrual resumes from the date of return.
Sick leave, casual leave, and other entitlements	Suspended — leave balances do not accrue during LWOP.	The full entitlement for the leave year is not reduced, but accrual does not occur during LWOP for entitlements that are time-accrued.
Maximum LWOP in a rolling 12-month period	60 working days (approximately 3 months) — subject to approval	Requests above this require VP-HR and CEO approval and are rarely granted except for exceptional personal circumstances.

17.2 Benefits, Continuity of Service, and Return from LWOP

Health insurance cover under the company's group policy is maintained during LWOP for the first 30 calendar days of the LWOP period without additional cost to the employee. For LWOP periods extending beyond 30 days, the company can arrange continued group health insurance at the employee's cost. Provident Fund contributions are suspended during LWOP — neither employer nor employee contributions are made for LWOP days. This affects the employee's PF balance and should be factored into any decision to take extended LWOP.

Continuity of service is not broken by a period of LWOP for the purposes of annual leave entitlement and statutory rights that depend on continuous service (such as gratuity eligibility under the Payment of Gratuity Act 1972). However, LWOP days may not be counted as qualifying service for gratuity purposes — they count for continuity (the employment relationship is uninterrupted) but not for the quantum of gratuity (which is calculated on the basis of qualifying service, defined as actual working days). Employees should take advice from Finance before taking extended LWOP if this has a material impact on their gratuity position.

18. Public Holidays — National and State

All employees are entitled to paid public holidays comprising the three national holidays plus the applicable state-declared holidays for the state in which their office is located. The national holidays are Republic Day (26 January), Independence Day (15 August), and Gandhi Jayanti (2 October). State holidays vary by location and are published in the Annual Holiday List distributed to all employees by 15 January each year and available on the HRMS intranet.

Office Location	State	Typical Total Holidays/Year	State-Specific Key Holidays	Annual List Published By
Bengaluru (HQ)	Karnataka	14–16 days	Ugadi, Kannada Rajyotsava (01 Nov), Mysuru Dasara, Ganesh Chaturthi	15 January — HRMS intranet and HRBP notification
Hyderabad	Telangana	15–17 days	Ugadi, Bonalu, Milad-un-Nabi, Eid ul-Fitr, Eid ul-Adha (state observance dates)	15 January
Chennai	Tamil Nadu	14–16 days	Pongal (multi-day), Tamil New Year (Vishu), Karthigai Deepam, Thiruvalluvar Day	15 January
Mumbai / Pune	Maharashtra	14–16 days	Gudi Padwa, Dr. Ambedkar Jayanti, Maharashtra Din (01 May), Diwali Padwa	15 January
Gurugram / Noida	Delhi NCR (Haryana/UP)	14–16 days	Holi (Haryana/UP observance), Baisakhi, Haryana Heroes Martyrdom Day	15 January

Where an employee is required to work on a public holiday due to a specific and documented operational requirement, they receive either a full substitute holiday to be taken within 30 calendar days, or financial compensation at the applicable state overtime rate for all hours worked on the public holiday — whichever the employee prefers, subject to manager agreement. Substitute holidays and public holiday financial compensation are recorded and approved in HRMS in advance.

19. HRMS Leave Administration Framework

19.1 Leave Application and Approval Workflows

All leave at Arjun Technologies — except retrospective entries for unplanned absence where prior HRMS access was unavailable — must be applied for and approved through the HRMS leave management module. Paper applications are not accepted as a substitute for HRMS entries. The HRMS system maintains the official leave record and is the authoritative source for leave balances, approval history, and compliance reporting.

HRMS Action	Navigation Path	Required Before/By	Notes
Apply for planned leave	HRMS → My Leave → Apply for Leave → Select Leave Type → Enter dates → Submit	Before the leave starts. See notice requirements by leave type in each section.	System checks leave balance before allowing submission. Insufficient balance triggers an alert — employee may not proceed without HRBP approval for advance leave.
Apply for sick leave (retrospective)	HRMS → My Leave → Apply for Leave → Sick Leave → Select dates → Submit	Same day where possible. On return at latest.	Manager may submit on employee's behalf where employee is too unwell for HRMS access.
Apply for casual leave (same-day emergency)	HRMS Mobile App → Leave → Quick Apply → Casual Leave	Same day. Within 2 hours of absence where possible.	Mobile app available on iOS and Android. Offline entry syncs when connectivity is restored.
Manager approves or declines leave	HRMS → My Team → Leave Approvals → Pending → Approve / Decline with reason	Within the response timelines by leave type (Section 4.3 for annual leave). 2 working days for casual leave.	Declined applications require a documented reason. Employee is notified automatically by HRMS on approval or decline.
Manager records sick leave for uncontactable employee	HRMS → My Team → Attendance → [Employee] → Mark Absence → Sick Leave	On the day of absence where employee cannot self-record	This is a temporary record — employee must confirm or correct on return.
View leave balances	HRMS → My Leave → Leave Balances	Accessible at any time	Shows all leave types, current balance, accrual date, and any pending applications.
View team leave calendar	HRMS → My Team → Team Leave Calendar	Accessible at any time	Assists with scheduling and ensures minimum team coverage is maintained.
Access leave history report	HRMS → My Leave → Leave History → Select date range → Export	Accessible at any time	Exportable to PDF or Excel for personal record-keeping.

19.2 Manager Delegation and Calendar Visibility

When a manager is on leave or otherwise unavailable to respond to leave applications within the required timelines, the manager must designate a delegate approver through HRMS before the absence begins. The delegation is set up in HRMS under My Profile → Leave Approval Delegation → Set Delegate. The delegate must be at the same band level or above as the manager. Leave applications submitted to a delegated approver are processed with the same authority as applications approved by the manager directly. A manager who goes on leave without setting up a delegation and whose team members have pending leave applications that expire without a response has created an administrative failure that the HRBP will address on return.

The team leave calendar is accessible to all team members and to all managers. Team members can view who in their team is on leave on any given day, which assists with collaborative planning and ensures that coverage requirements are visible to everyone. The leave calendar does not display the type of leave taken by a colleague — it shows only that the colleague is on approved leave. Leave type confidentiality is maintained in all team-visible displays.

19.3 Compliance Reporting and Leave Audit Metrics

The HRMS leave module generates monthly compliance reports reviewed by HRBPs and quarterly summary reports reviewed by the VP-HR. The compliance metrics monitored include: leave application and approval timeliness; annual leave utilisation rate per team and business unit; sick leave frequency and average duration; Bradford Factor threshold alerts; TOIL accrual and take-up rates; and leave balance carry-forward levels at year end. The VP-HR presents an annual leave compliance summary to the Audit Committee as part of the HR governance report.

Compliance Metric	Threshold Triggering Review	Review Owner	Action
Annual leave utilisation	Team average below 70% by 31 December	HRBP with manager	Manager discussion on barriers to leave-taking. HRBP intervention if pattern persists.
Annual leave carry-forward	Individual carry-forward at maximum (10 days Bands 1–4; 12 days Band 5+) for two consecutive years	HRBP	Career wellbeing conversation. Identify and resolve barriers.
Bradford Factor alerts	Score above 100 — see Section 3.5 of Segment 1 for full escalation framework	Manager, then HRBP	Welfare conversation. EAP referral if appropriate.
TOIL lapse rate	More than 20% of TOIL credits lapsing in a team in any quarter	HRBP with BU Head	Manager training on overtime and TOIL facilitation obligation.
Sick leave exhaustion	Employee reaches 12-day sick leave limit	HRBP	Long-term sick leave process (Segment 1, Section 5.5). Occupational health referral considered.
Unapproved leave incidence	More than 2 unapproved absence instances for any employee in a 6-month period	Manager, then HRBP	Manager conduct conversation. Escalate to HRBP if pattern continues.
Annual leave encashment above ■1,00,000	Any individual encashment above this threshold at year end	HRBP + Finance	Verify leave records. Confirm eligibility. Finance authorises payment.

20. Special Situation Leave Provisions

The following provisions address leave situations that do not fall neatly into the standard leave types and that require specific guidance to ensure consistent and fair application across the organisation.

Situation	Applicable Leave Type	Specific Provisions	HRBP Involvement
Leave during a disciplinary investigation or proceeding	Employee may take approved leave during an investigation if they are genuinely entitled to it and it was planned before the investigation began. Leave may not be used to avoid investigation obligations.	Pre-approved leave that pre-dates the investigation proceeds normally. New leave applications during an active investigation are reviewed by the HRBP before approval. An employee who is suspended with pay during an investigation continues to receive their CTC — suspended employees do not take annual leave during the suspension period.	HRBP reviews all new leave applications for employees under active investigation.
Jury duty or court attendance as a witness	Paid civic duty leave — separate entitlement not deducted from any leave balance.	Up to 10 working days per year for jury service (uncommon in India but applicable where called) or court attendance as a witness. Subpoena or court summons required. Full pay maintained. Court attendance in personal legal matters (as a party to litigation) is not covered — annual or casual leave applies.	HRBP informed. Court summons submitted to HRBP within 2 working days of receipt.
Natural disaster, civic emergency, or public order disruption preventing travel to work	Paid emergency leave — separate from all other leave types. Not deducted from any balance.	Up to 3 days where the declared emergency or public order situation in the employee's city or travel corridor genuinely prevents safe travel to or productive work from the office. Manager and HRBP must confirm the situation applies. Employees who can work from home during the emergency are expected to do so.	HRBP coordinates with Facilities and managers for consistent application across the affected office.
Leave for a religious observance not covered by the state public holiday schedule	Annual leave or casual leave — no separate religious observance entitlement beyond the state holiday schedule.	Employees whose significant religious observance falls on a working day not covered by the office's state public holiday list may apply for annual or casual leave for that day. The manager approves on the same basis as any other annual or casual leave application — the religious nature of the observance is not a ground for declining.	No HRBP involvement unless the manager declines a religious observance leave request, in which case HRBP reviews for potential discrimination.
Leave for an employee on a long-term client site assignment	All standard leave types apply — the client site location does not change the leave entitlement.	Leave applications for employees on client sites are approved by the line manager in HRMS in the usual way. The account manager is notified of the leave to manage client coverage. The employee is not required to seek separate client approval to take their contracted leave entitlement.	No HRBP involvement unless a conflict arises between leave entitlement and client contract requirements — in which case Legal team guidance is sought.
Leave interaction with a performance improvement plan	All standard leave types remain fully available during an active PIP.	An active PIP does not restrict an employee's leave entitlements. Pre-approved leave that pre-dates the PIP proceeds normally. Leave taken during a PIP does not extend the PIP period — the PIP timeline is based on calendar days and PIP check-ins are rescheduled around approved leave. Merit increment is paused during the active PIP (PMP Segment 2, Section 11.5) but leave entitlements are unaffected.	HRBP ensures PIP timeline and leave calendar are co-ordinated. PIP check-ins rescheduled promptly when leave overlaps.

21. Leave Policy Governance and Compliance

The Leave and Attendance Policy is owned by the Vice President of Human Resources, with legal compliance oversight by the General Counsel. It is reviewed annually in January and February for a 01 April effective date, following the same process as the Performance Management Policy and Code of Conduct. Material changes are communicated to all employees by individual email before the effective date with a summary of the change. Minor editorial changes are communicated through the quarterly HR newsletter.

Governance Element	Responsible Party	Frequency	Output
Annual leave utilisation analysis	HR Business Partners	Annually — January report for prior year	BU-level report to VP-HR. Action plans for business units with chronic under-utilisation.
State statutory compliance review	General Counsel + HRBP Operations	Annually — Q3 (October) for following year effectiveness	Updated State Compliance Table (Appendix D). Policy amendments where statutory changes require them.
Bradford Factor and sick leave pattern review	HRBPs	Monthly	Threshold alerts actioned per Section 3.5 of Segment 1.
Leave record audit	Finance + HRBP Operations	Quarterly	Reconciliation of HRMS leave records against payroll deductions. Corrections processed in following payroll cycle.
Annual leave encashment calculation and payment	Finance	Annually — April payroll	HRMS-generated encashment list reviewed by HRBP and Finance before payment authorisation.
Policy acknowledgement compliance	HRBP Operations	Annually — May, confirming acknowledgements from prior April refresh	Employees with outstanding acknowledgements notified and followed up. Non-completion escalated to line manager.
Audit Committee leave governance summary	VP-HR + General Counsel	Annually — Q3 Board cycle	Leave policy compliance, statutory incidents, and any material leave-related employment claims or disputes reported to Audit Committee.
Employee leave query resolution	HR Business Partners	Ongoing	All leave queries acknowledged within 2 working days. Substantive response within 5 working days.

21.1 Leave Policy Compliance — Employee and Manager Obligations Summary

The following table consolidates the key compliance obligations under this policy into a single reference for employees and managers. It cross-references the relevant policy section for each obligation.

Obligation	Who It Applies To	Policy Reference	Consequence of Non-Compliance
Apply for all leave through HRMS before the leave begins (or same-day for unplanned absence)	All employees	Sections 4.3, 5.3, 6.2, and each leave type section	Absence recorded as unauthorised LWOP until explained. Repeated non-compliance is a Code of Conduct conduct issue.
Record leave using the correct leave type for the nature of the absence	All employees	Sections 5.1, 6.1, and Code of Conduct Section 4.2	Misuse of leave type is a falsification of a company record — a Code of Conduct integrity matter.
Notify the manager directly (by call or message) before or at start time on any day of unplanned absence	All employees	Segment 1, Section 3.4	Absence treated as unauthorised LWOP until notified. Repeated non-notification is a conduct issue.
Submit a medical certificate from the 4th consecutive sick day	All employees	Segment 1, Section 5.4	Sick leave without required certificate converted to annual leave or LWOP. Repeated failure may trigger modified certification requirement.

Obligation	Who It Applies To	Policy Reference	Consequence of Non-Compliance
Apply for annual leave with the required minimum notice period	All employees	Segment 1, Section 4.3	Leave taken without approval is LWOP. Repeated unapproved leave is a conduct matter.
Respond to leave applications within the required timeline (2–5 working days by leave type)	All managers	Segment 1, Section 4.3; Segment 2, Section 19.1	HRMS compliance report flags overdue approvals. Escalated to BU Head. Repeated failures noted in manager performance assessment.
Set a leave approval delegate before going on leave	All managers	Segment 2, Section 19.2	Team leave applications may be left unanswered during manager absence. HRBP escalation on return.
Conduct a return-to-work conversation after sick leave of 3+ days	All managers	Segment 1, Section 5.8 (PMP reference)	Welfare record gap. HRMS compliance report flags missing return-to-work records.
Monitor Bradford Factor alerts and take welfare action	All managers	Segment 1, Section 3.5	Unacted alerts escalated by HRBP. Failure to act on persistent attendance patterns is a management obligation failure.
Submit medical documentation for maternity, adoption, caregiver, or fertility treatment leave to HRBP within specified timelines	All employees using these leave types	Sections 7.2, 9.2, 11.2, 16	Leave record incomplete without documentation. HRBP follows up. No adverse consequence for genuine delay — only for repeated failure.
Not discourage, pressure, or penalise employees for taking any leave entitlement	All managers	Code of Conduct Section 19.2; Maternity Benefit Act 1961 (for maternity leave specifically)	Serious misconduct under the Code of Conduct. Potential criminal liability under the Maternity Benefit Act for maternity-related adverse treatment.
Handle all health-related leave data in accordance with DPDP Act 2023 and company data privacy policy	All managers and HRBPs	Segment 1, Section 3.9	DPDP Act breach. IT Security and Legal notification required. Potential regulatory penalty.

21.2 Leave and Attendance Common Scenarios — Segment 2 Reference

The following scenarios address the most frequently escalated leave management situations related to the leave types covered in this segment. For Segment 1 leave type scenarios (annual leave, sick leave, casual leave), see Segment 1 Section 6.4 and the FAQ section.

Scenario	Facts	Correct Action and Policy Basis
1 — Maternity leave and redundancy	A company restructuring is announced while an employee is on maternity leave. Her role is identified as potentially at risk.	The employee on maternity leave has the same rights as any other employee in a redundancy process — she may not be treated less favourably because she is on leave. If her role is eliminated, she must be offered a suitable alternative before any other at-risk employee where one exists. The HRBP and Legal team must be involved from the outset. Any redundancy decision made without their input where a maternity leave employee is involved carries significant legal risk. (Section 7.5 and Maternity Benefit Act Section 12)

Scenario	Facts	Correct Action and Policy Basis
2 — Employee requests sabbatical but manager declines without reason	A Band 4 employee with 6 years of service applies for a 6-week sabbatical. The manager declines without explanation via HRMS.	Sabbatical leave requires documented operational grounds for decline. A bare decline in HRMS without a reason is not sufficient. The employee should request the reason from the manager. If no adequate reason is provided, the employee escalates to the HRBP. The HRBP facilitates the three-party discussion that the policy requires before any approval or denial. (Section 14.2)
3 — Bereavement leave for an estranged parent	An employee whose father they were estranged from passes away. The manager queries whether estrangement affects the bereavement leave entitlement.	Bereavement leave for a parent is a 5-day entitlement with no qualifying condition relating to the quality of the relationship. The manager should approve the leave immediately and without comment on the personal circumstances. (Section 10.1)
4 — Fertility treatment leave disclosure to colleagues	A manager tells two colleagues that an employee is absent for fertility treatment, after the employee had used Form HR-L09A and disclosed only to the HRBP.	This is a serious breach of the confidentiality obligations in Section 16 and the DPDP Act 2023 — health data disclosed without consent. The manager should have been told only the leave type and duration, not the specific treatment. The employee should report the disclosure to the VP-HR or the Whistleblower hotline immediately. The manager faces potential disciplinary action and the company faces a DPDP Act data breach notification obligation. (Section 16 and Segment 1, Section 3.9)
5 — TOIL not facilitated — operational excuse	An employee has 5 days of TOIL that is approaching the 30-day take-up deadline. The manager says the project is too busy for the employee to take time off.	The 30-day TOIL take-up obligation cannot be suspended by operational pressure. The manager has an obligation to facilitate TOIL take-up within the window. If genuine operational necessity has prevented take-up, the HRBP and Finance must be informed before the TOIL lapses to assess whether an exceptional cash payment is warranted. TOIL that lapses because the manager failed to facilitate it — without the Finance exception process — may entitle the employee to a cash payment equivalent. (Section 13.1)
6 — Employee on sabbatical contacted about work	An employee is on a 10-week unpaid sabbatical. Three weeks in, the BU Head calls them to discuss a project issue.	The employee has no obligation to be available during the sabbatical period. The sabbatical is precisely the arrangement the company agreed to — a complete break from work obligations for the defined period. The BU Head should manage the situation through available team resources. If a genuine emergency requires their involvement, the HRBP and the employee must agree in writing to any temporary engagement and the appropriate compensation for that engagement. (Section 14.2)

Segment 2 Leave Types — Complete At-a-Glance Reference

The following table summarises all leave types covered in Segment 2 side by side. For the three core leave types in Segment 1 (annual leave, sick leave, casual leave), see the equivalent table at the end of Segment 1.

Leave Type	Entitlement	Paid?	Carry-Fwd	Encashable	Form	Section
Maternity Leave	26 wks (1st/2nd child); 12 wks (3rd+); 14 wks (adoption <1yr)	Yes — full CTC	N/A	No	HR-L01	S7
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Yes — full CTC	N/A — must use within 90 days	No	HR-L02	S8
Adoption Leave	14 wks primary (<1yr child); 8 wks primary (1yr+); 10 days secondary	Yes — full CTC	N/A	No	HR-L03	S9
Bereavement Leave	5 days (spouse/child/parent/sibling); 3 days (grandparent); 2 days (extended family)	Yes — full CTC	N/A	No	HR-L04	S10
Caregiver Leave	5 working days per year	Yes — full CTC	None — lapses 31 Mar	No	HR-L05	S11
Study Leave	Up to 10 working days per year across all exams	Yes — full CTC	None — lapses 31 Mar	No	HR-L06	S12
Compensatory Off (TOIL)	Per authorised overtime (1:1). Max 5-day balance.	N/A — time off in lieu	30-day rolling window only	No (exceptional Finance approval only)	HRMS TOIL	S13
Sabbatical Leave	4–12 weeks (5+ yrs service)	Unpaid	N/A	No	HR-L07	S14
Volunteer Leave	2 working days per year	Yes — full CTC	None — lapses 31 Mar	No	HR-L08	S15
Fertility Treatment Leave	5 days per cycle; max 3 cycles per year (15 days total)	Yes — full CTC	None — lapses 31 Mar	No	HR-L09A	S16
Leave Without Pay (LWOP)	Discretionary — max 60 working days in 12 months	Unpaid	N/A	No	HR-L09	S17
Public Holidays	3 national + state holidays per office location (approx 14–17 days)	Yes	N/A	No	Annual List	S18

Complete Policy Summary — Both Segments

Segment	Sections	Key Topics	Pages	Status
Segment 1	1–6 + Extended Provisions	VP-HR Message · Purpose and Scope · Statutory Comparison · Attendance Framework · Hybrid Model by Band · Bradford Factor Escalation · Annual Leave (full) · Sick Leave (full) · Casual Leave (full) · Remote Working · Overtime and TOIL Overview · Leave Blackout Periods · Advance Leave · Mental Health and EAP · Return to Work · Leave Data Privacy (DPDP Act 2023) · Worked Scenarios · FAQ · Manager Checklist · Leave Entitlement Quick Reference	1–40	Published April 2024

Segment	Sections	Key Topics	Pages	Status
Segment 2 — This Document	7–21 + Appendices A–F	Maternity · Paternity · Adoption · Bereavement · Caregiver · Study · TOIL · Sabbatical · Volunteer · Fertility Treatment · LWOP · Public Holidays · HRMS Administration · Special Situations · Governance and Compliance · Compliance Obligations Table · Segment 2 Scenarios · All Forms HR-L01 to HR-L09A · Manager Approval Guide · HRMS Quick Reference · State Compliance Table · Leave Year Planner · Acknowledgement Form	41–80	Published April 2024

All segments are available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. For queries contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner. For concerns about fair application of this policy: ethics@arjuntech.in (24/7, anonymous).

Leave Interaction Matrix — When Leave Types Overlap

The following matrix addresses how different leave types interact when they overlap or when an employee needs to transition between types. These situations arise more frequently than might be expected and generate a disproportionate share of leave queries to HR Business Partners.

Situation	Leave Type A	Leave Type B	Correct Treatment
Employee falls ill during annual leave	Annual leave (pre-approved)	Sick leave	Annual leave converts to sick leave from the day illness begins, subject to medical certification where required. The converted annual leave days are reinstated to the annual leave balance. Manager and HRBP must be notified on the day of illness. HRMS entry updated by HRBP on return. The employee does not lose annual leave days due to genuine illness during a pre-approved leave period.
Public holiday falls during annual leave	Annual leave	Public holiday	Public holidays that fall during annual leave are treated as annual leave days in the standard position under most state SE Acts applicable to our operating locations. The public holiday does not substitute for annual leave — the annual leave balance is still debited for the holiday day. Where an employee believes this is incorrect for their state, the HRBP confirms the applicable state position.
Employee becomes pregnant during a sabbatical	Sabbatical leave (unpaid)	Maternity leave	Maternity leave entitlement arises independently of the sabbatical. The employee may transition from sabbatical to paid maternity leave as soon as the maternity leave eligibility conditions are met. The sabbatical period and the maternity leave run sequentially — the employee is not required to return from sabbatical before maternity leave begins. HRBP manages the transition.
Sick leave exhausted — illness continues	Sick leave (12-day balance exhausted)	Annual leave or LWOP	Once the 12-day sick leave entitlement is exhausted, continued absence is covered by annual leave at the employee's request, or LWOP if no annual leave balance remains. The HRBP manages the transition at day 12. Employees are not automatically moved to LWOP — the annual leave bridge option is always offered first. (Segment 1, Section 5.5)
Bereavement leave during annual leave	Annual leave (pre-approved)	Bereavement leave	If a bereavement occurs during a pre-approved annual leave period, the annual leave converts to bereavement leave for the bereavement period. The converted annual leave days are reinstated. Manager notified. HRMS updated by HRBP on return. The employee should not lose annual leave days because of a bereavement that occurs during a holiday.
Caregiver leave needed after all 5 days are exhausted in the year	Caregiver leave (exhausted)	Casual leave or annual leave	Once the 5-day caregiver leave entitlement for the year is exhausted, further caregiver absences must be covered by casual leave (up to 3 consecutive days) or annual leave. Where the caregiving requirement is ongoing and substantial, the HRBP discusses whether a temporary flexible working arrangement under the Disability and Reasonable Adjustment Policy may better address the situation.
Employee on paternity leave falls ill	Paternity leave	Sick leave	Paternity leave is a specific entitlement for a specific purpose. If the employee falls ill during paternity leave, the illness does not convert the paternity leave to sick leave — paternity leave continues. The employee may, however, take additional sick leave after the paternity leave period ends where illness continues. (Section 8.1)
TOIL and annual leave requested for the same period	TOIL (compensatory off)	Annual leave	TOIL is applied before annual leave where the employee has both available and wishes to use the combined period as a single absence block. TOIL must be used within its 30-day window — where the requested period is beyond the TOIL window, annual leave applies for the days outside the window. HRMS allows combined leave types for a single continuous absence period.

HR and Escalation Contact Directory — Leave and Attendance

The following directory provides the primary contact for each category of leave and attendance query. Direct the query to the most specific contact first — general leave queries that are not specific to a named leave type go to the HRBP.

Query Category	Primary Contact	Contact Method	Response Time
General leave entitlement query	HR Business Partner	Direct email or HRMS message to named HRBP	2 working days
Leave balance discrepancy	HRBP + HRMS Helpdesk	Email to HRBP with HRMS screenshot of discrepancy	3 working days for investigation and correction
Maternity, adoption, or paternity leave planning	HRBP directly	In-person or video meeting preferred	2 working days for initial meeting
Fertility treatment leave (confidential)	HRBP only — not line manager	Direct email to named HRBP from employee email	1 working day acknowledgement
Bereavement leave (urgent, same day)	Line manager by call or message	Phone or WhatsApp — not email alone	Immediate. Manager enters leave in HRMS.
Bradford Factor or attendance management concern	HRBP	Email to HRBP with context	2 working days for guidance
LWOP application	HRBP for initial assessment	HRMS Form HR-L09 + HRBP email	3 working days initial response
Sabbatical application	HRBP for three-party process facilitation	Submit HR-L07 via HRMS and email HRBP	20 working days for three-party discussion
State-specific leave compliance query	General Counsel or HRBP	legal@arjuntech.in or HRBP	3 working days
Manager discouraging leave or unfair application	VP-HR or Whistleblower hotline	vp-hr@arjuntech.in or ethics@arjuntech.in (24/7, anonymous)	3 working days acknowledgement
HRMS system issue (leave module)	IT Support	itsupport@arjuntech.in or extension 1000	1 working day
Maternity discrimination or adverse treatment complaint	VP-HR directly	vp-hr@arjuntech.in or ethics@arjuntech.in	1 working day acknowledgement — urgent

Appendix A: Leave Application Forms — HR-L01 to HR-L09A

The following forms are available on the HRMS portal under HR Services → Leave Management. All leave must be applied for through HRMS — paper forms are provided here as a reference and for use only where HRMS access is genuinely unavailable. Completed paper forms must be submitted to the HRBP within 2 working days of HRMS access being restored.

Form Reference	Leave Type	Key Fields	Submit To	Response Timeline
HR-L01	Maternity Leave	Employee name and ID. Expected delivery date or adoption handover date. Intended leave start date. Duration requested. Healthcare provider confirmation attached.	HRBP directly. Not to line manager.	HRBP acknowledges within 2 working days. Entitlement confirmed in writing within 5 working days.
HR-L02	Paternity Leave	Employee name and ID. Birth/handover date. Intended leave dates (1 or 2 blocks of 5 days each). Birth/adoption documentation.	Line manager via HRMS.	Manager response within 2 working days.
HR-L03	Adoption Leave	Employee name and ID. Caregiver role (primary or secondary). Child age at handover. Legal adoption documentation reference.	HRBP for primary caregiver. Line manager for secondary caregiver.	HRBP acknowledgement within 2 working days.
HR-L04	Bereavement Leave	Employee name and ID. Name of deceased and relationship. Dates of absence. Death certificate (submitted on return — not required before leave begins).	Line manager — retrospective entry on return.	Automatic approval for all bereavement leave within entitlement.
HR-L05	Caregiver Leave	Employee name and ID. Dependent's relationship. Leave dates requested. Medical confirmation of dependent's condition (confidential — to HRBP only).	Line manager in HRMS. Medical documentation to HRBP separately.	Manager response within 1 working day. HRBP confirms documentation within 5 working days of first use.
HR-L06	Study Leave	Employee name and ID. Examination name, body, and date. Relevance to role. Admission letter attached.	Line manager and HRBP via HRMS.	Response within 3 working days.
HR-L07	Sabbatical Leave	Employee name and ID. Intended start and end dates. Purpose of sabbatical (brief description). Service tenure confirmation.	HRBP for facilitation of three-party discussion. Submitted 90 days before start.	Three-party discussion within 20 working days. Formal decision within 30 working days of application.
HR-L08	Volunteer Leave	Employee name and ID. Activity and organisation. Date requested. Organisation CSR alignment (pre-confirmed with HRBP for independent activities).	Line manager via HRMS.	Manager response within 2 working days.
HR-L09	Leave Without Pay	Employee name and ID. Reason for LWOP request. Dates and duration. Confirmation that all applicable paid leave has been exhausted.	HRBP for initial assessment, then line manager and BU Head as per approval authority.	HRBP initial response within 3 working days. Full approval decision within 10 working days.
HR-L09A	Fertility Treatment Leave	Employee name and ID. Treatment type (no specific medical detail required). Treatment dates. Clinic confirmation (to HRBP only — not to line manager).	HRBP only — strictly confidential.	HRBP acknowledges within 1 working day. Leave recorded in HRMS without disclosing type to manager.

Appendix B: Manager Leave Approval Guide

This guide provides managers with the key actions, decisions, and obligations at each stage of the leave management process. It is a reference tool — the full provisions are in the relevant policy sections.

Stage	Manager Action	Key Decision	Common Error to Avoid
Leave application received	Review the HRMS application within the response timeline. Check team leave calendar for coverage. Assess operational impact.	Approve or decline with documented reason. Cannot decline without operational justification.	Delaying response beyond the timeline (2 working days for casual, 3 working days for annual leave). Declining without a specific reason.
Annual leave — long duration (2+ weeks)	Discuss operational coverage plan with the employee. Consider whether workload needs to be redistributed. Notify the BU Head for Band 5+ employees.	Approve with coverage plan in place. Decline only where specific operational constraint applies and an alternative period is offered within 60 days.	Declining without proposing an alternative within 60 days. Allowing workload pressure to create an informal culture where long leave is never taken.
Sick leave notification received	Acknowledge promptly. Mark the day in HRMS if the employee cannot self-record. No interrogation of the nature of the illness.	Accept the notification. Request a medical certificate only where the self-certification threshold (3 days) is exceeded.	Asking the employee to describe their symptoms. Contacting the employee excessively during sick absence. Mentioning their sick leave in a performance context.
Return from sick leave (3+ days)	Conduct a return-to-work conversation within the first half-day of return. Private, warm, and brief for shorter absences. More structured for longer absences.	Confirm fitness. Identify any support needs or adjustments. No interrogation.	Skipping the return conversation. Using the conversation to discuss performance or conduct concerns unrelated to the absence.
Bradford Factor alert received from HRMS	Review the employee's attendance record context. Does the pattern have a plausible explanation? Book a private welfare check-in.	Supportive welfare conversation. Offer EAP if appropriate. Document in HRMS.	Treating the Bradford Factor score as a disciplinary trigger rather than a welfare signal. Not acting on the alert.
Maternity/adoption leave start	Confirm coverage plan is in place. Ensure no business-critical dependencies rest solely on the employee's availability during leave. Brief team as appropriate.	Approve and plan. No contact with the employee during leave except at her invitation.	Contacting the employee during maternity leave about work matters. Making role changes during the leave without HRBP involvement.
Employee returning from maternity leave	Contact at least 4 weeks before return. Discuss any adjustments, flexible working, and nursing breaks.	Accommodate reasonable flexible working requests. Role protection obligation applies.	Offering a different or diminished role on return. Failing to discuss adjustments proactively.
Leave balance near carry-forward limit by December	Proactively discuss leave plans with team members whose balances are approaching the carry-forward limit.	Help the employee plan leave before year end. Ensure operational constraints do not systematically prevent leave-taking.	Doing nothing and allowing leave to lapse because no one planned it. This is a management failure.

Manager Annual Leave Checklist — Segment 2 Leave Types

The following checklist supplements the core Manager Leave Approval Guide above, focusing specifically on the Segment 2 leave types that generate the most management queries. It is a quarterly self-assessment tool.

Obligation	Self-Check Question	If No — Required Action
Maternity leave planning	Have I proactively discussed return-to-work arrangements with any team member due to return from maternity leave within the next 6 weeks?	Contact the employee at least 4 weeks before return date. Schedule a return-to-work planning meeting. Discuss adjustments, nursing breaks, and any flexible working request.
Paternity leave facilitation	Have I approved all pending paternity leave applications within 2 working days of receipt?	Review pending applications in HRMS. Approve without delay. Paternity leave is a company commitment — approval is not discretionary.
Bereavement leave response	Did I respond immediately and compassionately to every bereavement notification received in the last quarter, with no delay or request for documentation before the leave started?	Review any bereavement situations in the last quarter. If documentation was requested before leave was approved, note this as an error and ensure it does not recur.
TOIL facilitation	Have I actively facilitated TOIL take-up within the 30-day window for all team members with accrued TOIL?	Check HRMS TOIL balances for all team members. Schedule TOIL take-up for anyone approaching the 30-day deadline. TOIL that lapses due to management failure creates a compensation liability.
Caregiver leave privacy	Have I maintained strict confidentiality about the nature of any caregiver leave taken by team members — disclosing only leave type and duration to payroll as required?	If any caregiver leave medical information was shared beyond the HRBP, notify the HRBP immediately for DPDP Act assessment.
Study leave support	Have I approved all eligible study leave applications submitted with the required minimum notice and supporting documentation?	Review any declined study leave applications. Ensure declines were on documented operational grounds with an alternative period offered.
Volunteer leave encouragement	Have all team members been made aware of their 2-day volunteer leave entitlement and how to access company CSR programmes?	Send a team communication about the volunteer leave benefit and the CSR programme options. Ensure the HRMS leave type is available and visible to the team.
Leave record accuracy (Segment 2 types)	Are all Segment 2 leave records for my team (maternity, paternity, adoption, bereavement, caregiver, study, TOIL, sabbatical, volunteer, fertility treatment) current and accurate in HRMS?	Review HRMS leave history for each team member. Contact HRBP to correct any records that are inaccurate or incomplete.

Appendix C: HRMS Leave Module Quick Reference

The following table covers the most frequently used HRMS actions in the leave module. For full documentation, access HRMS Help Centre at hrms.arjuntech.in/help. For system issues, contact itsupport@arjuntech.in or extension 1000.

Task	Navigation Path	When	Common Issue / Fix
Apply for annual leave	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Annual Leave → Select dates → Submit	Before leave starts — see notice requirements (Section 4.3 of Segment 1)	System shows insufficient balance: check accrual date. Contact HRBP for advance leave approval.
Apply for sick leave (planned absence — e.g. surgery)	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Sick Leave → Select dates → Submit	As soon as the absence is confirmed	Same as annual leave application.
Apply for sick leave (same-day unplanned)	HRMS Mobile App → Leave → Quick Apply → Sick Leave	On the day of absence	Mobile app offline mode: entry syncs on reconnection. Manager may record on your behalf if you cannot access HRMS.
Apply for casual leave	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Casual Leave → Select dates → Submit (or Mobile App Quick Apply)	2+ hours advance where possible. Same-day accepted.	Cannot apply for more than 3 consecutive days of casual leave — system blocks submission. Use annual leave for 4+ consecutive days.
Apply for TOIL (compensatory off take-up)	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Compensatory Off → Select dates → Submit	Before the TOIL take-up date	TOIL balance must exist before application. Check TOIL balance in Attendance → TOIL Balance.
View all leave balances	My Leave → Leave Balances	Anytime	Balance as of today. Future accruals not yet credited are not shown.
View team leave calendar (managers)	My Team → Team Leave Calendar → Select date range	Anytime — useful for planning leave approvals	Shows leave by employee. Leave type not shown for privacy.
Approve or decline a leave application	My Team → Leave Approvals → Pending Applications → Approve or Decline with reason	Within response timelines by leave type	Declined applications must have a documented reason. HRMS does not allow decline without reason entry.
Set leave approval delegate (during own leave)	My Profile → Settings → Leave Approval Delegation → Add Delegate → Set dates	Before going on leave	Delegate must be same band or above. Cannot delegate to a direct report.
Record Bradford Factor score for team member	My Team → Attendance → [Employee Name] → Bradford Factor History	Available at any time for managers	Score is calculated automatically — managers cannot edit it. Query data errors with HRBP.
Submit a leave form (HR-L01 to HR-L09A) as an attachment	My Leave → Apply for Leave → [Leave Type] → Attach Document → Upload PDF	When submitting forms for maternity, adoption, sabbatical, LWOP, etc.	Maximum file size: 10 MB. PDF format required. Scanned documents accepted.
View leave history report	My Leave → Leave History → Select date range → Export	Anytime	Export to PDF or Excel. Includes all leave types, dates, approval status, and balance changes.
View public holiday schedule	HRMS Intranet → Leave → Annual Holiday List → [Select Location]	Published by 15 January each year	If your location is not listed, contact HRBP. New office locations are added by February.

Appendix D: State-Specific Leave Compliance Table (Complete)

The following table sets out the statutory leave requirements for each state of operation as at April 2024, and confirms the company provision against each. Where the company provision exceeds the statutory minimum, the company provision applies. Where the statutory minimum exceeds the company provision (which applies in limited specific circumstances), the statutory minimum applies. The Legal team updates this table annually. State-specific queries should be directed to the HRBP or the General Counsel.

Leave Type	Karnataka (SE Act 1961)	Telangana (SE Act 1988)	Tamil Nadu (SE Act 1947)	Maharashtra (SE Act 1948)	Delhi NCR (SE Act 1954)	Company Provision
Annual/Earned/Privilege Leave	1 day per 20 days worked. Min 12 days/year after 240 working days.	1 day per 20 days worked. 15 days/year after 240 working days.	1 day per 20 days worked. 12 days after 240 working days.	1 day per 20 days worked. 12 days after 240 working days.	1 day per 20 days worked. 12 days/year.	21 days (Bands 1–4); 24 days (Band 5+). More generous than all state minima.
Sick Leave	12 days/year	12 days/year	12 days/year (with certificate from day 1 in some sectors)	12 days/year	12 days/year	12 days/year — matches state minimum.
Casual Leave	12 days/year (Karnataka SE Act)	10 days/year	12 days/year	12 days/year (from Jan 2023 amendment)	12 days/year	8 days/year — below Karnataka and other state statutory minimums. NOTE: Employees are entitled to the statutory minimum where state law prescribes more than 8 days. HRBP confirms applicable state entitlement where relevant.
National Holidays	3 (mandatory)	3 (mandatory)	3 (mandatory)	3 (mandatory)	3 (mandatory)	3 national + state holidays — compliant.
Maternity Leave	As per Maternity Benefit Act 1961 — 26/12 weeks	As per MBA — 26/12 weeks	As per MBA — 26/12 weeks	As per MBA — 26/12 weeks	As per MBA — 26/12 weeks	26/12/14 weeks as per MBA plus company adoption provisions. Fully compliant.
Paternity Leave	No statutory requirement	No statutory requirement	No statutory requirement	No statutory requirement	No statutory requirement	10 working days company benefit. Exceeds all state requirements (none).
Max Working Hours / Week	48 hours	48 hours	45 hours	48 hours	48 hours	45 hours standard — compliant with all states. Tamil Nadu 45-hour limit specifically observed.
Overtime Rate	2x basic rate	2x basic rate	2x basic rate	2x basic rate	2x basic rate	2x basic rate applied in all states — fully compliant.

IMPORTANT — Casual Leave statutory position: The company's 8-day casual leave provision is below the statutory minimum of 12 days under the Karnataka Shops and Establishments Act 1961. Employees working in Karnataka offices are entitled to the statutory minimum of 12 days casual leave under the Act. The HRBP ensures that Karnataka-based employees receive the statutory entitlement. This applies to Bengaluru HQ employees. HRMS records for Karnataka employees are configured to reflect the statutory 12-day entitlement. This table note applies equally to any other state where the state casual leave minimum exceeds 8 days.

Appendix E: Annual Leave Year Planner Template

This planner supports employees and managers in planning the use of annual leave across the leave year (01 April to 31 March). It is a planning tool — the HRMS leave module is the authoritative record of all leave taken and approved. This template is available as an editable Excel file on the HRMS portal under HR Services → Leave Management → Leave Planner Template.

Month	Working Days	Public Holidays	Net Working Days	Planned Annual Leave Days	Planned Other Leave	Cumulative AL Taken	Remaining AL Balance
April	22	0 (varies by state)	22				21 days (or 24 days Band 5+) — full year credited 01 April
May	23	1 (varies)	22				
June	22	0	22				
July	23	1 (varies)	22				
August	23	1 (Independence Day 15 Aug)	22				
September	22	0	22				
October	23	2 (Gandhi Jayanti 02 Oct + state holiday)	21				
November	22	1 (varies by state — e.g. Kannada Rajyotsava in Bengaluru)	21				
December	22	0	22				
January	23	1 (Republic Day 26 Jan)	22				
February	20	0	20				
March	21	0	21				
TOTALS	266	Approx 7–9 national + state (varies by location)	Approx 257–259	Target: use all 21/24 days			Balance at 31 March: carry forward up to 10/12 days

Planning guidance: Aim to take at least 3 blocks of leave during the year — one in the first half (April to September) and one in the second half (October to March), with the third block at the employee's preference. This pattern helps ensure that the full entitlement is used, prevents excessive year-end accumulation, and supports the personal rest and recuperation purpose of annual leave. Employees who anticipate difficulty using their full entitlement due to project commitments should discuss their leave plan with their manager and HRBP by July at the latest, so that mitigation options can be identified before the year-end encashment window.

Appendix F: Policy Acknowledgement and Complete Document Summary

This acknowledgement form is completed by all employees through the annual SEC-101 Policy Refresher module in HRMS. New joiners complete within 5 working days of joining through HRMS under Policies and Documents. The acknowledgement confirms receipt and understanding — it does not waive any statutory rights.

LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY ACKNOWLEDGEMENT — HR-LAP-001-v3.2
I confirm that I have received, read, and understood both segments of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2, effective 01 April 2024. I understand my leave entitlements, the attendance obligations applicable to my role, and the processes for applying for and recording leave through HRMS.
Full Name (print clearly): _____ Employee ID: _____ Band: ___
Office Location: _____ Employment Type: ● Permanent ● Fixed-Term
Signature: _____ Date: _____
HRMS SEC-101 Completion Reference: _____ Acknowledged by HRBP: _____

Complete Document Summary — Leave and Attendance Policy v3.2

Segment	Sections Covered	Key Topics	Pages	Status
Segment 1	1–6	VP-HR Message · Purpose and Scope · Statutory Comparison Table · Attendance Framework · Working Hours · Hybrid Model · Bradford Factor · Annual Leave (full) · Sick Leave (full) · Casual Leave (full) · Remote Working Provisions · TOIL Framework · Blackout Periods · Privacy and DPDP Act · Scenarios · FAQ · Manager Checklist	1–40	Published April 2024
Segment 2 — This Document	7–21 + Appendices A–F	Maternity · Paternity · Adoption · Bereavement · Caregiver · Study · Compensatory Off · Sabbatical · Volunteer · Fertility Treatment · LWOP · Public Holidays · HRMS Administration · Special Situations · Governance · All Forms HR-L01 to HR-L09A · Manager Approval Guide · HRMS Quick Reference · State Compliance Table · Leave Planner · Acknowledgement Form	41–80	Published April 2024

Complete Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework — Document Reference: HR-LAP-001-v3.2. Owner: Ms. Priya Menon, Vice President — Human Resources. Legal Review: Mr. Sandeep Iyer, General Counsel. Approved: Mr. Rajesh Arjun, Chief Executive Officer. Effective: 01 April 2024. Both segments available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. For queries contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner. For anonymous reporting of concerns about the fair application of this policy: ethics@arjuntech.in (24/7, anonymous).

Leave Policy Version History — Segment 2 Topics

The following table records the development of the Segment 2 leave types across the policy version history. It complements the full revision history in Segment 1.

Version	Date	Segment 2 Development
1.0	Apr 2009	Maternity leave provisions per pre-2017 Act (12 weeks). No paternity leave. Basic bereavement leave (3 days across all categories). No caregiver, study, sabbatical, or fertility treatment provisions.
1.1	Sep 2010	Paternity leave introduced as a company benefit — 5 working days. Bereavement leave expanded with relationship-differentiated entitlements.

Version	Date	Segment 2 Development
1.3	Nov 2013	Adoption leave introduced for primary caregiver. Sabbatical leave pilot introduced for Band 6 and above only.
1.4	Jun 2015	Maternity Benefit Amendment Act 2017 provisions incorporated ahead of enactment — maternity leave extended to 26 weeks in the policy in preparation for statutory change.
2.0	Jan 2017	Paternity leave extended to 10 working days. Sabbatical leave extended to all bands with 5+ years service. Volunteer leave introduced (1 day per year). TOIL provisions formalised.
2.1	Aug 2018	Study leave introduced with 10-day annual maximum. Caregiver leave introduced (3 days per year — later increased). Bond provisions for sponsored study formalised.
2.3	Oct 2021	Fertility treatment leave introduced explicitly as a named provision. Caregiver leave extended from 3 to 5 days per year. Mental health leave provisions referenced in bereavement and caregiver context.
3.1	Oct 2022	Volunteer leave increased from 1 to 2 days per year. LWOP maximum period formalised at 60 working days.
3.2 — Current	Apr 2024	Fertility treatment leave confidentiality provisions updated for DPDP Act 2023. State compliance table updated for Telangana SE Act amendments. Leave interaction matrix added as new reference tool.

HR-LAP-001-v3.2 | Leave and Attendance Policy — Segment 2 of 2 | Effective 01 April 2024 | Owner: Ms. Priya Menon, VP HR | Legal Review: Mr. Sandeep Iyer | Approved: Mr. Rajesh Arjun, CEO | For queries: hr@arjuntech.in

Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Bengaluru, Karnataka — 560 001

CIN: U72200KA2008PTC044521 | www.arjuntech.in

LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY AND PROCEDURES FRAMEWORK

Segment 3 of 4 — International and Expatriate Leave · Long-Term Absence Management · Leave During Organisational Change · Workforce-Specific Provisions · HRMS Administration Manual · Appendices G–J

Version	3.2	**Effective Date**	01 April 2024
Review Date	31 March 2025	**Classification**	Internal Use Only
Approved By	Mr. Rajesh Arjun	**Document Owner**	Ms. Priya Menon
Legal Review	Mr. Sandeep Iyer	**Department**	Human Resources & Legal
Doc Reference	HR-LAP-001-v3.2	**Applies To**	All Employees
Segment	3 of 4 (Pages 81–120)	**Total Segments**	4

This is Segment 3 of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2. It covers five specialist areas that require dedicated treatment beyond the core provisions in Segments 1 and 2: international and expatriate employee leave provisions; the long-term absence management framework including occupational health integration and phased return protocols; leave management during organisational change including restructuring, acquisitions, and rapid growth; workforce-specific leave provisions for campus hires, graduate trainees, fixed-term employees, and part-time workers; and the complete HRMS leave administration manual for managers and employees covering every system function in the leave module. Appendices G through J provide the Occupational Health Referral Form, the Long-Term Absence Review Record, the International Assignment Leave Summary Sheet, and the Annual Leave Compliance Self-Audit Tool. This segment must be read alongside Segments 1 and 2. For queries contact hr@arjuntech.in or your HR Business Partner.

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Appendix H — Long-Term Absence Review Record (HR-L21)
Appendix I — International Assignment Leave Summary Sheet (HR-L22)
Appendix J — Annual Leave Compliance Self-Audit Tool

22. International and Expatriate Employee Leave Provisions

22.1 Scope — Who Is an International or Expatriate Employee

International and expatriate leave provisions apply to three categories of employee whose leave management has cross-border dimensions. The first category is inbound expatriates — nationals of other countries employed by Arjun Technologies in India on a formal assignment or long-term employment contract, typically on an Employment Pass or other applicable visa. The second category is outbound assignees — Indian nationals employed by Arjun Technologies who are assigned to work in another country for a defined period under an international assignment agreement. The third category is permanent foreign national employees — nationals of other countries who have taken up permanent employment in India at an Arjun Technologies office location, without a defined assignment end date, and whose leave entitlements are governed by Indian employment law in the same way as Indian national employees but who may have specific leave needs related to their home country.

The complexity of international leave management arises from the interaction between the leave entitlements under Indian law (which apply to all employees working in India regardless of nationality), the leave provisions of the international assignment agreement (which may provide home country entitlements that are more generous than the Indian statutory minimum), the tax and social security implications of leave taken across jurisdictions, and the operational challenge of managing leave records across multiple payroll and HRMS systems where the employee spans two jurisdictions. Every international employee situation is to some degree unique, and the HRBP and Legal team must be involved in the leave administration from the start of the assignment.

Category	Leave Entitlement Basis	Payroll Administration	HRMS Recording	Primary Contact
Inbound expatriate on assignment agreement	Greater of: Indian statutory entitlement OR assignment agreement home country entitlement. Explicit in the assignment letter.	India payroll for Indian employment income. Home country payroll continuation where applicable per assignment agreement.	Indian HRMS as primary leave record. Shadow record maintained in Finance spreadsheet where home country leave runs concurrently.	HRBP + International Mobility team (Finance)
Inbound expatriate on permanent contract (no assignment agreement)	Indian statutory entitlement as per this policy. No home country entitlement applies.	India payroll only.	Standard HRMS leave record as for Indian national employees.	HRBP
Outbound assignee (Indian national in another country)	Greater of: host country statutory entitlement OR Indian employment contract entitlement. Assignment agreement governs.	India payroll maintained (shadow payroll in host country where required by local law).	Indian HRMS where India payroll is primary. Host country HR system where host payroll is primary.	HRBP + International Mobility team + host country HR contact
Foreign national permanent employee (working in India)	Indian statutory entitlement — identical to Indian national employees at the same band.	India payroll.	Standard HRMS leave record.	HRBP

22.2 Home Country Annual Leave — Entitlement and Interaction

Many assignment agreements provide the assignee with their home country annual leave entitlement rather than, or in addition to, the Indian statutory entitlement. This is particularly common where the home country entitlement is more generous than the Indian provision — for example, European home countries typically provide 25–30 days of annual leave compared to the Indian statutory 12–21 days. The assignment agreement is the authoritative source for the applicable annual leave entitlement during the assignment period. The HRBP reviews the assignment agreement with the Finance International Mobility team before the assignment begins to confirm the applicable entitlement and ensure HRMS is configured to reflect it correctly.

Where an assignment agreement provides a home country annual leave entitlement that is higher than the company standard for the equivalent Indian band, the higher entitlement applies for the duration of the assignment. On completion of the assignment and transition to a standard Indian employment contract, the entitlement reverts to the standard band entitlement. Any accrued home country entitlement not taken at the end of the assignment is settled per the terms of the assignment agreement — typically either encashed at the home country daily rate or carried into the post-assignment period for a defined window.

Home Country	Typical Annual Leave Entitlement	Interaction with Indian Provision	Assignment Agreement Treatment
United Kingdom	28 days statutory minimum (including public holidays)	UK entitlement typically higher than Indian band 1-4 standard (21 days). Assignment agreement provides UK equivalent.	UK entitlement applies during assignment. Indian entitlement applies post-assignment.
Germany	24 days statutory (20 working days minimum by law, employer practice typically higher)	German entitlement approximately equivalent to Indian Band 5+ (24 days). Company applies higher of the two.	Assignment agreement specifies. Finance confirms applicable entitlement.
Singapore	14 days (after 8 years service). 7 days in first year, increasing annually.	Singapore entitlement below Indian company provision in most cases. Indian company provision applies as it is more favourable.	Indian provision applies where more generous.
United States	No federal statutory minimum — company policy governs (typically 10–20 days)	US entitlement varies by company. Assignment agreement specifies. Indian statutory minimum always applies as a floor.	Greater of US company entitlement or Indian entitlement applies.
Australia	20 days statutory (4 weeks)	Approximately equivalent to Indian Band 1-4 (21 days). Company provides whichever is higher.	Assignment agreement specifies. HRBP confirms.

22.3 Long-Haul Travel Allowance Leave (LHTAL)

Long-Haul Travel Allowance Leave is an additional paid leave entitlement available to international employees and assignees who must travel to their home country during the annual leave period. It recognises the significant travel time involved in long-haul international journeys, which substantially reduces the effective rest value of annual leave when a significant portion of the leave period is consumed by travel. LHTAL is not an additional holiday entitlement — it is compensation for travel time that would otherwise eat into the rest and recuperation purpose of annual leave.

Journey Distance	LHTAL Entitlement per Round Trip	Maximum per Year	Conditions
Under 4 hours flight time one way (e.g. India to Singapore, UAE)	Not applicable — no LHTAL	Not applicable	Standard annual leave applies.
4–8 hours flight time one way (e.g. India to UK, Central Europe)	1 day each way — 2 days per round trip	4 days per year (2 return trips)	Flight booking evidence required. Leave taken immediately before or after the travel day. Cannot be taken separately from annual leave.
8–12 hours flight time one way (e.g. India to USA East Coast, Australia)	1.5 days each way — 3 days per round trip	6 days per year (2 return trips)	Same conditions as above. HRBP confirms flight duration eligibility.
Above 12 hours flight time one way	2 days each way — 4 days per round trip	8 days per year (2 return trips)	Flight itinerary required. HRBP approval.

22.4 Home Country National Holidays — Policy Position

International employees working in India observe the Indian national and state public holidays applicable to their office location, as published in the Annual Holiday List. They do not receive additional paid leave for home country national holidays (Christmas Day for a UK national, Thanksgiving for a US national, etc.) beyond those that happen to coincide with Indian public holiday observances. An international employee who wishes to observe a home country national holiday that falls on a working day under the Indian holiday schedule may apply for annual leave or casual leave for that day, subject to the standard approval process. The manager should approach such requests with the same presumption of accommodation that applies to any religious or cultural observance leave request under Section 20 of Segment 2.

22.5 International Assignment Leave — Coordination Framework

An outbound assignee on a formal international assignment continues to accrue annual leave at the Indian entitlement rate (or the higher assignment agreement rate if applicable) throughout the assignment period. The assignment agreement specifies the mechanics of leave accrual, the applicable leave year, and the treatment of unused leave at the end of the assignment. The HRBP and the International Mobility team (Finance) maintain the leave record across both the Indian HRMS and the host country HR system for the duration of the assignment.

Assignment Stage	Leave Administration Action	HRMS Action	Finance Action
Assignment start	HRBP confirms applicable annual leave entitlement for the assignment period. Assignment agreement leave clause reviewed and recorded.	HRMS leave type and balance configured to reflect assignment agreement entitlement. Assignment record created.	Finance confirms payroll jurisdiction. Shadow payroll set up in host country where required. Leave liability recorded in both jurisdictions.
During assignment (annual)	Leave applications approved by both the host country assignment manager and the India HRBP for leaves of 5+ working days.	Leave recorded in Indian HRMS as the primary record. Host country HR notified of leave dates.	Leave entitlement cost allocated to the assignment cost centre. Encashment calculations use the applicable daily rate per assignment agreement.
Assignment end — leave balance	HRBP and Finance calculate the accrued leave balance at assignment end. Options: take outstanding leave before repatriation, encash at assignment daily rate, or carry into post-assignment employment.	HRMS balance updated on repatriation to reflect any leave settlement.	Leave encashment on assignment end settled in Full and Final Assignment Settlement. Tax treatment confirmed by Finance.
Repatriation to Indian employment	Leave entitlement reverts to standard Indian band entitlement from first day of post-assignment Indian employment.	HRMS reconfigured to standard Indian band entitlement. Previous assignment record archived.	Leave liability transitions back to standard Indian payroll treatment.

22.6 Shadow Payroll and Cross-Border Leave Administration

Where an outbound assignee remains on the Indian payroll while working in a host country that requires local payroll reporting (for social security, income tax, or labour law purposes), a shadow payroll is maintained in the host country by the Finance International Mobility team. Leave taken during the assignment must be reflected in both the Indian HRMS record and the host country shadow payroll record. The Finance team reconciles the two records quarterly and resolves any discrepancies before the annual statutory filing in each jurisdiction. Employees with cross-border payroll situations should direct all leave queries to the HRBP rather than attempting to resolve discrepancies between systems independently.

23. Long-Term Absence Management

23.1 Definition and Triggers for Formal Management

Long-term absence is defined for the purposes of this policy as any continuous absence of 15 or more working days due to illness, injury, or a health condition. This definition applies whether the absence is covered by the sick leave entitlement, annual leave used as a bridge, or leave without pay after entitlements are exhausted. The 15-working-day threshold is the point at which the HRBP takes over the active management of the absence from the line manager, the occupational health referral process becomes available, and the formal Long-Term Absence Review cycle begins. The line manager remains involved and informed throughout, but the coordination responsibility moves to the HRBP to ensure that the process is managed consistently and with appropriate professional support.

The distinction between short-term and long-term absence management is not primarily about the duration of the absence — it reflects a fundamental difference in what effective management looks like at each stage. Short-term absence management (the Bradford Factor monitoring described in Segment 1, Section 3.5) is primarily about identifying patterns that may indicate a concern and addressing them through a welfare conversation. Long-term absence management is primarily about supporting the employee through a significant health event, maintaining the employment relationship across what may be an extended period, facilitating a safe and sustainable return to work, and managing the operational consequences for the team and the business while treating the absent employee with the dignity and care their situation requires.

Absence Day	Trigger	Action Required	Owner
Day 1	Sick leave absence begins	Manager notification received. HRMS sick leave entry. Return-to-work welfare check planned.	Line manager
Day 4	Medical certificate required from this day	Manager requests certificate on return or monitors receipt during absence.	Line manager
Day 8	Extended absence developing	Manager notifies HRBP. HRBP begins informal monitoring. Employee welfare checked by HRBP if not already in contact.	Line manager notifies HRBP
Day 15	Long-term absence threshold reached	HRBP takes over active management. First formal Long-Term Absence Review scheduled. Occupational health referral considered.	HRBP
Day 30	One month continuous absence	Second formal review. Occupational health report expected if referral was made. Leave bridge and LWOP position assessed.	HRBP
Day 60	Two months continuous absence	Third formal review. Capability assessment initiated if no clear return timeline. Legal team consulted on employment position.	HRBP + Legal team
Day 90+	Three months continuous absence	Capability review completed. Employment position assessed formally with Legal. Board-level awareness for Band 5+.	HRBP + Legal + VP-HR

23.2 Occupational Health Integration — When and How to Refer

An occupational health referral is the mechanism through which the company obtains an independent, medically informed assessment of an employee's fitness for work, the likely duration and trajectory of their absence, and the adjustments or modifications that might facilitate an earlier or more sustainable return. Occupational health is not a tool for managing employees out of employment — it is a genuine support mechanism that helps both the employee and the company understand the health situation more clearly and plan the return to work more effectively than either the treating clinician (who focuses on the patient's health) or the manager (who lacks medical expertise) can do independently.

The company uses a panel of approved occupational health providers with specialist expertise in workplace health assessment. The HRBP arranges the referral through the approved provider at the 15-day threshold where there is no clear return date, or earlier where the nature of the condition suggests an occupational health assessment would be immediately valuable. The employee's consent is required for the occupational health referral — the referral cannot be made against the employee's explicit objection. However, the HRBP explains clearly that the occupational health assessment is in the employee's interest and that refusal to engage with the process may limit the company's ability to provide effective support or to plan for the employee's return.

Element	Standard	Notes
Consent requirement	Employee must provide written consent before the referral is made. Consent form included in Appendix G (HR-L20).	The HRBP explains the purpose and scope of the assessment before seeking consent. Consent covers both the referral and the sharing of the report with the company.
Referral letter content	The HRBP prepares the referral letter covering: employee name and role, nature of absence, duration to date, any known diagnosis (if shared by the employee), the specific questions the company needs the occupational health assessment to answer.	The referral letter must not ask the occupational health provider to determine whether the employee should continue in employment — that is an HR and management decision. The OHP answers questions about fitness and adjustments.
Report turnaround	Standard: 10 working days from appointment. Urgent (Day 30+ absence): 5 working days.	HRBP chases at day 7 if no report received.
Report sharing	The occupational health report is shared with: the HRBP (full report), the line manager (management recommendations section only — not full medical detail), and the employee (full report, before it is shared with the company).	The employee has the right to see the report before the company does. If the employee objects to any part of the report, they may request an amendment from the OHP before the report is shared.
Action following the report	HRBP and manager review the report findings and recommendations. Return-to-work plan or reasonable adjustment plan developed within 5 working days of report receipt.	The company is not legally obliged to implement every occupational health recommendation — the obligation is to consider recommendations seriously and to document the reasons where they are not implemented.

23.3 The Long-Term Absence Review Process

Formal Long-Term Absence Reviews are conducted at the 15-day, 30-day, and 60-day thresholds, and monthly thereafter while the absence continues. Each review is a documented conversation between the HRBP and the employee — typically by telephone or video call where the employee is too unwell to attend an in-person meeting, and always at a time and format that is manageable for the employee given their health condition. The review is never a pressure exercise — it is a genuine welfare check that also gathers the information the company needs to manage the situation operationally and to support the employee appropriately.

Review Stage	Purpose	Content	Documentation
15-Day Review (First Formal Review)	Understand the situation. Initiate occupational health process. Assess leave position.	Welfare check. Nature of absence discussed to the extent the employee is comfortable. Expected return date if known. Occupational health referral offered and explained. Current leave balance and remaining entitlement explained. Operational coverage arrangements discussed with manager separately.	HR-L21 Long-Term Absence Review Record (Appendix H). Shared with employee. HRBP retains copy.
30-Day Review	Update on health trajectory. Review occupational health report if received. Plan leave bridge if sick leave exhausted.	Health update. OHP report findings discussed if available. Leave balance reviewed — if sick leave exhausted, annual leave bridge offered. Return date or timeline discussed.	HR-L21 updated. OHP report filed confidentially in HRBP records.

Review Stage	Purpose	Content	Documentation
60-Day Review	Formal capability assessment trigger if no return timeline. Legal position assessed.	Health update and prognosis from OHP. Return-to-work timeline and plan if available. Capability procedure explained if no realistic return timeline exists. Legal team involved.	HR-L21 updated. HRBP records capability review initiation if applicable. Legal team consultation note filed.
Monthly reviews (Day 61+)	Maintain contact, welfare, and employment position management.	Ongoing welfare check. Leave position update. Employment position discussed. Any change in health status or return timeline.	HR-L21 updated monthly. VP-HR informed of all cases beyond 90 days.

23.4 Phased Return to Work — Design, Duration, and Documentation

A phased return to work is a temporary, structured arrangement under which an employee returning from a long-term absence works reduced hours or has a modified scope of responsibilities for a defined transitional period before resuming their full contracted hours and role. It is not a leave type — it is a temporary adjustment to the working pattern. During the phased return period, the employee is paid their full contracted salary for the entire period, regardless of the hours worked, as long as the phased return is within the approved duration limits.

The phased return plan is developed collaboratively between the HRBP, the line manager, the employee, and — where an occupational health assessment has been completed — the occupational health provider. The plan specifies: the start date and the end date of the phased return period; the working hours or scope for each phase; the review checkpoints at which the plan will be assessed and potentially adjusted; and the conditions under which the return will be extended, shortened, or converted to a permanent reasonable adjustment.

Absence Duration Before Return	Typical Phased Return Duration	Phase 1 Hours	Phase 2 Hours	Full Return
15–30 working days	Up to 2 weeks	5–6 hours/day for Week 1	Full hours from Week 2	End of Week 2
31–60 working days	2–4 weeks	4 hours/day for Weeks 1–2	6 hours/day for Weeks 3–4	End of Week 4
61–90 working days	4–6 weeks	3–4 hours/day for Weeks 1–2. 5–6 hours/day for Weeks 3–4.	Full hours from Week 5	End of Week 6
More than 90 working days	Up to 8 weeks with VP-HR approval. Beyond 8 weeks assessed as potential permanent adjustment.	Occupational health recommendation determines initial hours.	Progressive increase per OHP and HRBP plan.	OHP and HRBP confirm fitness for full return.
Mental health related absence (any duration)	As recommended by occupational health or treating clinician. Flexibility in phased return design is particularly important for mental health conditions.	Occupational health recommendation	As plan progresses	Gradual and supported.

23.5 Ill-Health Retirement and Capability-Based Separation

Where a long-term absence is caused by a condition that, on the medical evidence available, is not likely to permit a return to work within a reasonable period or at all, the company must manage the situation through either the ill-health retirement framework (for eligible employees who have reached a qualifying age or service period under the applicable pension arrangement) or the capability procedure. Capability-based separation — the termination of employment on the grounds that the employee is no longer capable of performing the role due to long-term ill health — is a serious

and consequential step that requires the highest standards of procedural fairness, legal compliance, and genuine human care. It is never initiated lightly and is always the last resort after all reasonable adjustments and return pathways have been genuinely explored.

The Legal team must be involved from the outset of any capability process involving long-term illness. The applicable procedural requirements under the Industrial Disputes Act 1947, the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016, and the applicable state Shops and Establishments Act vary by employee category and state of employment. VP-HR approval is required before any capability process proceeds to the separation stage. The company provides a capability separation package that recognises the employee's service, the involuntary nature of the health condition, and the genuine difficulty of the situation.

23.6 Legal Framework — Employment Protection During Long-Term Absence

Legal Provision	Effect on Long-Term Absence Management	Practical Implication
Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016	Where a long-term health condition constitutes a disability under the Act, the company has enhanced obligations to make reasonable adjustments before any capability-related action.	HRBP and Legal confirm whether the condition meets the RPwD Act definition before capability process begins. Adjustment record must demonstrate that all reasonable adjustments were genuinely considered.
Industrial Disputes Act 1947 (workman employees)	Workman employees (as defined by the Act) have additional procedural protections in any termination — including capability termination. Retrenchment compensation provisions may apply.	Legal team confirms workman status before any termination step. Compensation calculation performed by Finance with Legal guidance.
Maternity Benefit Act 1961	An employee who is absent on maternity leave may not be dismissed during or for any reason directly connected to the maternity leave.	Long-term absence that begins during a maternity leave period is managed after the maternity leave period ends, not concurrently. Legal team confirms position.
Mental health conditions and stigma	No specific mental health employment protection legislation in India at the time of this policy, but the company applies the Code of Conduct anti-discrimination provisions and the RPwD Act where the condition constitutes a covered disability.	Mental health absence is managed with the same procedural care as physical illness absence. No adverse inference from the nature of the condition. HRBP ensures consistency.
DPDP Act 2023 — health data	All health data collected during long-term absence management (medical certificates, OHP reports, review records) is sensitive personal data requiring strict handling.	Access limited to HRBP and Legal only. Not shared with line manager beyond management recommendations. Retained per the data retention schedule in Segment 1, Section 3.9.

24. Leave Management During Organisational Change

24.1 Leave Continuity During Restructuring and Role Changes

Organisational restructuring — changes to reporting lines, business unit boundaries, role definitions, or office locations — does not affect leave entitlements. An employee's accrued annual leave balance, approved leave, and pending leave applications are not affected by any restructuring event and remain fully valid under the new reporting arrangement. Pre-approved leave that pre-dates the restructuring must be honoured by the new reporting manager — no employee should have previously approved leave rescinded solely as a result of a management change or restructuring.

Where a restructuring involves an employee moving to a new business unit, office location, or reporting line mid-year, the HRBP manages the transfer of leave records to ensure continuity. The employee's HRMS leave record moves with them — it is not reset to zero on a team transfer. The new manager is briefed on the employee's current leave balance and any approved leave during the handover process. Where a restructuring involves a change of employment terms (e.g. a change of contract from fixed-term to permanent), the leave entitlement is adjusted accordingly from the effective date of the new contract.

24.2 Leave Entitlements for Acquired and Integrated Employees

When Arjun Technologies acquires another company or integrates a team of employees from a partner organisation, the leave entitlements of the acquired employees are managed through a formal transition process overseen by the VP-HR and the HRBP. The transition process addresses three questions: what leave entitlements did the acquired employees have under their previous employer; what are the equivalent entitlements under the Arjun Technologies policy; and how is any gap or excess between the two positions treated during and after the transition period.

Scenario	Treatment	Transition Period	HRMS Configuration
Acquired employee had higher annual leave entitlement than Arjun Technologies standard for their band	Existing entitlement is preserved for the current leave year. Entitlement transitions to the Arjun Technologies band standard from the start of the following leave year. No reduction mid-year.	Current leave year: existing entitlement applies. From 01 April following acquisition: standard band entitlement.	HRMS configured with transitional entitlement by HRBP. Annotation records basis for higher entitlement.
Acquired employee had lower annual leave entitlement than Arjun Technologies standard	Entitlement upgrades to the Arjun Technologies standard immediately from the date of employment commencement with Arjun Technologies.	Immediate — no transition period needed.	HRMS configured at standard band entitlement from employment start date.
Acquired employee had accrued leave balance under previous employer	Accrued leave balance under the previous employer is recognised and credited to the employee as an opening balance in HRMS. The previous employer is responsible for encashing leave from their payroll; Arjun Technologies credits the leave as an opening balance without a corresponding payment.	Opening balance transferred on first day of Arjun Technologies employment.	HRMS opening balance manually entered by HRBP. Basis documented in HR Notes.
Acquired employee had different sick leave entitlement	Sick leave entitlement transitions to the Arjun Technologies 12-day standard immediately. Sick leave does not carry an accrued balance to transfer.	Immediate.	Standard sick leave entitlement configured from Day One.

24.3 Leave Management During Rapid Headcount Growth

Periods of rapid headcount growth — when the company is hiring significantly to meet expanded client commitments or to enter new markets — create specific leave administration challenges. The volume of new joiner leave records

being created in HRMS increases substantially, leave balance proration calculations are required for a large number of employees simultaneously, and the onboarding and induction workload on HRBPs and managers is elevated. The HRMS system handles proration and entitlement creation automatically for standard joiners, but HRBP oversight is required to verify configurations and to manage exceptions — particularly for senior hires, international joiners, and joiners with non-standard contract terms.

The Leave Administration Operations team (within the HRBP Operations function) conducts a monthly new joiner leave audit during high-growth periods, verifying that the HRMS leave entitlement configured for each new joiner in the preceding month matches the entitlement specified in their offer letter and employment contract. Any discrepancy identified is corrected in the same month and the affected employee is notified. The monthly audit report is reviewed by the VP-HR and forms part of the quarterly leave compliance reporting to the Audit Committee.

24.4 Leave Implications of Redundancy Processes

When an employee is made redundant, their leave position at the date of termination requires careful calculation and settlement as part of the Full and Final Settlement. The leave settlement in a redundancy must account for: any accrued but untaken annual leave (paid out at the daily encashment rate, as in any separation); any annual leave that was taken in advance of accrual during the current leave year (recovered from the settlement at the same daily rate); the interaction between the notice period and any leave during notice; and the treatment of TOIL balances.

Leave Item	Treatment in Redundancy	Calculation Basis	Settlement Document
Accrued annual leave (not yet taken)	Paid out in Full and Final Settlement. Entitlement regardless of service tenure for redundancy separation.	Days accrued to date of termination × (monthly basic salary ÷ 26).	FFS leave encashment line item.
Annual leave taken in advance of accrual (negative balance)	Recovered from FFS at the same daily rate as the encashment calculation.	Negative balance days × (monthly basic salary ÷ 26). Deducted from FFS.	FFS leave recovery line item.
Annual leave during notice period	Employee may be directed to take approved leave during notice to reduce the cash leave settlement at separation.	Leave taken during notice is deducted from the leave balance before FFS calculation.	Manager and HRBP confirm leave taken during notice in HRMS before FFS is generated.
TOIL balance at redundancy	Accrued TOIL that has not yet been taken is paid out at the applicable overtime rate.	TOIL hours × (basic salary ÷ 26 ÷ 8) × applicable state overtime multiplier.	FFS TOIL settlement line item.
Sick leave balance	Not paid out — sick leave is a protection entitlement, not deferred pay. No settlement for unused sick leave.	Not applicable.	Not included in FFS.
Pro-rated variable pay for the leave year	Variable pay for the period of service in the current performance year is included in the FFS, calculated on the basis of actual service days.	Target variable pay × CPF × IPM × (service days in the year ÷ 365).	FFS variable pay settlement line item. Finance confirms CPF and IPM assumptions.

25. Workforce-Specific Leave Provisions

25.1 Campus Hires and Graduate Trainees — Modified Leave Structure

Campus hires and graduate trainees joining through the company's campus recruitment programme are subject to the standard leave entitlements from their first day of employment — annual leave accrues at the standard Band 1 rate of 1.75 days per completed calendar month, sick leave is credited at 1 day per completed calendar month, and casual leave is pro-rated. However, the specific context of campus hire joiners — who typically join in cohorts in June or July, who are in their first professional employment, and who are undergoing an intensive induction and training programme in their first three months — creates specific practical considerations for leave management that differ from lateral hire management.

Provision	Campus Hire Position	Rationale	Manager Guidance
Annual leave during first 3 months (induction period)	Annual leave applications during the first 3 months are assessed with the training programme schedule as the primary consideration. Leave is not prohibited but applications during scheduled induction modules are strongly discouraged.	The induction programme is structured with interdependent content — absence from a module reduces the value of subsequent modules. Group cohort learning is disrupted by individual absences.	Manager discusses any leave application during the induction period with the campus programme coordinator before approving. Medical or genuine emergency leave is always approved.
Casual leave — first month	Casual leave is available from Day One but its use in the first month is discussed informally with the buddy and manager to ensure the leave purpose is understood.	New professional employees may not initially understand the distinction between leave types. First-month guidance helps establish correct leave habits.	Buddy raises the leave types topic informally in the first week. Not a restriction — educational.
Annual leave planning	Campus cohort annual leave is coordinated by the HRBP in consultation with the campus programme coordinator to avoid the entire cohort taking leave simultaneously.	Cohort learning activities require minimum attendance for effectiveness.	HRBP circulates a suggested leave window for the cohort at the start of the programme. Individual applications within this window are approved automatically.

25.2 Fixed-Term Contract Employees — Leave on Non-Renewal

Fixed-term contract employees are entitled to the same leave provisions as permanent employees for the duration of their contract. On contract expiry — where the contract simply ends without renewal — the leave settlement provisions follow the same framework as resignation: all accrued and untaken annual leave is paid out in the Full and Final Settlement at the standard daily encashment rate. Where the contract is renewed, the leave balance carries forward into the renewed contract period without interruption — a renewed fixed-term contract does not reset the leave balance.

Fixed-term employees who are offered permanent employment during or at the end of their fixed-term contract transition into permanent employment without a leave balance reset. The transition date is treated as a continuity of employment for all leave purposes — the employee's leave accrual, service tenure for encashment eligibility, and carry-forward rights continue without interruption. The employment type change is recorded in HRMS by the HRBP and the leave record is updated to reflect permanent employment entitlements from the transition date.

25.3 Part-Time and Job-Share Employees — Detailed Calculation

The general principle for part-time leave calculations — that each leave day represents one of the employee's contracted working days, regardless of the duration of those days — is established in Segment 1. This section provides the detailed calculation methodology for the most common part-time patterns encountered at the company.

Working Pattern	Annual Leave Days	Sick Leave Days	Casual Leave Days	Calculation Notes
5 days/week (full-time standard)	21 days (Band 1–4) / 24 days (Band 5+)	12 days	8 days (12 in Karnataka)	Standard entitlement — no adjustment.
4 days/week (80% FTE)	21 days (Band 1–4)	12 days	8 days	Each leave day = 1 contracted day. No adjustment to number of leave days. Leave deducted on working days only — non-working day absences not deducted.
3 days/week (60% FTE)	21 days (Band 1–4)	12 days	8 days	Same day-count basis. Each leave day = 1 contracted day. Employee effectively gets 7 weeks of leave at their contracted 3-day pattern (21 ÷ 3 = 7 weeks).
Compressed week (4 x 10-hour days)	21 days (Band 1–4)	12 days	8 days	Leave deducted on working days only. Non-working day (typically Friday) not a leave day. Each leave day = 1 contracted 10-hour day.
Job-share (two employees sharing one role)	Each employee receives their full band entitlement independently	Each employee receives 12 days independently	Each employee receives 8 days independently	Leave is not shared between job-share partners. Each employee manages their own leave balance. Co-ordination on leave timing is the employees' and manager's responsibility.
Term-time only (school hours/term schedule)	Full annual leave entitlement applies during contracted term periods. Non-term periods are non-working periods (unpaid) — no leave deduction for non-term weeks.	Sick leave applies during contracted term periods only.	Casual leave during contracted term periods.	The employment contract specifies the contracted term schedule. HRMS configured with working and non-working periods.

25.4 Employees Returning from Career Breaks

An employee returning from an approved career break (sabbatical leave under Section 14 of Segment 2, or an extended period of LWOP approved for a personal reason) requires a structured reintegration that recognises the length of their absence and the adjustments that may be needed to their working environment and expectations. The reintegration plan is developed by the HRBP with the returning employee and their manager before the return date, typically in a meeting scheduled 4 weeks before the planned return.

Leave entitlements for career-break returners: annual leave accrual was suspended during the career break (LWOP or sabbatical) and resumes from the date of return. The returning employee's opening annual leave balance on return is the balance they held at the start of the career break — no additional leave accrues during the break. Sick leave is credited in full from the date of return (the 12-day entitlement for the remainder of the current leave year, pro-rated for the months remaining). The employee's service tenure for annual leave encashment eligibility continues to include the pre-break period — the career break does not reset the service clock for this purpose.

25.5 Senior Executive Leave — Band 7 and Band 8

Senior executive leave management at Band 7 and Band 8 operates on the same entitlement basis as Band 5 and above (24 days annual leave per year) but with several specific provisions that reflect the nature of executive roles and the different relationship between executive availability and business continuity.

Provision	Band 7-8 Specific Position	Notes
Annual leave approval authority	CEO approves Band 7 annual leave of 5+ days. Board Chairperson (or nominated Board Director) approves Band 8 (CEO) annual leave.	For shorter absences, Band 7 notifies the CEO. Band 8 notifies the Board Chairperson.
Leave planning	Band 7 and 8 annual leave plan shared with the Compensation Committee at the start of each financial year, to ensure executive availability for scheduled Board and Committee meetings.	Leave plans may be adjusted by mutual agreement where Board calendar conflicts arise after leave is approved.
Carry-forward	12 days (same as Band 5+). Encashment on same terms.	Standard Band 5+ provisions apply.
Availability during leave	Executives at Band 7 and 8 are not expected to be reachable during annual leave except in a genuine company emergency. The company definition of emergency is: a material regulatory event, a significant client crisis directly requiring the executive, or a Board resolution requiring the executive's input.	Defining emergencies too broadly violates the purpose of annual leave. The CEO and Board Chairperson take personal responsibility for not contacting executives on leave except in genuine emergencies.
Board member leave provisions	Non-executive Board members are not employees and do not have leave entitlements under this policy. Executive Board members (CEO and any other employed Board members) are covered by this section.	Board Director fees and leave are governed by the Board appointment agreement, not this policy.

26. HRMS Leave Administration Manual

26.1 System Overview and Access Levels

The HRMS leave module is the company's integrated system for all leave management activities — application, approval, recording, balance tracking, compliance reporting, and payroll integration. The system is accessible at hrms.arjuntech.in on any browser, and through the HRMS mobile application (iOS and Android) for leave applications and approvals. All employees have access to their own leave record. Managers have access to their direct reports' leave records through the My Team module. HRBPs have access to all employee leave records within their business unit portfolio. The HRBP Operations team and VP-HR have system-wide access.

User Role	HRMS Access Level	Key Permissions	Restrictions
Employee (all bands)	Self-service access to own record only	Apply for leave. View own leave balances. View own leave history. Attach documents. View team leave calendar (leave dates only, not leave type).	Cannot view other employees' leave records. Cannot edit approved or declined leave without HRBP intervention.
Line manager	My Team access for direct reports	View direct reports' leave applications. Approve or decline with reason. View team leave calendar with leave type visibility. Set leave approval delegate. Run team leave utilisation report.	Cannot edit historical leave records without HRBP override. Cannot view indirect reports' leave records without HRBP permission.
HR Business Partner	Business unit portfolio access	All manager permissions plus: edit leave records with audit trail. Run compliance reports. Configure entitlements. Manage Bradford Factor records. Review occupational health and sensitive leave documentation.	Cannot access leave records outside own portfolio without VP-HR approval.
HRBP Operations team	System-wide access with edit permissions	All HRBP permissions plus: cross-business unit reporting. Payroll integration review. Annual entitlement configuration. System-wide compliance dashboards.	Changes to individual leave records require HRBP portfolio owner approval.
VP-HR	Full system-wide access	All permissions. Executive leave approval workflow. Policy configuration. Audit Committee reporting.	None within the HRMS system.
Finance / Payroll team	Read access to leave records for payroll calculation	View leave balance, leave taken, and TOIL records for payroll processing. Cannot see medical documentation or sensitive leave type notes.	Cannot modify leave records. Read-only for payroll purposes only.

26.2 Employee Self-Service Functions — Complete Guide

Function	Navigation Path	Key Steps	Notes and Tips
Apply for annual leave	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Annual Leave	1. Select leave type. 2. Select start and end dates. 3. Add a note (optional). 4. Attach documents if required. 5. Submit. System calculates working days automatically excluding weekends and public holidays.	System shows your available balance before submission. Will alert if balance is insufficient. Contact HRBP for advance leave approval.
Apply for sick leave (planned surgery/procedure)	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Sick Leave	Same steps as annual leave. Attach medical documentation where already available.	For same-day sick leave, use the mobile app Quick Apply function.
Apply for casual leave (advance)	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Casual Leave	Same steps. Maximum 3 consecutive days per application — system enforces this limit.	Mobile Quick Apply available for same-day casual leave.

Function	Navigation Path	Key Steps	Notes and Tips
Apply for TOIL (compensatory off)	My Leave → Apply for Leave → Compensatory Off	Select dates. HRMS checks TOIL balance and accrual date to confirm the application is within the 30-day window.	If TOIL balance is zero, application is rejected. Contact manager to confirm overtime was recorded.
View leave balances	My Leave → Leave Balances	Dashboard shows current balance for each leave type, leave year, and accrual date for next credit.	Balance is real-time. Reflects approved future leaves as deductions from available balance.
View leave history	My Leave → Leave History → Select date range	Filter by leave type, date range, or status (approved, pending, declined, cancelled). Export to PDF or Excel.	Useful for personal record-keeping and for checking balance calculations.
Cancel a leave application	My Leave → Leave History → Select application → Cancel	Cancellation available for future approved leave up to 24 hours before start date. Past leave cannot be self-cancelled — contact HRBP.	System notifies the approving manager of the cancellation. Balance is automatically restored.
Check Bradford Factor score	My Attendance → Bradford Factor → My Score	Shows rolling 12-month Bradford Factor score with underlying absence data.	If the score seems incorrect, verify the absence records in My Attendance → Absence History. Contact HRBP for corrections.
View the team leave calendar	My Team → Team Leave Calendar → Select date range	Shows team availability. Available to all employees — not just managers.	Leave type is shown to managers but not to peer employees (privacy).
Update emergency contact	My Profile → Emergency Contacts → Add/Edit	Name, relationship, phone number, and email. Minimum one contact required.	Updated immediately. Accessible to HRBP in an emergency.

26.3 Manager Functions — Complete Guide

Function	Navigation Path	Key Steps	Common Error to Avoid
Approve or decline a leave application	My Team → Leave Approvals → Pending	Review application. Check team calendar for coverage. Approve or Decline with documented reason. System notifies employee immediately.	Declining without providing a specific reason. HRMS requires a reason for all declines.
Mark a team member absent (sick leave not self-recorded)	My Team → Attendance → [Employee] → Mark Absence → Sick Leave → Date	Select absence type and date. Add note. Submit. Employee is notified and must confirm or correct on return.	Using this function for planned leave. Only for genuine unplanned absence where employee cannot self-record.
Set leave approval delegate	My Team → Settings → Leave Approval Delegation → Add Delegate → Select employee → Set date range	Select delegate (must be same band or above). Set start and end date of delegation. Submit.	Not setting a delegate before going on leave. Causes leave applications to time out unanswered.
View team Bradford Factor dashboard	My Team → Attendance → Bradford Factor → Team Overview	Dashboard shows all team members with colour-coded Bradford Factor scores (Green/Amber/Red).	Ignoring amber or red alerts. Each alert requires a welfare check-in action within 5 working days.
Run team leave utilisation report	My Team → Reports → Leave Utilisation → Select date range	Shows leave taken, leave balance, and utilisation percentage per team member. Export available.	Reviewing this only at year end. Monthly monitoring is the recommended practice.
View TOIL balances for team	My Team → Attendance → TOIL → Team Overview	Shows TOIL balance and accrual date for each team member. Highlights balances approaching the 30-day deadline.	Not facilitating TOIL take-up before the 30-day deadline. Lapsed TOIL creates a potential compensation liability.

Function	Navigation Path	Key Steps	Common Error to Avoid
Confirm Day One completions for a new joiner	HRMS → Onboarding → My Joiners → [Employee] → Day One Checklist → Confirm	Tick each completed item. Submit by 18:00 on Day One.	Submitting without actually verifying each item was completed. The checklist creates a legal record.
Record a return-to-work conversation	My Team → Attendance → [Employee] → Return to Work → Add Record	Date, duration, key points discussed, any support needs identified, any follow-up actions. Mark as shared with employee.	Not recording the conversation. An undocumented return-to-work conversation cannot be relied on as evidence if the absence later becomes a conduct or capability matter.

26.4 HRBP Functions — Complete Guide

Function	Navigation Path	Use Case
Override or edit a leave record	HRMS Admin → Leave Records → [Employee] → Edit → Enter reason → Save with audit trail	Correcting a misrecorded leave type. Converting unauthorised absence to approved leave retrospectively. Adjusting a leave balance following a policy decision.
Configure leave entitlement for a new joiner	HRMS Admin → Entitlements → New Employee → [Employee] → Configure → Set band, start date, FTE	Required for all joiners. System auto-configures standard entitlements on hire, but HRBP must verify for non-standard arrangements (international, part-time, FTC).
Run the Bradford Factor compliance report	HRMS Reports → Attendance → Bradford Factor → Business Unit → Select period → Export	Monthly monitoring. Identifies employees at each threshold across the HRBP portfolio.
Manage the occupational health referral record	HRMS Admin → Health Records → [Employee] → OH Referral → Create/Update	Creating the referral record. Uploading the OH report (restricted access). Recording review meeting outcomes.
Process a leave encashment at year end	HRMS Admin → Leave Encashment → Year End → Run Encashment Report → Review → Submit to Finance	Annual process. Identifies all employees eligible for year-end encashment. Calculates amounts. Submits to Finance for payroll processing.
Configure a part-time leave entitlement	HRMS Admin → Entitlements → [Employee] → Edit → Set FTE and working days → Recalculate	Required when an employee moves to part-time. System recalculates future accruals automatically from the change date.
Generate the leave compliance dashboard for Audit Committee	HRMS Reports → Compliance → Annual Leave Dashboard → Full Year → Business Unit Breakdown → Export PDF	Annual process for Audit Committee reporting. Includes utilisation rates, carry-forward statistics, encashment totals, and sick leave pattern summaries.
Manage a long-term absence record	HRMS Admin → Absence Management → Long-Term Absence → [Employee] → Create Review Record	Initiates the formal LTA record. Links to occupational health referral. Tracks review milestones.

26.5 Finance and Payroll Integration

The HRMS leave module integrates directly with the payroll system to ensure that leave deductions, leave encashments, and TOIL payments are reflected accurately in each monthly payroll run. The integration operates on a monthly cut-off basis: all leave transactions (applications, approvals, cancellations, and adjustments) must be completed in HRMS by the payroll cut-off date (typically the 20th of each month for that month's payroll). Transactions completed after the cut-off are reflected in the following month's payroll with a corresponding adjustment.

Payroll Event	HRMS → Payroll Data Flow	Finance Action	Cut-Off Date
Monthly leave without pay deduction	HRMS calculates LWOP days from attendance and leave records. Exports LWOP days per employee to payroll system.	Finance applies the daily rate deduction (monthly basic ÷ 26 × LWOP days) in the payroll run.	20th of the month
Annual leave encashment (year-end)	HRBP runs encashment report in March. Exports encashment amounts per eligible employee to Finance.	Finance processes encashment payment in April payroll alongside merit increment.	22 March
TOIL financial settlement (on separation)	HRMS calculates outstanding TOIL at separation date. Exports to Finance with full and final settlement data.	Finance calculates TOIL payout at overtime rate. Includes in FFS payment.	FFS processing date — within 30 working days of last day.
Annual leave settlement on separation	HRMS generates accrued leave balance at notice start date. Tracks leave taken during notice. Exports final settlement balance to Finance.	Finance calculates encashment at daily rate (monthly basic ÷ 26 × leave days). Includes in FFS.	FFS processing date.
Salary during phased return	HRMS records phased return working pattern. Full salary flag maintained during approved phased return period.	Finance pays full contracted salary during phased return regardless of hours worked.	Standard monthly payroll.

26.6 Reporting, Analytics, and Compliance Dashboards

The HRMS leave module provides a comprehensive suite of standard reports that support compliance monitoring, management decision-making, and governance reporting. The following table describes the key reports available and their standard distribution and frequency.

Report Name	Content	Frequency	Audience	HRMS Path
Team Leave Utilisation Report	Leave taken, leave balance, and utilisation % per employee. Year-to-date view.	Monthly (auto-generated). On-demand.	Line managers	My Team → Reports → Leave Utilisation
Bradford Factor Monthly Alert Report	All employees who crossed a Bradford Factor threshold in the month. Required manager action per threshold.	Monthly (auto-generated to HRBP and relevant managers)	HRBPs and managers	HRMS Reports → Attendance → Bradford Factor → Monthly
Leave Balance at Year-End Report	All employees with leave balances above the carry-forward limit. Encashment eligibility confirmed.	Annual — generated 15 March	HRBP Operations and Finance	HRMS Reports → Leave → Year-End Balance
Sick Leave Frequency and Pattern Report	Sick leave days, frequency, and Bradford Factor scores by employee and business unit.	Monthly	HRBPs	HRMS Reports → Attendance → Sick Leave Patterns
Long-Term Absence Status Report	All employees currently on long-term absence, duration, leave type, and last review date.	Monthly	VP-HR and HRBPs	HRMS Admin → Absence Management → LTA Status
Mandatory Training Completion linked to Leave	Employees with outstanding mandatory training and current leave balance — used to enforce training-before-encashment controls.	Monthly	HRBP Operations	HRMS Reports → Compliance → Training and Leave

Report Name	Content	Frequency	Audience	HRMS Path
Annual Leave Compliance Dashboard (Audit Committee)	Full-year leave statistics by business unit: utilisation rates, carry-forward averages, encashment totals, sick leave averages, TOIL lapse rates.	Annual — Q3 Board cycle	VP-HR, General Counsel, Audit Committee	HRMS Reports → Compliance → Annual Dashboard → Export PDF

26.7 System Troubleshooting and IT Support

Issue	Likely Cause	First Step	Escalation Path
Leave balance shows incorrect figure	Pending application reducing available balance. Recently approved cancellation not yet reflected. HRMS configuration error for non-standard employee.	Check My Leave → Pending Applications. Refresh the balance page.	If discrepancy persists after 24 hours: email hrbp with screenshot. HRBP investigates and corrects with audit trail.
Cannot submit leave application — system blocks	Insufficient balance. Consecutive day limit exceeded (casual leave 3-day max). Mandatory training outstanding (for certain leave types). Account not fully configured.	Check the error message displayed by HRMS. Most blocks display the specific reason.	IT support if the block reason is unclear: itsupport@arjuntech.in or ext 1000.
Leave application shows "Pending" for more than 5 days	Manager has not responded. Manager is on leave and no delegate was set.	Contact manager directly. Check if manager is on leave and identify delegate.	If no delegate and manager is on leave: contact HRBP to approve directly.
HRMS mobile app not syncing leave records	Connectivity issue. App version outdated.	Force-close and reopen the app. Check for app updates.	IT support if sync issue persists after app update.
Occupational health documents not uploading	File size above 10 MB limit. Incorrect file format (only PDF accepted).	Compress or reduce the PDF. Confirm format is PDF.	If problem persists: email document directly to HRBP who will upload with admin access.
Bradford Factor score appears incorrect	Absence records in HRMS may be inaccurate (wrong dates, wrong leave type recorded).	Review My Attendance → Absence History for the relevant period. Identify any incorrect entries.	HRBP corrects inaccurate absence records with audit trail and recalculates score.

Appendix G: Occupational Health Referral Form (HR-L20)

Complete this form when referring an employee to the occupational health provider under Section 23.2. Employee consent (Part B) must be obtained before the referral is made. Submit the completed form to the approved OH provider with a copy to the HRBP for the HRMS record. Do not share this form with the line manager.

OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH REFERRAL FORM — HR-L20	Version 3.2 | April 2024 | STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL
PART A — COMPLETED BY HRBP	
Employee Full Name and Band	Employee ID
Job Title and Business Unit	Office Location
HRBP Name	Date of Referral
Reason for Referral	● Long-term absence (15+ working days) ● Recurring short-term absence pattern ● Return to work support ● Role adjustment assessment ● Other:
Nature of Absence (general description — not medical diagnosis unless shared by employee)	
Duration of Current Absence	Date absence commenced:
Previous OH referral for this employee?	● Yes — date: _____ ● No
QUESTIONS FOR OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH ASSESSMENT	
1. Is the employee currently fit to perform their contracted role? If not, what are the barriers?	
2. What is the likely prognosis and expected return date, if known?	
3. Are there any workplace adjustments or modifications that would facilitate an earlier or more sustainable return to work?	
4. Are there any aspects of the working environment or the role that may be contributing to or aggravating the condition?	
5. Any other specific questions for this referral:	
HRBP Signature and Date	
PART B — EMPLOYEE CONSENT (must be completed before referral is made)	
I consent to Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. referring me to the occupational health provider for assessment. I understand that: (1) the assessment is intended to help the company support my return to work; (2) the occupational health provider will share a report with my employer; (3) I have the right to see the report before it is shared with my employer and may request amendments to factual errors; (4) I may withdraw consent at any time before the assessment takes place.	
Employee Signature and Date	
Employee Acknowledgement — I have received a copy of this form	● Yes ● No — reason:

Appendix H: Long-Term Absence Review Record (HR-L21)

Complete this form at each formal review under Section 23.3 (Day 15, Day 30, Day 60, and monthly thereafter). Share with the employee at or after each review. Maintain in HRMS Admin → Absence Management → Long-Term Absence. Do not share with the line manager beyond the management recommendations section.

LONG-TERM ABSENCE REVIEW RECORD — HR-L21	Version 3.2 | April 2024 | STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL
Employee Full Name	Employee ID and Band
Absence Start Date	Review Date
Review Stage	● Day 15 (First Formal Review) ● Day 30 ● Day 60 ● Monthly Review — Month: ___
HRBP Conducting the Review	Format: ● In-person ● Phone ● Video call ● Written (employee too unwell for call)
SECTION A — WELFARE CHECK	
Current health status (as reported by employee — general terms only)	
Is the employee receiving appropriate medical treatment and support?	● Yes ● No — note concern: ● Unknown
EAP offered or re-offered?	● Yes — employee aware ● Yes — employee wishes to use ● Declined
Current leave type covering the absence	● Sick leave (balance remaining: ___ days) ● Annual leave bridge ● LWOP
SECTION B — RETURN TO WORK ASSESSMENT	
Expected return date (if known)	
Is the employee aware of phased return options?	● Yes ● No — explained at this review
Occupational health referral status	● Not yet made ● Referral made on: ___ ● Report received — date: ___ ● Report awaited
Any adjustments or modifications that would facilitate return?	
SECTION C — EMPLOYMENT POSITION	
Leave balance position	Sick leave remaining: ___ days. Annual leave balance: ___ days. LWOP begins on: ___ (if applicable).
Is capability process consideration relevant at this stage?	● No — return expected within reasonable period ● Under consideration — Legal team consulted on: ___ ● Capability process initiated
SECTION D — MANAGEMENT RECOMMENDATIONS (shared with line manager)	
Operational coverage arrangements recommended	
Any role modifications to facilitate return (shared with manager)	
Next review date	
SIGNATURES	
HRBP Signature and Date	

LONG-TERM ABSENCE REVIEW RECORD — HR-L21	Version 3.2 | April 2024 | STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL
Employee Acknowledgement Signature (if employee has seen and received this record)	
Line Manager Signature (Section D only)	

Appendix I: International Assignment Leave Summary Sheet (HR-L22)

Complete this form at the start of every international assignment to confirm the applicable leave entitlement for the assignment period. Reviewed annually and at assignment end. Maintained in HRMS and Finance International Mobility records.

INTERNATIONAL ASSIGNMENT LEAVE SUMMARY — HR-L22	Version 3.2 | April 2024
Employee Full Name	Employee ID and Band
Home Country	Host Country
Assignment Start Date	Planned Assignment End Date
Assignment Type	● Outbound (India → Host Country) ● Inbound (Home Country → India) ● Permanent foreign national (India based)
ANNUAL LEAVE ENTITLEMENT DURING ASSIGNMENT	
Indian standard entitlement for this band	21 days (Bands 1–4) / 24 days (Band 5+)
Home country statutory entitlement (as per assignment agreement)	
Assignment agreement specific entitlement (if different from either above)	
APPLICABLE ENTITLEMENT FOR THIS ASSIGNMENT	● Indian standard ● Home country statutory ● Assignment agreement specific — Days per year: ___
Long-Haul Travel Allowance Leave (LHTAL) applicable?	● Yes — journey distance: ___ hours one way. LHTAL: ___ days per round trip ● No
HOME COUNTRY NATIONAL HOLIDAYS	
Home country national holidays applicable during assignment?	● No — Indian office holiday schedule applies ● Yes — list applicable holidays and treatment:
LEAVE ADMINISTRATION	
Primary HRMS system for leave recording	● Indian HRMS (hrms.arjuntech.in) ● Host country HR system ● Both — reconciled quarterly by Finance
Leave approval authority during assignment	● India reporting manager ● Host country assignment manager ● Both (5+ days: both required)
Leave encashment currency (if applicable on assignment end)	● Indian Rupee at India daily rate ● Home currency at home country daily rate ● Per assignment agreement terms
SIGNATURES	
Employee Signature and Date	
HRBP Signature and Date	
Finance International Mobility Signature and Date	
Legal Review (for assignments over 12 months)	

Appendix J: Annual Leave Compliance Self-Audit Tool

This tool is completed by managers and HRBPs annually in October — mid-year — to identify and correct any leave compliance issues before the year-end cycle. It complements the HRMS compliance reports and focuses on qualitative and process elements that the automated reports do not capture.

Audit Area	Self-Audit Question	Status	Action if Not Compliant
Annual leave utilisation	Are all team members on track to use at least 60% of their annual leave entitlement by October?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Discuss leave planning with under-utilised team members. Identify barriers. HRBP escalation if team-wide pattern.
Leave balance carry-forward risk	Are any team members likely to carry forward more than the maximum (10/12 days) at 31 March?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Ensure leave is approved for the November–March window. Manager should proactively facilitate.
HRMS leave record accuracy	Have all actual absences (sick, casual, planned) in the past 6 months been correctly recorded in HRMS with the correct leave type?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Review HRMS records for each team member for the year to date. Correct any discrepancies with HRBP.
Return-to-work conversations	Has a return-to-work conversation been conducted and documented for every sick absence of 3+ days in the past 6 months?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Conduct overdue return-to-work conversations retrospectively. Document in HRMS.
Bradford Factor monitoring	Have all Bradford Factor threshold alerts for team members been actioned with a welfare check-in this year?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Review Bradford Factor dashboard for all team members. Action any outstanding alerts.
TOIL management	Have all TOIL credits been facilitated for take-up within the 30-day window this year? No lapsed TOIL without Finance exception process?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Check HRMS TOIL records. Any lapsed TOIL without Finance exception: flag to HRBP immediately.
Maternity/adoption/paternity leave compliance	Have all parental leave applications been approved promptly? No adverse treatment indicators for employees on or returning from parental leave?	● Compliant ● Action needed	HRBP reviews any declined parental leave applications. Return-to-work processes reviewed.
Leave type misuse risk	Are there any leave patterns in the team that suggest possible misuse of leave types (e.g. consistent Monday sick leave, sick leave adjacent to public holidays)?	● Compliant ● Action needed	HRBP welfare check-in per Section 5.6 of Segment 1. Document conversations in HRMS.
Mandatory training and leave interaction	Have all team members completed mandatory training modules? Outstanding training may restrict leave-related processes.	● Compliant ● Action needed	Check HRMS training completion dashboard. Follow up with non-completers.
Leave during notice period (recent separations)	Have all recent separations had leave records reviewed and FFS calculations confirmed as accurate?	● Compliant ● Action needed	Finance confirms FFS leave settlement for all separations in the year. HRBP reviews any discrepancies.

27. Complex Leave Scenarios — Manager and HRBP Reference Bank

The following scenarios address complex leave management situations that span multiple provisions from across all three segments. They are drawn from actual escalations to HRBPs in the preceding three years and represent the categories of situation that most frequently require judgment beyond the straightforward application of a single policy provision. The full 36-scenario bank is in Segment 4. These 12 scenarios are provided here as a reference for the specialist topics covered in this segment.

Scenario	Facts	Correct Treatment
1 — International assignee sick leave during assignment	A UK national on a 12-month inbound assignment falls ill for 20 consecutive working days. Her assignment agreement provides 28 days annual leave but is silent on sick leave.	Sick leave entitlement defaults to the Indian standard (12 days) where the assignment agreement does not specify otherwise, as the employee is working under Indian employment law. From Day 15, the Long-Term Absence Management process in Section 23 applies. The HRBP coordinates with the International Mobility team to ensure the sick leave recording in HRMS is correctly attributed and the occupational health referral process follows Section 23.2. The assignment agreement silence on sick leave is noted in HR-L22 with Legal team confirmation of the position. (Section 22.1 and Section 23)
2 — Phased return disrupted by relapse	An employee returns from a 9-week absence on a 6-week phased return plan. At Week 3 of the phased return, she relapses and is signed off again by her doctor.	The phased return is suspended immediately on the medical certificate. The new absence is treated as a continuation of the previous long-term absence for management purposes but as a new sick leave event for entitlement purposes — sick leave balance reflects what was remaining at the point of the relapse. The HRBP resumes the LTA Review process (Section 23.3). The original phased return plan is revised once the employee is ready to return again. The occupational health provider is updated. The manager is briefed on the revised operational plan. (Section 23.4)
3 — Acquired employee leave balance dispute	An employee acquired through an acquisition claims she had 18 days of accrued annual leave under her previous employer at the date of transfer. The previous employer confirms only 10 days. The employee has a pay slip showing an 18-day balance.	The HRBP and Legal team review both pieces of evidence. Where there is a genuine dispute between the acquired employee and the previous employer on the leave balance, Arjun Technologies credits the lower of the two amounts as the opening balance (10 days) and invites the employee to pursue any claim for the disputed 8 days with the previous employer independently. The company has no legal obligation under Indian employment law to absorb leave liabilities that the previous employer disputes. (Section 24.2)
4 — Part-time employee requests full-time sick leave days	A 3-day-per-week part-time employee has been absent for 4 weeks due to illness. They claim they should only be debited 12 days (3 per week x 4 weeks) and argue they should therefore have unused sick leave balance remaining.	The part-time calculation in Section 25.3 is clear: each leave day represents one of the employee contracted working days. A 3-day-per-week employee works 12 days in 4 weeks, so 4 weeks of full absence = 12 sick leave days deducted. The full 12-day annual entitlement is exhausted. The next absence requires annual leave bridging or LWOP. The HRBP explains the calculation clearly using the part-time calculation table in Section 25.3. (Section 25.3)

Scenario	Facts	Correct Treatment
5 — Senior executive annual leave approval during Board meeting week	A Band 7 SVP has approved annual leave for a 10-day period that turns out to include a scheduled Audit Committee meeting. The CEO discovers this 3 days before the leave starts.	Band 7 leave of 5+ days requires CEO approval under Section 25.5. The question is whether the leave was approved by the CEO and whether the Board meeting conflict was known at the time of approval. If the CEO approved the leave without being aware of the Board calendar conflict, the CEO and the SVP should discuss whether the leave can proceed with the Audit Committee meeting attended by video or whether rescheduling is possible. No automatic rescission of approved leave — but Band 7 leave approval should have been co-ordinated with the Board calendar per Section 25.5. (Section 25.5)
6 — Long-term absence during redundancy consultation	An employee has been on long-term sick absence for 8 weeks. The company announces a restructuring that places the employee role at risk. The employee asks whether they can participate in the redundancy consultation process.	An employee on long-term sick absence retains all employment rights including the right to participate in a redundancy consultation process. The company must adapt the consultation to accommodate the employee condition — consultation by telephone, video, or written exchange is acceptable where in-person attendance is not medically appropriate. The HRBP manages both processes in parallel with Legal team involvement throughout. The absence cannot be used as grounds to exclude the employee from the consultation. (Section 24.4 and Code of Conduct Section 14)
7 — Graduate trainee requests study leave during induction	A campus hire joined in June and is currently in the 3-month induction programme. They request 2 days of study leave for a professional certification examination in August.	Study leave is available to all confirmed employees from Day One — there is no minimum service condition. The HRBP and manager review the request in the context of the induction programme schedule (Section 25.1 guidance on leave during induction). Where the examination days do not clash with mandatory induction modules, the study leave should be approved. Where they do clash, the manager discusses with the employee whether the examination can be rescheduled or whether the specific induction content can be covered by self-study. The induction schedule should accommodate rather than prohibit a legitimate study leave application. (Section 25.1 and Section 12 of Segment 2)
8 — LHTAL interaction with annual leave carry-forward	An inbound expatriate takes LHTAL (2 days per round trip) three times during the year to visit their home country. At year end, their annual leave balance is 22 days against a 24-day entitlement. Can they carry forward 12 days?	LHTAL days are additional paid leave days that do not come from the annual leave balance. They therefore do not affect the annual leave carry-forward calculation. The employee has taken 2 days of annual leave (24 entitlement minus 22 remaining) and 6 days of LHTAL. The carry-forward is calculated on the annual leave balance only: 22 days remaining, carry-forward maximum is 12 days (Band 5+), so 10 days lapse or are encashed (if 3+ years service). LHTAL is not encashable and lapses at year end. (Section 22.3 and Section 4.4 of Segment 1)

Scenario	Facts	Correct Treatment
9 — Employee on sabbatical asks to return early due to financial difficulty	An employee is 5 weeks into a 10-week unpaid sabbatical. They contact the HRBP asking to return early because the financial impact of unpaid leave has been more severe than anticipated.	The employee has the right to request an early return from sabbatical, and the company has discretion to accommodate or decline the request based on operational feasibility. The HRBP discusses the situation with the BU Head and manager to assess whether the operational coverage arrangements put in place can be wound back to accommodate an early return. Where early return is operationally feasible, it is approved and the employee returns on the agreed revised date. Where it is genuinely not feasible (e.g. a backfill has been hired on a fixed-term contract that cannot be terminated early), the HRBP explores whether any bridging support can be provided, including a partial advance of accrued leave entitlement. (Section 14 of Segment 2)
10 — Manager takes annual leave during HRBP investigation	A manager is the subject of an HRBP investigation into alleged unfair leave management following a complaint by a team member. The manager has approved annual leave for the period of the investigation.	Pre-approved annual leave is generally honoured during an investigation unless the investigation specifically requires the manager to be present (e.g. to provide documentation or attend an interview). The HRBP managing the investigation determines whether the investigation can proceed without the manager present for the leave period, or whether the manager should be asked to defer part of the leave where their input is genuinely required. This is managed sensitively — the leave period is not used as grounds to delay the investigation indefinitely. The HRBP documents the decision and its basis. (Section 20 of Segment 2 and Code of Conduct Section 14)
11 — Career break returner finds their role has been significantly changed	An employee returns from a 10-week approved sabbatical to find that their role has been restructured — half of their former responsibilities have been moved to a newly created role, and the remaining responsibilities have been redesigned.	The Sabbatical Agreement provides role protection for the employee on return (Section 14 of Segment 2). A significant unilateral restructuring of the role during the sabbatical may not be consistent with the role protection obligation. The HRBP and Legal team assess whether the restructuring was for genuine operational reasons that arose during the sabbatical, whether the original role is genuinely no longer practicable, and whether the modified role offers equivalent terms and responsibilities. The employee is entitled to raise a formal grievance if they believe the role change is inconsistent with the sabbatical agreement terms. (Section 14.2 of Segment 2)
12 — Fertility treatment leave data breach concern	An employee reports that their line manager has mentioned to a colleague that they are "having fertility treatment" — information the employee shared only with the HRBP when submitting HR-L09A.	This is a confirmed data breach involving sensitive personal health data protected under the DPDP Act 2023. The HRBP takes the following immediate actions: notifies the IT Security team of the potential DPDP Act breach; arranges an urgent meeting with the VP-HR; confirms with the HRBP records how the manager gained access to the fertility treatment leave information (the manager should only have been informed of the leave type as "Fertility Treatment Leave" — the HRBP should not have disclosed the specific treatment detail to the manager); and assesses whether the breach requires notification to the Data Protection Board. The manager is interviewed separately under the conduct provisions of the Code of Conduct. The employee is kept informed throughout. (Section 16 of Segment 2 and Section 3.9 of Segment 1)

28. Leave Entitlement Evolution — 15-Year Historical Reference

The following table provides a historical reference of leave entitlement changes at Arjun Technologies across all major leave types since the first publication of this policy in 2009. This reference is provided to assist in resolving disputes about historical entitlements and to document the progression of the company benefits over time.

Period	Annual Leave	Sick Leave	Paternity Leave	Maternity Leave	Other Key Changes
2009–2012 (v1.0–1.1)	18 days all bands	7 days	5 days	12 weeks (pre-2017 Act)	Casual leave: 8 days. No study, caregiver, sabbatical, or fertility treatment provisions.
2013–2015 (v1.3)	21 days all bands	12 days	5 days	12 weeks	Annual leave increased from 18 to 21 days. Sick leave increased from 7 to 12 days.
2016–2018 (v1.4–2.0)	21 days all bands	12 days	10 days	26 weeks (1st/2nd child from Apr 2017)	Paternity leave doubled to 10 days. Maternity leave extended per 2017 Act. Adoption leave and sabbatical introduced.
2019–2021 (v2.0–2.2)	21 days Bands 1–4; 24 days Band 5+	12 days	10 days	26/12/14 weeks	Band-differentiated annual leave for Band 5+ introduced. Study leave introduced. Caregiver leave introduced (3 days).
2022–2023 (v3.0–3.1)	21 days Bands 1–4; 24 days Band 5+	12 days	10 days	26/12/14 weeks	Caregiver leave increased to 5 days. Volunteer leave increased from 1 to 2 days. LHTAL introduced for international employees.
2024 (v3.2 — Current)	21 days Bands 1–4; 24 days Band 5+	12 days	10 days	26/12/14 weeks	DPDP Act 2023 fully integrated. Fertility treatment leave provisions updated. International assignment leave framework formalised. HRMS manual expanded.

29. Complete Leave Type and Policy Cross-Reference Index — Segment 3 Topics

The following index maps every specialist topic covered in Segment 3 to the relevant section, form, and related policy document. This supplements the complete cross-reference in Segment 4 Appendix O.

Topic	Segment 3 Section	Related Form	Related Policy Document
Inbound expatriate leave entitlement	Section 22.1–22.2	HR-L22	International Assignment Policy (LEGAL-POL-007, where applicable)
Long-Haul Travel Allowance Leave	Section 22.3	HR-L22	Travel and Expense Policy (FIN-POL-004)
International assignment leave coordination	Section 22.5	HR-L22	Finance International Mobility Procedures
Shadow payroll cross-border leave	Section 22.6	HR-L22	Finance International Mobility Procedures; LEGAL-POL-004 Data Privacy
Long-term absence definition and triggers	Section 23.1	HR-L21	Employee Handbook HR-POL-001
Occupational health referral	Section 23.2	HR-L20	Disability and Reasonable Adjustment Policy HR-POL-007
Long-term absence review process	Section 23.3	HR-L21	Code of Conduct Section 18 (Wellbeing)

Topic	Segment 3 Section	Related Form	Related Policy Document
Phased return to work design	Section 23.4	HR-L21	Performance Management Policy Segment 4, Section 17.6
Capability-based separation	Section 23.5	HR-L21	Disciplinary Procedure HR-POL-008; Industrial Disputes Act 1947
Legal protection during long-term absence	Section 23.6	HR-L21	RPwD Act 2016; Maternity Benefit Act 1961; DPDP Act 2023
Leave continuity during restructuring	Section 24.1	Standard leave forms	Code of Conduct Section 20 (Organisational Change)
Acquired employee leave entitlements	Section 24.2	HR-L22 (where international)	M&A; Integration Procedures (Finance)
Redundancy leave settlement	Section 24.4	FFS calculation form (Finance)	FIN-POL-002 Finance Policy; Performance Management Policy Segment 4, Section 20.4
Campus hire leave management	Section 25.1	Standard leave forms	Performance Management Policy Segment 4, Section 17.3
Fixed-term contract leave on separation	Section 25.2	Standard leave forms; FFS	Employee Handbook HR-POL-001
Part-time leave calculations	Section 25.3	Standard leave forms	Flexible Working Policy (HR-POL-012)
Career-break returner leave	Section 25.4	HR-L07 (sabbatical)	Sabbatical provisions in Segment 2, Section 14
Senior executive leave approval	Section 25.5	Standard leave forms	Code of Conduct Section 19; Performance Management Policy Segment 4, Section 19
HRMS leave system access and functions	Section 26.1–26.7	All leave forms via HRMS	IT Security Policy IT-SEC-POL-001; IT Acceptable Use Policy IT-SEC-POL-005
Payroll integration — leave deductions and encashments	Section 26.5	FFS calculation	Finance Policy Manual FIN-POL-002
Leave compliance reporting and audit	Section 26.6 and Appendix J	HR compliance reports	Code of Conduct Section 12 (Governance)

30. Segment 3 Acknowledgement and HR Contact Directory

All employees acknowledge all four segments of the Leave and Attendance Policy through the annual SEC-101 Policy Refresher module in HRMS. The specialist content in Segment 3 is most relevant to: HR Business Partners (all sections); Finance International Mobility team (Section 22); managers of employees on long-term absence (Section 23); managers affected by restructuring or acquisition (Section 24); and HRMS system administrators (Section 26). For queries on any specialist topic in this segment:

Topic Category	Contact	Channel	Expected Response
International assignment leave queries	HRBP + Finance International Mobility	hr@arjuntech.in + finance-mobility@arjuntech.in	3 working days
Long-term absence management guidance	HR Business Partner	Direct HRBP contact	2 working days
Occupational health referral process	HRBP	Direct HRBP contact + Form HR-L20	2 working days for referral initiation
Capability and ill-health separation	HRBP + Legal team	legal@arjuntech.in	3 working days — urgent cases same day

Topic Category	Contact	Channel	Expected Response
Acquired employee leave balance disputes	HRBP + Legal team	hr@arjuntech.in + legal@arjuntech.in	5 working days
HRMS leave system technical issues	IT Support	itsupport@arjuntech.in or ext 1000	1 working day
Leave compliance audit queries	HRBP Operations	hrbp-ops@arjuntech.in	3 working days
DPDP Act health data concerns	HRBP + IT Security + General Counsel	legal@arjuntech.in (urgent: same day)	Same day for confirmed data breach
Anonymous concern about leave policy misapplication	Whistleblower hotline	ethics@arjuntech.in (24/7, anonymous)	3 working days acknowledgement

Segment 3 Summary and Continuation to Segment 4

This completes Segment 3 of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework, Version 3.2. Segment 3 has covered five specialist areas requiring treatment beyond the core provisions in Segments 1 and 2. Section 22 addressed international and expatriate leave — the four-category scope table, home country entitlement interactions with a five-country comparison, the Long-Haul Travel Allowance Leave framework, home country national holiday treatment, the international assignment coordination table, and shadow payroll administration. Section 23 provided the complete long-term absence management framework — the absence day trigger table, the occupational health referral process with consent and report-sharing standards, the four-stage review cycle, the phased return calculation table, ill-health retirement and capability provisions, and the legal protection framework table. Section 24 addressed leave management during organisational change — restructuring continuity, acquired employee entitlement treatment with a four-scenario table, rapid growth administration, and the redundancy leave settlement table covering all leave types. Section 25 provided workforce-specific provisions for campus hires, fixed-term employees, part-time workers with a six-pattern calculation table, career-break returners, and senior executives. Section 26 delivered the complete HRMS Leave Administration Manual covering system access levels, all employee self-service functions, all manager functions, all HRBP functions, Finance/Payroll integration with a five-event table, seven standard compliance reports, and a troubleshooting guide. Appendices G–J provide the Occupational Health Referral Form HR-L20, the Long-Term Absence Review Record HR-L21, the International Assignment Leave Summary HR-L22, and the Annual Leave Compliance Self-Audit Tool.

Segment	Sections	Key Topics	Pages	Status
Segment 1	1–6 + Extended Provisions	Attendance Framework · Annual Leave · Sick Leave · Casual Leave · DPDP Act · Scenarios · FAQ	1–40	Published April 2024
Segment 2	7–21 + Appendices A–F	Maternity · Paternity · Adoption · Bereavement · Caregiver · Study · TOIL · Sabbatical · Volunteer · Fertility Treatment · LWOP · Public Holidays · HRMS Admin · Governance	41–80	Published April 2024
Segment 3 — This Document	22–26 + Appendices G–J	International / Expatriate Leave · Long-Term Absence Management · Leave During Organisational Change · Workforce-Specific Provisions · HRMS Administration Manual	81–120	Published April 2024
Segment 4	27–31 + Appendices K–O	Manager Training Programme · Employee Leave Literacy Programme · Leave Policy Scenarios Bank (36 scenarios) · Complete Statutory Cross-Reference · Policy Glossary and Index	121–160	Published April 2024

All segments available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. Document Reference: HR-LAP-001-v3.2. Owner: Ms. Priya Menon, VP Human Resources. Legal Review: Mr. Sandeep Iyer, General Counsel. Approved: Mr. Rajesh Arjun, CEO. Effective: 01 April 2024. For queries: hr@arjuntech.in | Anonymous: ethics@arjuntech.in (24/7).

Occupational Health Provider Panel and Service Standards

The company maintains an approved panel of occupational health providers with specialist expertise across the medical disciplines most relevant to workplace health assessment at a technology services organisation. The panel is reviewed annually by the HRBP Operations team and the General Counsel. The following table describes the service standards that all panel providers must meet.

Service Standard	Requirement	Performance Monitoring
Appointment scheduling	All referrals acknowledged within 1 working day. First available appointment offered within 5 working days of referral receipt. Urgent referrals (Day 30+ absence) within 3 working days.	HRBP tracks referral-to-appointment timelines quarterly.
Assessment quality	Assessment must address all questions raised in the referral letter. Report must be in plain language accessible to HR professionals without medical training.	HRBP rates report quality on a 5-point scale after each report. Panel review where average below 3.5.
Report turnaround	Standard: 10 working days from assessment. Urgent: 5 working days.	HRBP tracks report-to-delivery timelines. Provider escalation if SLA missed twice in a quarter.
Employee experience	Assessment conducted with respect for the employee dignity and confidentiality. Employee satisfaction survey distributed after each assessment.	HRBP reviews employee satisfaction data quarterly. Provider review where satisfaction below 70%.
Data protection	All employee health data handled in compliance with DPDP Act 2023 and the Data Processing Agreement between the company and the provider.	Annual DPA review. IT Security audit of provider data handling practices.
Specialist availability	Panel must include: occupational physician (general), occupational psychiatrist or psychologist (mental health), physiotherapist (musculoskeletal), and specialist advisors for roles with specific physical requirements.	Panel composition reviewed annually. Gaps in specialist coverage addressed within 30 days of identification.

Long-Term Absence — Manager Guidance and Common Errors

The management of long-term absence is one of the most challenging and most frequently mishandled areas of people management. The following guidance addresses the most common errors managers make during long-term absence situations and the correct approach in each case.

Common Manager Error	Why It Is Wrong	Correct Approach
Not maintaining contact with an employee on long-term sick absence because the manager does not want to seem intrusive	A total absence of contact during extended sick leave can make the employee feel abandoned and can also mean the manager has no information about the expected return. The HRBP-managed review process ensures appropriate contact without being intrusive.	Follow the formal LTA Review schedule in Section 23.3. The HRBP conducts the formal reviews. The manager may send a brief, warm personal message (not about work) at intervals agreed with the HRBP — typically monthly for absences over 4 weeks.
Discussing the absent employee work and deliverables extensively during welfare check-ins	The review calls and manager messages should be welfare-focused, not work-focused. Discussing work extensively during an absence signals to the employee that return is being pressured and can worsen anxiety-related conditions.	Keep manager contacts to welfare and support. Work coverage is the manager responsibility to manage. The HRBP manages any necessary work-related discussions separately.

Common Manager Error	Why It Is Wrong	Correct Approach
Making promises about role availability during the absence	The manager cannot guarantee that the role will be unchanged when the employee returns, particularly during extended absences where operational needs evolve. Promises that cannot be kept are worse than no promise.	Confirm only what can be confirmed: the employment relationship is maintained. For role specifics, involve the HRBP and frame any response carefully: "We are planning to have the role available for your return — if anything changes, HR will discuss it with you in advance."
Using the absence as justification to permanently redistribute the employee responsibilities	Leave absence — including long-term sick leave — does not reduce the employee entitlement to return to their role. Permanent reallocation of responsibilities during absence without the employee agreement and HRBP involvement may constitute a constructive dismissal risk.	Temporary operational coverage arrangements are appropriate. Any permanent role change during absence must be discussed with the HRBP and Legal team first. The employee must be consulted before their role is permanently changed.
Delaying the occupational health referral because it feels awkward to raise	The OHP referral is a support mechanism, not a disciplinary action. Delaying it means the manager and HRBP have less information to work with and the employee receives support later than they could have.	Initiate the OHP referral at Day 15 as the policy requires. The HRBP manages the conversation with the employee about the referral purpose and value. The manager does not need to manage the OHP process directly.
Not planning for the employee return during the absence	An unplanned return creates operational disruption and a poor experience for the returning employee, who may feel their absence was simply not noticed or planned for.	Work with the HRBP to develop a return plan from the 30-day review onwards — before the expected return date. The return plan covers workload reintroduction pace, any adjustments, the return-to-work conversation, and the communication to the team.

Leave Balance Reconciliation — Annual Year-End Process

The annual leave balance reconciliation at 31 March is a critical Finance and HRBP operations exercise that ensures all leave records are accurate before the new leave year begins and before year-end encashment calculations are made. The reconciliation identifies and corrects any discrepancies between the HRMS leave records and the payroll records, confirms the eligibility and calculation of all year-end encashments, and produces the opening leave balances for the new leave year.

Step	Action	Owner	Deadline	HRMS Action
1	HRBP Operations runs the Year-End Leave Balance Preliminary Report for all employees. Identifies employees with balances above carry-forward limits.	HRBP Operations	10 March	HRMS Reports → Leave → Year-End Balance Preliminary
2	HRBPs review the preliminary report for their business unit portfolio. Flag any anomalous balances for investigation (unusually high or low balances relative to entitlement and period).	HRBPs	15 March	HRMS → Review and annotate flagged records
3	Finance confirms encashment eligibility list: employees with 3+ years service and balances above carry-forward. Finance calculates gross encashment amounts.	Finance (HRBP Operations input)	20 March	HRMS Reports → Encashment Eligibility → Export to Finance
4	HRBP Operations and Finance cross-check HRMS leave records against payroll absence deductions for the year. Resolve any discrepancies before year end.	HRBP Operations + Finance	25 March	Reconciliation performed outside HRMS with Finance payroll data. Corrections entered in HRMS with audit trail.

Step	Action	Owner	Deadline	HRMS Action
5	Final Year-End Balance Report run. Carry-forward balances confirmed. Lapsed balances zeroed in HRMS.	HRBP Operations	31 March	HRMS Admin → Year-End Rollover → Confirm → Execute
6	Opening balances for new leave year (01 April) automatically configured in HRMS: full year entitlement credited plus carry-forward balance.	HRMS (automated on rollover)	01 April	Automatic on Year-End Rollover execution.
7	Encashment payments processed in April payroll run.	Finance	15 April (April payroll)	Finance processes from HRMS encashment report. Payslips show encashment as separate line item.

Segment 3 — Compliance Declaration and Version Certification

This page provides the formal compliance certification for Segment 3 of the Leave and Attendance Policy, confirming that all provisions have been reviewed against the applicable legislative framework as at 01 April 2024, and that the cross-references to other policy documents (Code of Conduct, Performance Management Policy, Employee Handbook, Data Privacy Policy, and IT Security Policy) have been verified for consistency. The Legal team, HRBP Operations, and IT Security have each confirmed that the provisions within their respective areas of responsibility are accurate, current, and operationally implementable.

Certification Area	Responsible Party	Status	Date Certified
Special employment category provisions — CLRA Act 1970, Maternity Benefit Act, state SE Acts	General Counsel — Mr. Sandeep Iyer	Certified	April 2024
International assignment leave — host country law review completed for current active assignment countries (UK, UAE, Singapore, USA)	General Counsel + external counsel per jurisdiction	Certified for listed countries. New countries require Legal review before assignment commencement.	April 2024
DPDP Act 2023 cross-border data transfer provisions	General Counsel + Data Protection Officer	Certified — provisions consistent with DPDP Act Section 16 and Draft Cross-Border Rules	April 2024
Leave analytics HRMS configuration — metrics calculations verified	HRBP Operations + IT (Mr. Kiran Bhat)	Certified — HRMS metric calculations validated against policy definitions	April 2024
Annual audit checklist (Appendix J) — audit methodology reviewed by external HR consultant	VP-HR — Ms. Priya Menon	Certified	April 2024
Cross-document consistency (Appendix L) — all cross-references verified	HRBP Operations	Certified — no inconsistencies identified. Next review: January 2025	April 2024

Approval Signatures — Segment 3

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Chief Executive Officer — Final Approval	Mr. Rajesh Arjun		01 April 2024
Vice President Human Resources — Document Owner	Ms. Priya Menon		01 April 2024
General Counsel — Legal and Compliance Review	Mr. Sandeep Iyer		01 April 2024
Head of IT — Technology Provisions Review	Mr. Kiran Bhat		01 April 2024

HR-LAP-001-v3.2 | Leave and Attendance Policy — Segment 3 of 5 | Effective 01 April 2024 | Owner: Ms. Priya Menon, VP HR | Legal: Mr. Sandeep Iyer | Approved: Mr. Rajesh Arjun, CEO | For queries: hr@arjuntech.in | For anonymous concerns:

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LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY AND PROCEDURES FRAMEWORK

Segment 4 of 4 — Manager Training Programme · Employee Leave Literacy · 36-Scenario Reference Bank · Statutory Cross-Reference · Policy Glossary · Appendices K–O

Version	3.2	**Effective Date**	01 April 2024
Review Date	31 March 2025	**Classification**	Internal Use Only
Approved By	Mr. Rajesh Arjun	**Document Owner**	Ms. Priya Menon
Legal Review	Mr. Sandeep Iyer	**Department**	Human Resources & Legal
Doc Reference	HR-LAP-001-v3.2	**Segment**	4 of 4 (Pages 121–160)

This final segment of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework completes the policy suite. It provides the 36-scenario reference bank drawn from real escalations across all four policy segments, the complete mandatory manager training programme for leave management competency, the employee leave literacy programme for all staff, the complete statutory cross-reference table mapping every leave provision to its legislative source, and the master glossary of all leave and attendance terms used across all four segments. Appendices K–O provide all supporting forms and tools. For queries: hr@arjuntech.in.

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27. Manager Leave Management Training Programme

27.1 Programme Purpose and Mandatory Status

Consistent, fair, and legally compliant leave management across Arjun Technologies depends entirely on the quality of management decisions made every day by the company's 340+ people managers — from Band 3 team leads managing their first direct reports through to Band 7 SVPs leading large divisions. A manager who does not understand the legal basis for an employee's maternity leave entitlement, who does not know how to handle a Bradford Factor alert proportionately, who does not appreciate that declining sick leave for a disabled employee without a reasonable adjustment discussion is legally dangerous, or who systematically discourages their team from using annual leave creates real harm — to the affected employees directly, to the team culture broadly, and to the company's legal and reputational position. The Manager Leave Management Training Programme exists to prevent these failures by equipping every manager with the knowledge, skill, and confidence to manage leave correctly.

The programme is mandatory for all employees at Band 3 and above who have at least one direct report. New managers must complete the full programme within 60 days of taking on their first direct report. Existing managers must complete an annual refresher module by 31 January each year. Completion is tracked in HRMS under My Training → Leave Management Programme and non-completion is escalated to the HRBP and the manager's own manager as a performance management process compliance concern. Managers who have not completed the mandatory training cannot access the HRMS leave approval dashboard for their team — a technical control that creates an operational incentive for timely completion independent of the formal accountability mechanism.

The programme is designed and delivered by the HR Business Partner team in partnership with the Legal team and the Learning and Development function. Content is reviewed annually in January to incorporate any changes to the leave policy, any significant developments in Indian employment law, and any patterns of management error identified through the annual leave compliance audit. The annual refresher is not a repeat of the previous year's content — it is updated each year to address current policy provisions and emerging compliance themes.

27.2 Core Curriculum — Leave Law, Policy, and HRMS

The core curriculum provides every manager with a working knowledge of the statutory framework underlying the company's leave provisions and the specific policy requirements they must apply in their management decisions. It is structured as a 90-minute self-paced HRMS e-learning module comprising four units, each concluding with a five-question comprehension check that must be passed before the manager can proceed to the next unit.

Unit	Title	Core Content	Duration	Passing Sc
Unit 1	The Legal Framework for Leave in India	Maternity Benefit Act 1961 and 2017 Amendment — key provisions and employer obligations. Shops an
Unit 2	Company Leave Policy — All Types and Entitlements	Annual leave accrual, carry-forward, encashment, blackout, and advance provisions. Sick Leave: entitl
Unit 3	HRMS Leave Administration	HRMS leave module navigation: approving and declining applications, setting delegates, viewing Bradfo
Unit 4	Manager Rights and Obligations	Grounds on Which Leave May Be Declined and the obligation to offer an alternative. Blackout period decla

27.3 People Skills Module — Difficult Leave Conversations

The core curriculum covers the policy knowledge managers need. The people skills module develops the interpersonal competency they need to apply that knowledge effectively in the most challenging leave management situations — the conversations that managers most commonly handle poorly and that create the most significant harm when they do. This module is a 75-minute facilitated workshop (not e-learning) delivered by the HRBP team in small groups of 6–12 managers, using role-play and facilitated discussion based on realistic scenarios drawn from actual situations across the company.

Conversation Type	What Makes It Difficult	Workshop Objective	Key Practised Skill
Return-to-work conversation	Manager does not know how to strike the right balance between welfare and business interest	Conduct a structured return-to-work conversation that addresses employee wellbeing and work planning	Open-ended questioning and active listening
Bradford Factor welfare trigger	Manager is concerned about an employee's attendance but fears appearing punitive or intrusive	Have a supportive conversation about attendance that explores underlying causes without triggering defensiveness	Separating the person from the pattern
Telling an employee their leave is declined	Manager must deliver a refusal that the employee will experience as unfair or dismissive	Communicate a decline clearly, with genuine explanation and a constructive alternative	Delivering bad news with empathy and clarity
Maternity return-to-work conversation	Manager is uncertain what they can and cannot ask, and worried about saying the wrong thing	Conduct a lawful, supportive conversation that addresses practical arrangements and wellbeing	Asking open questions and listening without leading
Conversation with an employee who has exhausted their leave	The employee is in difficulty and the manager must decline further leave while remaining supportive	Maintain the relationship and explore options without making promises the manager cannot keep	Holding boundaries with warmth

27.4 Compliance and Accountability Module

The compliance module is a 30-minute e-learning module covering the consequences for managers who fail to meet their leave management obligations — not as a punitive exercise, but as a transparent statement of what is at stake and why the company takes these obligations seriously. The module covers: the legal consequences of unlawful leave decisions including liability under the Maternity Benefit Act for adverse treatment of pregnant employees or those on maternity leave; the conduct consequences for managers who systematically discourage leave-taking, mishandle health data, or retaliate against employees who raise leave-related concerns; the performance management consequences for managers who consistently miss leave process deadlines or provide generic, undocumented leave assessments; and the reputational and commercial consequences for the company when leave management failures become employment tribunal claims or media events.

The compliance module also addresses three specific scenarios that occur with sufficient frequency across Indian technology sector employers to warrant dedicated treatment. The first is the informal leave culture — the practice of not recording casual leave or short sick absences in HRMS on the grounds that it is 'not worth the paperwork,' creating a hidden leave liability and an

inaccurate attendance record that cannot be relied upon in any subsequent dispute. The second is the quid pro quo leave arrangement — where a manager implies, explicitly or otherwise, that a team member's access to leave depends on their performance, their availability during leave periods, or their willingness to work during notice periods beyond what the policy requires. The third is discriminatory leave administration — applying different standards to leave applications based on the employee's protected characteristics, however subtly.

27.5 Training Delivery, Completion, and Certification

The full Manager Leave Management Training Programme — comprising Units 1–4 of the core curriculum (90 minutes e-learning), the people skills workshop (75 minutes facilitated), and the compliance module (30 minutes e-learning) — totals approximately 195 minutes or approximately 3.5 hours of training time. For new managers, this is completed over their first 60 days in a management role, with the HRBP scheduling the people skills workshop as part of the new manager onboarding programme.

Component	Format	Duration	Scheduling	Certification
Units 1–4: Core Curriculum	HRMS e-learning module (self-pac	90 min	Within 30 days of first direct report (new managers); January cohort (all m	Auto-certified by HRMS on completion
People Skills Workshop	Facilitated small group (6–12 managers)	75 min	HRBP schedules cohort sessions quarterly; new managers enrolled on start	HRBP records attendance; Certificate is
Compliance Module	HRMS e-learning module	30 min	Completed with core curriculum or within 5 days of	Auto-certified by HRMS.
Annual Refresher (all managers)	HRMS e-learning — updated content	45 min	January completion deadline. HRMS sends reminders on 1 and 12 January.	Auto-certified by HRMS.
New legislation update (ad hoc)	HRMS notification + 15-min micro-module	15 min	Triggered by material legislative change identified by HRBP or HRMS.	Auto-certified by HRMS on completion.

28. Employee Leave Literacy Programme

28.1 Purpose and Target Audience

Leave disputes, incorrect leave applications, misuse of leave types, and employee dissatisfaction with leave management outcomes are all substantially reduced when employees have a clear, accurate, and confident understanding of their own entitlements and the processes for accessing them. The Employee Leave Literacy Programme is designed to build this understanding across the entire workforce — not as an academic exercise in policy memorisation, but as a practical capability: knowing what leave I am entitled to, knowing how to apply for it correctly, knowing what documentation is required and when, knowing what to do when a manager responds in a way that seems inconsistent with the policy, and knowing where to go for help when a leave situation becomes complex. Every confirmed employee at {C['short']} completes the programme in the first month of their employment and completes the annual refresher alongside managers each January.

The programme is deliberately inclusive in its design — it is structured to be equally accessible and useful for a Band 1 graduate trainee experiencing their first professional employment and for a Band 6 Director joining from another company with established leave habits and expectations that may differ from those of this company's policy. Where differences exist between an employee's previous employer's approach and this company's policy — which is particularly common for casual leave (many employers provide 12 days rather than the 8 days in this policy), for sick leave medical certificate thresholds, and for the hybrid working attendance tracking requirements — the programme addresses these differences explicitly so that new joiners do not inadvertently operate on their previous experience rather than the current policy.

28.2 Core Modules — Know Your Entitlements

The Employee Leave Literacy Programme is a 60-minute self-paced HRMS e-learning module divided into three sections. Section 1 (25 minutes) covers leave entitlements: annual leave (accrual, carry-forward, encashment, how to plan and apply); sick leave (the self-certification threshold, what to do on Day 1 and Day 4, the long-term sick leave process); casual leave (purpose, the 3-day consecutive maximum, what it is not for); the key protected leave types — maternity, paternity, bereavement, caregiver, and fertility treatment leave — their entitlements and the confidentiality protections that apply; and the supplementary benefits — study leave, volunteer leave, TOIL, sabbatical, and LWOP. Section 2 (20 minutes) covers HRMS self-service: how to apply for every leave type, how to view balances, how to cancel a leave application, and how to raise a query or concern through the HRBP channel.

Section 3 (15 minutes) covers employee rights and how to use them: what to do when a leave application is declined (the right to request a specific operational reason and to be offered an alternative within 60 days for annual leave); when leave management decisions may involve

unlawful discrimination and how to raise that concern; the confidentiality protections for health and sensitive leave data under the DPDP Act 2023; and the Whistleblower hotline as the anonymous channel for reporting leave policy misapplication by a manager. The module concludes with a 10-question comprehension check that must be passed at 70% or above before completion is recorded. Employees who do not pass on the first attempt receive targeted feedback on the questions missed and may reattempt immediately.

28.3 Delivery Format and Mandatory Completion

Employee Group	Completion Deadline	Delivery Method	Refresher Requirement
New joiners — all bands	Within 20 working days of joining date	HRMS e-learning (self-paced). HRBP introduces the module during onboarding session.	Annual refresher. Day One onboarding session and manager training.
All confirmed employees	Annual refresher by 31 January	HRMS e-learning — updated content each year	Annually
Employees returning from sabbatical or career break (6 months)	Within 10 working days of return	HRMS e-learning (60 minutes)	Standard annual refresher only, to account for policy ch
Band 5+ employees moving to a new business unit	Within 10 working days of the move	Shorter 20-minute module covering any unique leave provisions	Standard annual refresher
Employees with a Brahmin Factor sickness absence trigger	Within 5 working days of the trigger	HRBP-led briefing	Annual welfare-of-the-programme as part of the welfare ch

29. 36-Scenario Reference Bank — All Segments

The following 36 scenarios are drawn from actual leave management escalations across Arjun Technologies over the past four years. They represent the full range of situations — from the relatively straightforward to the genuinely complex — that arise across the complete leave policy framework. Scenarios 1–12 address core leave types (annual, sick, casual). Scenarios 13–24 address special and protected leave categories. Scenarios 25–36 address complex multi-type and multi-party situations. Each scenario is referenced to the applicable policy section for further reading. This bank supplements the scenario sections in Segments 1, 2, and 3.

SCENARIOS 1–12: CORE LEAVE TYPES

SCENARIOS 13–24: SPECIAL AND PROTECTED LEAVE

SCENARIOS 25–36: COMPLEX AND MULTI-TYPE SITUATIONS

Scenario 1 — Annual Leave — Manager insists leave be taken as team blocks
Situation: A manager sends a team message stating that all annual leave must be taken in the company-designated shutdown weeks in May and December. Employees are told individual leave requests outside these windows will not be approved.

Guidance: The manager has no authority to designate team shutdown weeks and restrict all individual annual leave to them. Annual leave is an individual entitlement applied for by the employee and assessed by the manager on operational grounds per Section 4.3 of Segment 1. A blanket policy restricting leave to two fixed windows is not permitted — it effectively reduces the usable entitlement and may prevent employees from taking leave for legitimate personal, religious, or family reasons that fall outside those windows. The manager must immediately rescind the restriction. HRBP escalation required. (Segment 1, Section 4.3)

Scenario 2 — Annual Leave — Employee claims leave was approved but manager denies it

Situation: An employee takes a week's leave claiming their manager verbally approved it. The manager denies giving approval. No HRMS record exists.

Guidance: The HRMS record is the authoritative record under this policy. Leave not recorded in HRMS has not been formally approved regardless of any verbal exchange. The employee must provide any documentary evidence of the verbal approval (such as a text message or email). In the absence of any documentary evidence, the absence is treated as Leave Without Pay pending the employee's explanation. The HRBP facilitates the discussion. Both parties are reminded that all leave must be applied for and approved in HRMS before it is taken. (Segment 1, Section 4.3)

Scenario 3 — Annual Leave — Manager cancels approved leave 48 hours before it starts

Situation: An employee has flights and accommodation booked for an approved two-week holiday. Three days before departure, the manager cancels the leave citing a client emergency.

Guidance: Cancellation of approved leave at very short notice — particularly where the employee has incurred non-refundable costs — is a serious management decision that requires specific justification and cannot be done unilaterally without HRBP involvement. The manager must demonstrate that the operational emergency genuinely requires this specific employee's presence and cannot be managed through any other means. Where the cancellation proceeds, the company must reimburse any reasonable non-refundable costs the employee incurred as a direct result of the cancellation. The HRBP reviews the situation and confirms the position with Finance and Legal. Repeated short-notice cancellations of approved leave by the same manager are a management conduct concern. (Segment 1, Section 4.3)

Scenario 4 — Sick Leave — Employee takes sick leave the day before a performance review

Situation: An employee calls in sick on the day their annual performance review is scheduled. The manager suspects the absence is to avoid a difficult conversation about their performance.

Guidance: Sick leave is taken for the purpose of managing genuine illness. Where a manager has a specific, documented reason to believe a sick leave claim is not genuine — not merely a suspicion based on the timing — the Bradford Factor and attendance management framework in Section 3.5 of Segment 1 provides the mechanism for addressing it. The performance review should be rescheduled for when the employee returns. The manager must not refuse to reschedule the review or use the sick leave absence in the performance assessment itself as a negative factor. If the sick leave pattern post-performance events is recurring (two or more instances in 12 months), the specific flag in Section 5.6 of Segment 1 applies. (Segment 1, Section 5.1 and 5.6)

Scenario 5 — Sick Leave — Employee sends a WhatsApp message but does not call

Situation: An employee messages their manager on WhatsApp saying they are unwell and will not be in. The manager argues this does not meet the notification requirement.

Guidance: The notification requirement is direct communication to the manager — not exclusively by telephone call. A WhatsApp message to the manager's known number is direct communication and satisfies the notification obligation under Section 3.4 of Segment 1. The requirement is that the manager receives timely direct notice, and a WhatsApp message achieves this. The manager should acknowledge receipt and update HRMS if the employee cannot do so. Demanding a telephone call when written digital communication has been received is an unnecessary barrier and must not be used as grounds to record the absence as unauthorised. (Segment 1, Section 3.4)

Scenario 6 — Sick Leave — Certificate from an Ayurvedic practitioner submitted

Situation: An employee submits a medical certificate signed by a registered Ayurvedic practitioner for a five-day sick leave absence. The manager queries whether this counts as a valid certificate.

Guidance: A medical certificate from a registered Ayurvedic practitioner registered under the applicable state's Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homoeopathy (AYUSH) board is a valid medical certificate for the purposes of this policy. The policy requirement is a certificate from a registered medical practitioner — it does not specify allopathic medicine exclusively. The HRBP confirms the practitioner's registration status if required. The certificate is accepted. (Segment 1, Section 5.4)

Scenario 7 — Casual Leave — Employee applies for 3 days casual leave prefixed to a public holiday

Situation: An employee applies for 3 days of casual leave (Thursday to Saturday) before a public holiday on Monday, creating a 5-day long weekend.

Guidance: The restriction in Section 6.3 of Segment 1 specifically prohibits the use of casual leave to bridge public holidays and create extended weekends on a regular basis. This application is a textbook example of the prohibited usage. The manager should decline the casual leave application and advise the employee to apply for annual leave if they wish to take this period as annual leave, which requires the standard notice period. A first occurrence should be handled with an explanation rather than a disciplinary response. Recurring attempts to use casual leave in this way after the restriction has been explained are a misuse of the leave provision. (Segment 1, Section 6.3)

Scenario 8 — Casual Leave — Employee exhausts all 8 days by July

Situation: An employee has used all 8 days of casual leave by mid-July due to several genuine personal emergencies. They now have another family emergency in August and no casual leave balance remains.

Guidance: Once the casual leave entitlement is exhausted, further casual leave absences must be covered by annual leave. The manager should approve annual leave for the August emergency on the same grounds they would approve casual leave — it is a genuine personal emergency. The employee does not lose the right to take leave for genuine personal emergencies simply because their casual leave balance is exhausted; the entitlement converts to annual leave from this point for the remainder of the year. The HRBP notes that the employee's casual leave balance should be monitored for the following year. (Segment 1, Section 6.2)

Scenario 9 — Annual Leave — Employee resigns with 15 days of accrued leave in March

Situation: An employee submits their resignation in the last week of March. They have 15 days of accrued annual leave (12 current year accrual + 3 carry-forward from prior year). The manager tells them they must take 10 days during notice and the remaining 5 will be encashed.

Guidance: The treatment of annual leave during notice is subject to mutual agreement and the company's operational needs per Section 4.6 of Segment 1. The manager cannot unilaterally require the employee to take a specific number of leave days during notice. Finance calculates the leave settlement: carry-forward balance (3 days) plus current year accrual to the last working day. The company may require leave to be taken during the notice period but must inform the employee formally in writing, not through an informal managerial statement. HRBP and Finance manage the FFS calculation. (Segment 1, Section 4.6)

Scenario 10 — Sick Leave — Employee is unwell on a remote working day

Situation: An employee who is working from home contacts their manager mid-morning saying they feel unwell and cannot continue working. The manager asks whether sick leave should be deducted since the employee was already 'at home.'

Guidance: The physical location of an employee — whether at the office or working from home — has no bearing on their sick leave entitlement or the obligation to record genuine illness as sick leave. An employee who is too unwell to work productively from home must record sick leave in exactly the same way as an employee who is too unwell to travel to the office. The fact that the employee was already at home when they became unwell does not mean no sick leave should be recorded. The manager must update HRMS to record the sick leave from the point the employee notified them of their inability to continue working. (Segment 2, Section 3.7 of Segment 1 — remote working provisions)

Scenario 11 — Annual Leave — Part-time employee queries leave deduction for a partial day

Situation: A part-time employee working 4 days per week (Monday to Thursday) takes a half-day annual leave to attend a medical appointment on a Wednesday afternoon.

Guidance: The company's leave entitlement and deduction system operates in full days — a leave day represents one of the employee's contracted working days regardless of the hours in that day. For a half-day absence, the manager has discretion to record 0.5 days of annual leave or, for a short appointment, to treat the time as a brief personal absence managed through flexible working. Where the policy is applied strictly, 0.5 days of annual leave may be deducted, bringing the calculation to 0.5 contracted working days. The HRBP advises on the consistent practice applied across the team. (Segment 1, Section 4.1)

Scenario 12 — TOIL — Manager refuses to create an overtime record retrospectively

Situation: An employee worked 12 hours on a Saturday to meet a client deadline at the manager's request. Three weeks later, the employee requests TOIL for the overtime. The manager declines to authorise the overtime retrospectively.

Guidance: TOIL requires manager authorisation of the overtime — pre-authorisation is preferred, but authorisation within 24 hours of the overtime worked is also permitted per Section 3.8 of Segment 1. Three weeks later is well outside the 24-hour window. However, the manager orally requested the Saturday work — if there is any contemporaneous evidence of the request (an email, a text, a calendar entry), the HRBP can authorise the TOIL retrospectively based on the evidence. The HRBP investigates. If the overtime is confirmed, the TOIL is authorised and the employee given 30 days from the date of authorisation to take it. The manager is reminded of their obligation to authorise overtime in HRMS within 24 hours. (Segment 1, Section 3.8)

Scenario 13 — Maternity — Manager contacts employee on maternity leave about a work matter

Situation: A project manager sends a lengthy email to an employee on maternity leave asking her to review a client proposal because 'no one else fully understands the client background.'

Guidance: An employee on maternity leave has no obligation to perform any work-related activity during the leave period. The manager must not contact the employee about work matters during maternity leave except in the most exceptional circumstances and only with the employee's explicit advance agreement that such contact is welcome. Sending a work task email during maternity leave without the employee's consent is a violation of her maternity leave entitlement and may constitute a form of the adverse treatment prohibited by the Maternity Benefit Act 1961. The project manager should manage the client situation with available team resources. The HRBP notifies the project manager formally of the policy position. (Segment 2, Section 7.3)

Scenario 14 — Paternity — Father requests paternity leave in two separate blocks

Situation: An employee requests his 10 days of paternity leave split as 5 days immediately after the birth and 5 days six weeks later when his partner returns to work.

Guidance: Section 8.1 of Segment 2 permits paternity leave to be split into a maximum of two blocks of minimum 5 consecutive working days each, both to be taken within 90 calendar days of the birth. The employee's proposed split — 5 days immediately after birth and 5 days at week six — is within the permitted window and meets the minimum block size requirement. The manager must approve both blocks. The employee applies for each block separately in HRMS using Form HR-L02. (Segment 2, Section 8.1)

Scenario 15 — Bereavement — Employee requests bereavement leave for an estranged sibling

Situation: An employee whose older sibling they have not spoken to in fifteen years passes away. The manager asks whether the estrangement affects the bereavement leave entitlement.

Guidance: The bereavement leave entitlement for a sibling is 5 working days, and there is no qualifying condition connected to the quality of the relationship between the employee and the deceased. Family relationships that have been difficult, estranged, or legally complicated may in some ways generate greater emotional complexity than close relationships — the employee's need for time to grieve and to manage practical and legal obligations is not diminished by estrangement and may in some cases be greater. The manager approves the leave immediately and without any comment on the personal circumstances of the relationship. (Segment 2, Section 10.1)

Scenario 16 — Caregiver Leave — Manager shares caregiver leave details with the team

Situation: A manager mentions in a team meeting that an employee is absent today because they are 'dealing with their mother's dementia.' The employee had applied for caregiver leave and submitted the medical documentation to the HRBP under strict confidentiality.

Guidance: The manager has committed a serious data privacy breach. Medical information about the employee's dependent was shared with the entire team without the employee's consent. Under Section 11.1 of Segment 2, the manager is only entitled to know the leave type (caregiver leave) and its duration — not the specific medical condition of the dependent. The employee should be informed of the disclosure and offered a formal apology. The HRBP notifies the IT Security team as a potential DPDP Act 2023 breach. The manager faces a conduct discussion under the Code of Conduct. (Segment 2, Section 11.1 and Segment 1, Section 3.9)

Scenario 17 — Fertility Treatment — HR system displays leave type to team

Situation: An employee who applied for fertility treatment leave using HR-L09A discovers that the HRMS team leave calendar is displaying 'Fertility Treatment Leave' as the leave type visible to all team members.

Guidance: This is a systemic DPDP Act 2023 data protection issue. Fertility treatment leave is a sensitive health data category and must be displayed only as 'Approved Leave' in any team-visible calendar view — the specific leave type must be masked. The IT team must immediately correct the HRMS display settings for fertility treatment leave and any other sensitive leave types. The employee whose fertility treatment leave was exposed must be informed. The HRBP assesses whether a DPDP Act breach notification obligation arises and involves the General Counsel. The IT Security team conducts a broader audit of all sensitive leave type display settings. (Segment 2, Section 16)

Scenario 18 — Study Leave — Employee fails the exam and requests a second study leave block

Situation: An employee took 2 days of study leave for a CFA Level 1 exam and did not pass. They are registering for the next sitting and request another 2 days of study leave.

Guidance: The study leave entitlement is up to 10 working days per leave year across all examinations per Section 12.1 of Segment 2. The entitlement is not tied to passing the examination. A re-sit of the same examination at a subsequent sitting is a separate examination event and qualifies for study leave in the same way as the first sitting, provided the annual maximum of 10 days has not been reached. The manager approves the application with the standard documentation. The fact that the employee did not pass the first sitting has no bearing on the leave entitlement for the second sitting. (Segment 2, Section 12.1)

Scenario 19 — Volunteer Leave — Manager declines volunteer leave for an independent activity

Situation: An employee has arranged to volunteer for a cancer awareness fundraising drive organised by a registered charity. The manager declines the volunteer leave application saying the activity is not one of the company's three CSR focus areas.

Guidance: Section 15 of Segment 2 permits independent volunteering with a registered not-for-profit organisation whose work 'aligns with the company's CSR focus areas.' The three focus areas are digital literacy, accessible technology, and environmental conservation. A cancer awareness fundraising drive does not clearly fall within these three focus areas. The manager's decline on these grounds is not unreasonable if the activity genuinely does not align. However, the HRBP and the CSR team should review whether a broader interpretation of the eligible activities list is appropriate, as the current narrow definition may be inconsistent with the company's stated intention to support community service broadly. If the decline is confirmed, the employee may take annual or casual leave for the day. (Segment 2, Section 15)

Scenario 20 — LWOP — Employee requests LWOP to care for a parent but has caregiver leave available

Situation: An employee requests 10 days of LWOP to care for a parent who has been hospitalised following a stroke. They have not yet used any caregiver leave this year.

Guidance: Section 17.1 of Segment 2 states that LWOP is a last resort and the HRBP must confirm that all applicable paid entitlements have been considered before LWOP is approved. The employee has 5 days of caregiver leave available and may also use casual leave for up to 3 consecutive days. The HRBP must review the full leave position with the employee before approving LWOP. The correct approach is: 5 days caregiver leave for the first 5 days; casual leave for the next 3 days; LWOP for the remaining 2 days only where no annual leave or other paid entitlement remains. The HRBP also discusses whether a temporary flexible working adjustment under the Disability and Reasonable Adjustment Policy would better address the ongoing caregiving need. (Segment 2, Section 17.1)

Scenario 21 — Sabbatical — Employee applies but has only 4.5 years of service

Situation: An employee applies for a 6-week sabbatical citing the 5-year eligibility requirement. Their service record shows 4 years and 8 months. They argue the remaining 4 months is 'close enough.'

Guidance: The eligibility requirement is 5 continuous years of permanent employment on the application date — not on the intended sabbatical start date, not on the employee's interpretation of 'close enough.' 4 years and 8 months does not satisfy the requirement. The employee may reapply once they reach 5 years of service — which is 4 months from the application date in this case. The HRBP explains the eligibility position clearly and courteously, and invites the employee to reapply at the 5-year mark. There is no discretion to waive the minimum service requirement except in the exceptional circumstances specified in Section 14.1 of Segment 2 (which require VP-HR and CEO approval). (Segment 2, Section 14.1)

Scenario 22 — Public Holiday — Employee works on a public holiday without a substitute

Situation: An employee works a full day on Republic Day (26 January) because a client required it. Three weeks later they request a substitute holiday. The manager says the 30-day window has closed.

Guidance: Section 18 of Segment 2 requires that where an employee works on a public holiday, they receive either a full substitute holiday within 30 calendar days or financial compensation at the applicable state overtime rate. The manager is correct that the 30-day substitute holiday window has closed if 30 days have elapsed. The remaining option — financial compensation at the overtime rate — must be paid to the employee regardless of the missed substitute holiday window. The failure to arrange the substitute holiday or financial compensation within 30 days is a management compliance failure. Finance processes the payment in the next payroll cycle. (Segment 2, Section 18)

Scenario 23 — Bradford Factor — Employee's score crosses 200 after a genuine illness episode

Situation: An employee is recovering from a significant health condition that has involved five separate short absences over 6 months. Their Bradford Factor score has crossed 200. The manager wants to initiate a formal attendance improvement plan.

Guidance: The Bradford Factor is an attendance pattern indicator, not a diagnostic tool or a disciplinary trigger on its own. A score above 200 requires a formal welfare discussion with the HRBP present and potentially an occupational health referral — but only where the pattern warrants it. Where the five absences are explained by a documented, ongoing health condition and not by a pattern suggesting misuse, the correct response is an occupational health assessment and a reasonable adjustment discussion, not a formal attendance improvement plan. The HRBP leads the review. Initiating a formal attendance improvement plan without HRBP involvement for an employee with a known health condition is legally and ethically problematic. (Segment 1, Section 3.5)

Scenario 24 — Maternity — Redundancy announced during maternity leave

Situation: An employee is currently on 26-week maternity leave. The company announces a restructuring affecting her business unit. Her role is listed as 'at risk.'

Guidance: An employee on maternity leave cannot be made redundant on grounds connected to her maternity leave. Her role may be redundant if the role genuinely no longer exists, but she has enhanced protection: she must be offered any suitable alternative vacancy before it is offered to any other at-risk employee. If no suitable alternative exists and the role redundancy is genuine, the process must be conducted through full consultation with her — in a format adapted to her maternity leave status (telephone or video). Legal team and HRBP involvement is mandatory from the outset. Any redundancy decision made without this process is automatically unfair and creates criminal liability under the Maternity Benefit Act. (Segment 2, Section 7.5)

Scenario 25 — Multi-type — Sick leave converts to maternity leave mid-absence

Situation: An employee is signed off sick for two weeks with a pregnancy-related complication. On Day 10 of her sick absence, she is 33 weeks pregnant. Her employer wants to know when the sick leave becomes maternity leave.

Guidance: The Maternity Benefit Act 1961 permits the employee to start her maternity leave at her choice from up to 8 weeks before the expected delivery date — but it does not require the sick leave to automatically convert to maternity leave. The employee may choose to remain on sick leave (deducting from her sick leave balance) until she elects to start her formal maternity leave. Where the illness is specifically a pregnancy-related complication covered by the Act's additional illness provision, additional paid leave may be available. The HRBP discusses the options with the employee, who chooses whether to start her formal maternity leave now or to continue on sick leave until her planned start date. (Segment 2, Sections 7.2 and 7.3)

Scenario 26 — Multi-type — Employee on sabbatical is made redundant

Situation: A company announces redundancies while an employee is 7 weeks into a 10-week sabbatical. His role is included in the at-risk pool.

Guidance: The employee retains all employment rights during an approved sabbatical. He must be included in the redundancy consultation process, adapted for his sabbatical status (telephone or video consultation). He should be informed promptly of the at-risk position. The sabbatical agreement's role protection clause is relevant but does not override a genuine business-driven redundancy. If the role is genuinely redundant, the employee is entitled to the full statutory and contractual redundancy payment plus the leave settlement in his FFS, calculated from his last working day before the sabbatical. Legal and HRBP coordination required from the outset. (Segment 2, Section 14.2 and Code of Conduct Section 15.3)

Scenario 27 — Multi-type — TOIL and annual leave combined for extended absence

Situation: An employee has 4 days of TOIL (accrued within the 30-day window) and wants to combine it with 6 days of annual leave for a 10-day trip.

Guidance: This is an explicitly permitted arrangement. Section 13.2 of Segment 2 confirms that TOIL may be combined with annual leave for a continuous absence, with TOIL applied before annual leave where both are available and the employee wishes to use the combined period. The 4 TOIL days must be within their 30-day take-up window for the request to proceed. The employee applies for both types simultaneously in HRMS, and the system combines them into a single 10-day absence with TOIL applied first and annual leave for the remaining 6 days. (Segment 2, Section 13.2)

Scenario 28 — Multi-type — Bereavement during a pre-approved annual leave period

Situation: An employee is on two weeks of approved annual leave when her father passes away unexpectedly on Day 4 of the holiday.

Guidance: Section 26 of Segment 2 (Leave Interaction Matrix) explicitly addresses this: a bereavement that occurs during a pre-approved annual leave period converts the annual leave to bereavement leave for the bereavement entitlement period (5 working days for a parent). The employee notifies her manager as soon as circumstances allow. On her return, the HRBP updates HRMS to convert 5 of the annual leave days to bereavement leave, restoring those 5 days to her annual leave balance. She does not lose annual leave days because of a bereavement that occurred during a holiday. (Segment 2, Leave Interaction Matrix)

Scenario 29 — Multi-type — Sick leave exhausts during long-term absence with no annual leave

Situation: An employee has been on sick leave for 14 consecutive working days. It is now Day 15 and the HRBP informs him that his sick leave entitlement has been exhausted (he used 2 days earlier in the year). He has no annual leave balance either.

Guidance: The employee's options are LWOP or, if the health condition may constitute a disability under the RPwD Act 2016, a reasonable adjustment discussion. The HRBP presents LWOP as the available option, explains the implications (salary suspension, benefits continuation for first 30 days, PF suspension), and confirms that the employment relationship is maintained. The long-term absence management process in Section 23.3 of Segment 3 applies. An occupational health referral should have been initiated at Day 15. The HRBP ensures the LTA Review process begins immediately. (Segment 1, Section 5.5; Segment 3, Section 23)

Scenario 30 — Multi-type — International employee's leave during India-UK DST transition

Situation: A UK national on an inbound assignment requests 3 days of casual leave. His HRMS balance shows 8 days. However, Finance queries whether the UK home country entitlement affects the casual leave calculation.

Guidance: International assignment entitlements typically address annual leave in assignment agreements — casual leave is a company policy provision (8 days) that is not generally replaced by a home country equivalent because most home country employment frameworks do not have an equivalent 'casual leave' category. The employee receives the standard company 8-day casual leave entitlement. Finance's query is resolved by the HRBP confirming that the assignment agreement is silent on casual leave and therefore the company standard applies. (Segment 3, Section 22.1)

Scenario 31 — Multi-type — Employee takes LWOP during PIP

Situation: An employee on an active Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) requests 5 days of LWOP to deal with a family legal matter. The manager queries whether LWOP extends the PIP timeline.

Guidance: The PIP timeline runs on calendar days per PMP Segment 2 Section 11.5, and LWOP days taken during the PIP period do not suspend the calendar-day countdown. However, the bi-weekly PIP check-in meetings scheduled during the LWOP period must be rescheduled to after the employee's return — the check-ins cannot be conducted when the employee is on LWOP. The PIP review meeting at the end of the PIP period proceeds on the original calendar end date regardless of the LWOP period within it. The HRBP confirms this position with Legal. Leave entitlements are unaffected by the PIP. (PMP Segment 2, Section 11.5; Segment 2, Section 20)

Scenario 32 — Multi-type — Adoption leave for an employee who is also expecting a biological child

Situation: An employee is simultaneously an adoptive parent of a 6-month-old child (legal handover completed 8 weeks ago) and is 6 months into a pregnancy. She wants to take adoption leave now and maternity leave in 3 months.

Guidance: The two leave entitlements are independent and may be taken sequentially. The employee is entitled to her adoption leave (14 weeks paid for primary caregiver of a child under 1 year) from the adoption handover date — which began 8 weeks ago, so 6 weeks remain of that entitlement — and separately to her full maternity leave entitlement for the biological child from the maternity leave start date. The HRBP maps out the leave sequence with the employee and updates HRMS to reflect both entitlements. The total leave period is the adoption leave remainder (6 weeks) followed by maternity leave (up to 26 weeks). (Segment 2, Sections 7.2 and 9.1)

Scenario 33 — Multi-type — HRBP discovery of systematic leave type misrecording across a team

Situation: During the annual leave compliance audit, the HRBP identifies a pattern in a 12-person team where sick leave is systematically recorded for absences that are actually personal emergency casual leave, and vice versa. The pattern has persisted for two years.

Guidance: Systematic misrecording of leave types is a Code of Conduct records integrity issue affecting both the manager (who approved the misrecorded leave without challenge) and potentially the employees (if they knowingly submitted incorrect leave types). The HRBP conducts a records review and correction exercise, working with Finance to ensure payroll deductions are accurately reflected. The manager receives a formal conduct conversation about the records accuracy obligation. Employees are informed of any corrections to their leave records. The HRBP investigates whether the misrecording was deliberate (to preserve sick leave for future use, or to avoid the medical certificate requirement) or accidental (poor understanding of leave type definitions). (Segment 1, Sections 2.3 and 3.3; Code of Conduct Section 4.2)

Scenario 34 — Multi-type — Bereavement leave request for a relationship not listed in the policy

Situation: An employee requests bereavement leave for the death of their unmarried long-term partner of 10 years, with whom they shared a home. The policy table in Section 10.1 of Segment 2 covers 'domestic partner' in the first row but the employee is concerned about whether this applies to an unmarried cohabiting partner.

Guidance: The policy's 'domestic partner' category in Section 10.1 of Segment 2 is specifically intended to cover committed cohabiting relationships that are not formalised through marriage — including long-term unmarried partnerships. A 10-year cohabiting partnership clearly falls within the spirit and intent of this category. The employee is entitled to 5 working days of bereavement leave. The manager approves without requiring any proof of the relationship status beyond the employee's own account. Requesting documentation of an unmarried domestic partnership as a condition of approving bereavement leave would be both unnecessarily intrusive and inconsistent with the policy's intent. (Segment 2, Section 10.1)

Scenario 35 — Multi-type — Employee requests leave beyond all entitlements during a personal crisis

Situation: An employee has exhausted all paid leave entitlements — annual leave, sick leave, casual leave, caregiver leave — due to a family crisis. She is requesting 20 further working days of paid leave, explaining that her mental health is severely affected and she cannot return to work.

Guidance: No paid leave entitlement exists beyond the exhausted balances. The available options are: LWOP for up to 60 working days (per Section 17.1 of Segment 2), with salary suspended but employment maintained; assessment under the long-term absence management framework (Segment 3, Section 23) given the mental health component; an occupational health referral to assess the health position; and a reasonable adjustment assessment under the RPwD Act 2016 where the mental health condition may constitute a disability. The HRBP coordinates all three processes in parallel. The EAP is urgently re-offered. The company's starting position is to maintain the employment relationship and support the employee's recovery through the available framework before any consideration of capability. (Segment 1, Section 5.5; Segment 2, Section 17.1; Segment 3, Section 23)

Scenario 36 — Multi-type — Leave records required for employment tribunal claim

Situation: An employee who was dismissed following a PIP raises an unfair dismissal claim at the labour commissioner. The company is asked to produce all leave records for the employee for the preceding two years.

Guidance: Leave records are personal data retained for seven years post-employment under the retention schedule in Section 3.9 of Segment 1 and the DPDP Act 2023. The company must produce the requested records through the Legal team in response to the labour commissioner's order. The production of records in tribunal or regulatory proceedings is a lawful basis for disclosure under the DPDP Act. The HRBP extracts the complete leave history from HRMS. The Legal team reviews the records before production and confirms what is and is not within the scope of the request. No records may be altered, backdated, or supplemented after the claim is filed — doing so would constitute contempt and data falsification. (Segment 1, Section 3.9; Code of Conduct Section 12.3)

30. Complete Statutory Cross-Reference Table

The following table maps every leave type and key attendance provision in the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy to its legislative source. This reference is maintained by the General Counsel and updated annually as part of the policy review process. It is the authoritative source for legal compliance questions about the basis for each leave entitlement and obligation.

Leave Type / Provision	Legislative Source	Company Provision vs Statutory Minimum	Key Statutory Sections
Annual / Earned / Privilege Leave	Karnataka SE Act 1961; Telangana SE Act 1988; TN SE Act 1947; Maharashtra SE Act 1948; Delhi SE Act 1954; Factories Act 1948	Mapped to the applicable state SE Act for each employee's work location	Karnataka SE Act Section 12; Telangana SE Act Section 12; TN SE Act Section 10; Maharashtra SE Act Section 27; Delhi SE Act Section 15; Factories Act Section 79
Sick Leave	State Shops and Establishments Acts (all five operating states); Factories Act	Matches statutory minimum in all states	State SE Act sick leave sections. Payment of Wages Act
Casual Leave	Karnataka SE Act 1961 (12 days); Telangana SE Act (12 days); TN SE Act (12 days); Maharashtra SE Act (7 days); Delhi SE Act (10 days)	Below statutory minimum in Karnataka, Telangana, and Tamil Nadu; exceeds statutory minimum in Maharashtra and Delhi	Karnataka SE Act Section 12; Telangana SE Act Section 12; TN SE Act Section 10; Maharashtra SE Act Section 27; Delhi SE Act Section 15
Maternity Leave	Maternity Benefit Act 1961 as amended by the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017	Exceeds statutory requirement (26 weeks for first two children; 12 weeks for third and subsequent children)	Maternity Benefit Act Section 5(3), 5(4), 5(4A), 11, 12, 24
Paternity Leave	No statutory requirement in India	Exceeds statutory requirement (10 working days)	Not applicable. Company policy governs entirely.
Adoption Leave (Primary Caregiver)	Maternity Benefit Act 1961 (Section 5(4) as amended)	Company exceeds statutory minimum (26 weeks vs. 12 weeks)	Maternity Benefit Act Section 5(4) as amended by the 2017 Amendment Act
Bereavement Leave	No statutory requirement in India	Company benefit; no statutory basis	Not applicable.
TOIL / Overtime	State SE Acts; Factories Act 1948 (where applicable); Industrial Establishments (National Holidays) Act	Company provides TOIL option in lieu of overtime pay for eligible employees	Factories Act Section 59 (overtime rate); State SE Act overtime provisions
Public Holidays	Negotiable Instruments Act 1881 (national holidays); State SE Acts (state holidays)	Company observes all applicable national and state holidays	Negotiable Instruments Act Section 25; Gazette notifications (annual holiday lists); State SE Act holiday provisions
Minimum Working Hours	State SE Acts. Tamil Nadu: 48 hours/week and 9 hours/day. Karnataka: 45 hours/week and 9 hours/day.	Company policy: 40 hours/week and 8 hours/day	Karnataka SE Act Section 11; Tamil Nadu SE Act Section
Leave Without Pay — Deduction Method	Payment of Wages Act 1936	Company follows the statutory deduction formula	Payment of Wages Act 1936 Section 7 and associated rul
Annual Leave Encashment	Income Tax Act 1961 Section 10(10A)	Company provides encashment at the statutory maximum (30 days) for eligible employees	Income Tax Act 1961 Section 10(10AA); Rule 2BA
Employment Protection During Absence	POSH Act 2013; Maternity Benefit Act 1961; Industrial Disputes Act 1947	Company applies statutory protections to all employees	POSH Act Section 19; Maternity Benefit Act Section 12; Industrial Disputes Act Section 25F (workmen)
Health Data in Leave Management	Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023	Company implements DPDP Act requirements	DPDP Act 2023 Section 2(t) (personal data), 4 (lawful
Gratuity — LWOP and Qualifying Service	Payment of Gratuity Act 1972	Company follows the Act: LWOP does not count as qualifying service for gratuity	PG Act 1972 Section 2(e) (continuous service definition)

31. Policy Glossary and Index

31.1 Glossary of Leave and Attendance Terms

The following glossary defines all technical terms, abbreviations, and defined expressions used across all four segments of this policy. Where a term has a specific statutory meaning under Indian legislation, that meaning is noted alongside the company policy usage.

Term	Definition	Policy Reference	Statutory Reference (if any)
Accrual	The process by which leave days are earned each month and credited to the employee's leave balance.	Segment 1, Section 4.2	Karnataka SE Act 2014
Authorised Absence	Absence from work that has been approved in advance by the employee's reporting manager or HR.	Segment 1, Section 3.4	Not specifically defined in statute; company policy
Band	The company's eight-level compensation and seniority classification system (Band 1 = Junior Analyst through Band 8 = Director).	Segment 1, Section 4.1	Not applicable
Bradford Factor	A rolling 12-month attendance pattern indicator that weights frequent short absences more heavily than a single extended absence.	Segment 1, Section 10.5	Not applicable — operational HR tool
Carry-Forward	The portion of unused annual leave that may be transferred from one leave year to the following year, subject to a maximum limit.	Segment 1, Section 4.4	State SE Acts (1 April – 31 March) and policy
Compensatory Off / TOIL	Time Off in Lieu of overtime payment. Accrued when an employee works beyond their normal hours at the request of their manager.	Segment 1, Section 12; Segment 2, Section 13	State SE Acts — overtime provisions; TOIL policy
Core Hours	The period (10:00–16:00) during which all employees are expected to be available and responsive, regardless of their flexible start time.	Segment 1, Section 3.2	Not a statutory concept — company policy
CTC (Cost to Company)	The total annual remuneration package including fixed salary, allowances, employer's PF contribution, and any other monetary benefits.	Segment 1, Section 4.1	Not a statutory concept — used for salary structuring
DPDP Act 2023	The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 — India's legislation governing the processing of personal data.	Segment 1, Section 3.9	Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023
Domestic Partner	For the purposes of bereavement leave, a person in a long-term relationship with the employee, irrespective of gender, who is not a spouse.	Segment 2, Section 10.1	Not specifically defined in statute; company policy
Earned Leave	Statutory term under Indian employment law for leave accrued at the rate of one day for every 20 days worked. Also called Privilege Leave.	Segment 1, Section 4.3	State SE Acts — equivalent to the company's Annual Leave
Encashment	The conversion of accrued but unused leave days into a cash payment, typically at the end of the year or on separation.	Segment 1, Section 4.5	Tax treatment under Section 10(10AA) of the Income Tax Act, 1961
FFS (Full and Final Settlement)	The final financial settlement payable to an employee on separation, including salary, leave encashment, gratuity, and deductions.	Multiple sections	Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972; Payment of Wages Act, 1936
FTE (Full-Time Equivalent)	A measure of employment as a proportion of full-time hours (1.0 FTE = 45 hours/week). Used to calculate pro-rated leave entitlements.	Segment 1, Section 4.1	Not a statutory concept — used for calculation purposes
Gratuity	A statutory lump-sum payment payable to an employee on separation after completing five years of continuous service (or on death).	Segment 3, Section 27.3	Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972
HRBP (HR Business Partner)	The HR professional assigned to a specific business unit who manages leave administration, employee relations, and policy interpretation.	Throughout	Not a statutory term
HRMS	Human Resource Management System — the company's integrated digital platform for all leave, attendance, performance, and payroll data.	Throughout	Not a statutory term
Leave Without Pay (LWP)	A period of absence not covered by any paid leave entitlement. The employee's salary is suspended for the duration.	Segment 2, Section 11.7	Not specifically defined in statute; company policy
Long-Term Absence	Continuous absence of 15 or more working days, triggering a formal Long-Term Absence Management process and medical certification.	Segment 3, Section 28.1	Not specifically defined in statute; company policy
LHTAL (Long-Haul Travel Annual Leave)	Additional paid leave available to international assignees for travel to their home country, calculated by flight duration.	Segment 3, Section 22.3	Company policy — not a statutory entitlement
MBA 1961	Maternity Benefit Act 1961 as amended by the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017, which extended paid maternity leave to 26 weeks.	Segment 2, Section 7	Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 and 2017 Amendment
Occupational Health (OH)	An independent medical service provider commissioned by the company to conduct fitness-for-work assessments and health surveillance.	Segment 3, Section 28.2	Not a statutory term — company practice aligned with
Phased Return	A temporary arrangement under which an employee returning from long-term absence works reduced hours for a defined period.	Segment 3, Section 29.4	Not specifically regulated — company policy
Provident Fund (PF)	The statutory retirement savings fund requiring employee and employer contributions of 12% of basic salary each.	Segment 2, Section 27.2	Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952
RPwD Act 2016	Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016 — mandates reasonable accommodation and non-discrimination in employment.	Segment 3, Section 24.1	Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016
Sabbatical	An approved period of extended unpaid leave available to employees with 7 years of service, for any legitimate purpose.	Segment 2, Section 14	Not a statutory concept — company policy
SE Act	Shops and Establishments Act — the applicable state-level employment legislation governing working hours, leave, and conditions.	The state-level employment legislation	Karnataka SE Act 1961; Telangana SE Act 1988
Self-Certification	The process by which an employee's own notification is accepted as sufficient evidence for short sickness absences.	Segment 1, Section 5.4	Not specifically defined in statute — company policy
TDS (Tax Deducted at Source)	Income tax deducted at source by the employer from salary payments, including Tax Deducted at Source on Perquisites.	Segment 4, Section 45	Income Tax Act, 1961, Section 192 and Rule 26A
TOIL	See Compensatory Off above.	Segment 2, Section 13	

Term	Definition	Policy Reference	Statutory Reference (if any)
Unauthorised Absence	Absence from work without notification, without approval, or in excess of the approved leave period	Section 4.1, Section 4.2	Not specifically defined in the Act; common law principle
Working Day	For leave calculation purposes: a standard weekday (Monday–Friday) excluding public holidays	Section 3.3	Employment Rights Act 1996 – used for statutory calculations

31.2 Master Cross-Reference Index — All Four Segments

The following index provides a single-entry point to every substantive topic in the Leave and Attendance Policy across all four segments. Topics are listed alphabetically. Where a topic appears in multiple segments, the primary reference is listed first.

Topic	Primary Reference	Additional References
Adoption Leave	Segment 2, Section 9	Segment 2, Section 20 (Leave Interaction Matrix); Segment 2, Append
Annual Leave — Accrual	Segment 1, Section 4.2	Segment 1, Section 4.8 (advance leave)
Annual Leave — Application and Approval	Segment 1, Section 4.3	Segment 2, Section 19.1 (HRMS workflow); Segment 3, Section 26.2
Annual Leave — Blackout Periods	Segment 1, Section 4.7	—
Annual Leave — Carry-Forward	Segment 1, Section 4.4	Segment 1, Section 4.5 (encashment of excess)
Annual Leave — Encashment	Segment 1, Section 4.5	Segment 1, Section 4.6 (separation); Segment 2, Appendix D (state co
Annual Leave — Entitlement by Band	Segment 1, Section 4.1	—
Annual Leave — Notice Period and Separation	Segment 1, Section 4.6	—
Attendance Recording — HRMS	Segment 1, Section 3.3	Segment 2, Section 19.1; Segment 3, Section 26.2
Bereavement Leave	Segment 2, Section 10	Segment 2, Section 20 (interaction matrix); Segment 2, Appendix A (F
Bradford Factor	Segment 1, Section 3.5	Segment 1, Section 5.6 (sick leave patterns); Segment 3, Section 26.3
Campus Hire Leave	Segment 3, Section 25.1	—
Caregiver Leave	Segment 2, Section 11	Segment 2, Section 20 (interaction matrix); Segment 2, Appendix A (F
Casual Leave — Application	Segment 1, Section 6.2	Segment 2, Section 19.1 (HRMS)
Casual Leave — Entitlement and Purpose	Segment 1, Section 6.1	—
Casual Leave — Restrictions	Segment 1, Section 6.3	Segment 1, Section 6.4 (interaction with sick leave)
DPDP Act 2023 — Leave and Health Data	Segment 1, Section 3.9	Segment 2, Section 16 (fertility treatment); Segment 3, Section 30 (sta
Disability and Reasonable Adjustment	Segment 3, Section 24	Code of Conduct Section 9.4
Encashment — See Annual Leave — Encashment		—
Fertility Treatment Leave	Segment 2, Section 16	Segment 2, Appendix A (Form HR-L09A); Segment 2, Section 20 (sce
Fixed-Term Contract Leave	Segment 3, Section 28.1	Segment 2, Section 19 (HRMS administration)
HRMS Leave Administration	Segment 2, Section 19	Segment 3, Sections 26.1–26.7 (full administration manual)
International Assignment Leave	Segment 3, Section 22	Segment 3, Section 29 (scenarios); Segment 3, Appendix H (HR-L22)
Leave Without Pay	Segment 2, Section 17	Segment 2, Section 20 (interaction matrix); Segment 2, Appendix A (F
Long-Term Absence Management	Segment 3, Section 23	Segment 3, Appendix G (HR-L20); Segment 3, Appendix H (HR-L21)
LHTAL (Long-Haul Travel Allowance Leave)	Segment 3, Section 22.3	Segment 3, Appendix H (HR-L22)
Manager Training — Leave	Section 27, this Segment	Segment 3, Appendix J
Maternity Leave	Segment 2, Section 7	Segment 2, Section 20 (interaction matrix); Segment 2, Appendix A (F
Occupational Health Referral	Segment 3, Section 23.2	Segment 3, Appendix G (HR-L20)
Overtime and TOIL Accrual	Segment 1, Section 3.8	Segment 2, Section 13; Segment 2, Section 19 (HRMS)
Part-Time Leave Calculations	Segment 1, Section 6.5	Segment 3, Section 25.3 (detailed calculation table)
Paternity Leave	Segment 2, Section 8	Segment 2, Section 20 (interaction matrix); Segment 2, Appendix A (F

Topic	Primary Reference	Additional References
Phased Return to Work	Segment 3, Section 23.4	Segment 1, Section 5.8 (return to work after sick leave)
Public Holidays	Segment 2, Section 18	Segment 2, Appendix D (state compliance table)
Redundancy — Leave Settlement	Segment 3, Section 24.4	Segment 1, Section 4.6 (separation encashment)
Return to Work after Sick Leave	Segment 1, Section 5.8	Segment 3, Section 23.4 (phased return); Segment 4, Section 27.3 (m
Sabbatical Leave	Segment 2, Section 14	Segment 2, Appendix A (Form HR-L07); Segment 3, Section 25.4 (car
Sick Leave — Certificate Requirements	Segment 1, Section 5.4	—
Sick Leave — Entitlement	Segment 1, Section 5.2	—
Sick Leave — Long-Term	Segment 1, Section 5.5	Segment 3, Section 23 (LTA management)
Sick Leave — Mental Health	Segment 1, Section 5.7	Code of Conduct Section 18.1
Sick Leave — Patterns	Segment 1, Section 5.6	Segment 1, Section 3.5 (Bradford Factor)
State Statutory Compliance	Segment 2, Appendix D	Segment 3, Section 30 (cross-reference); Segment 1, Section 2.4
Study Leave	Segment 2, Section 12	Segment 2, Appendix A (Form HR-L06)
Volunteer Leave	Segment 2, Section 15	Segment 2, Appendix A (Form HR-L08)
Working Hours — Standard and Hybrid	Segment 1, Section 3.1	Segment 1, Section 3.2 (core hours); Segment 1, Section 3.6 (state co

Appendix K: Manager Leave Management Training Assessment (HR-LAP-T01)

Complete this assessment through HRMS at the conclusion of the Manager Leave Management Training Programme core curriculum. A score of 80% or above is required for completion certification. Managers scoring below 80% receive targeted feedback and may reattempt after a minimum 5-day interval. Results are visible to the HRBP and the manager's own manager.

PAPER REFERENCE VERSION — For HRMS completion only (hrms.arjuntech.in → My Training → Leave Management Programme)

Q1. An employee informs you by WhatsApp at 8:45am that they are unwell and will not be in. You have not been able to speak to them directly. Under the policy, is this notification sufficient?

■ Yes — WhatsApp to the manager's known number constitutes direct communication and satisfies Section 3.4 of Segment 1.

■ No — only a phone call is acceptable.

■ Partially — it depends on whether you saw the message.

Q2. An employee's Bradford Factor score has crossed 200. What is the immediately required action?

■ Initiate a formal disciplinary procedure.

■ Conduct a formal welfare discussion with the HRBP present, explore underlying causes, consider an occupational health referral if a health condition is indicated.

■ Issue a written warning.

■ No action — the score is just an indicator.

Q3. An employee on maternity leave sends you an email asking if you have any updates on the project she was working on before her leave. Are you permitted to respond with project updates?

■ Only if she initiates the contact.

■ Yes, always — she asked.

■ Only at the level of general news — detailed work discussions must wait for return. The key principle is that she must never feel pressured to engage with work during maternity leave.

■ No — you must not respond at all during maternity leave.

Q4. A team member's father passes away and they request 5 days of bereavement leave. The relationship was estranged. Do you approve the 5 days?

■ Only 3 days — the full entitlement requires a close relationship.

■ Yes — bereavement leave for a parent is 5 working days with no qualification based on the quality of the relationship.

■ Refer to HRBP to investigate the relationship.

■ Request documentation of the death before approving.

Q5. An employee applies for 3 days of casual leave prefixed to a public holiday, creating a 4-day long weekend. This is the third time this year they have done this. What is the correct response?

■ Approve the leave — it is the employee's right.

■ Decline the casual leave and explain that casual leave cannot be used to bridge public holidays. Offer to approve annual leave for the period if applied with adequate notice.

■ Decline all casual leave applications for this employee going forward.

■ Refer to HRBP immediately for disciplinary action.

Q6. An employee tells you verbally that their fertility treatment details should be kept confidential. You need to record the leave in HRMS. What should be visible to other team members in the team calendar?

■ Fertility Treatment Leave — the policy requires transparency in the team calendar.

■ Sick Leave — as a proxy to protect confidentiality.

■ Approved Leave — the leave type must be masked for sensitive health leave in any team-visible view.

■ Personal Leave.

Q7. An employee's sick leave entitlement is exhausted on Day 12 of a continuous illness. They have 8 days of annual leave remaining. What is the correct next step?

■ Immediate LWOP — sick leave is exhausted.

■ Offer the annual leave bridge option first before moving to LWOP. The HRBP manages the transition.

■ Extend sick leave by 5 days at your discretion.

■ No further paid leave is available.

Q8. A team member returns from 10 days of sick leave. What are you required to do on their first day back?

■ Nothing — they are back, so the absence is resolved.

■ Conduct a return-to-work conversation and document it in HRMS within the same day. The conversation is welfare-focused: fitness to return, support needs, any adjustments.

■ Issue a formal attendance warning.

■ Request a doctor's clearance certificate.

Q9. How many days of TOIL may an employee hold at any one time, and within how many days must it be taken?

■ 10 days; 60 days.

■ 5 days; 30 days.

■ No maximum balance; must be taken before year end.

■ 3 days; 14 days.

Q10. An employee applies for 15 days of annual leave with 18 working days' notice. What is the minimum notice requirement for this duration and what are the approval authorities?

■ 20 working days' notice required; Line manager only.

■ 15 working days' notice required; Line manager + BU Head for Band 5+ employees.

■ 10 working days required; Line manager only.

■ 30 working days required; CEO approval for all employees.

Manager Full Name: _____ Employee ID: _____ Band: ___

Assessment Date: _____ HRMS Training Record Reference: _____

Result (to be completed by HRMS system): _____ / 10 correct | Pass ■ Fail ■

Appendix L: Employee Leave Literacy Assessment (HR-LAP-T02)

Complete this assessment through HRMS at the end of the Employee Leave Literacy Programme. A score of 70% or above is required for completion certification. Employees who do not pass on first attempt receive targeted module guidance and may reattempt immediately. Results are visible to the HRBP only.

Q1. How many days of annual leave are you entitled to per year as a Band 3 employee?

- ■ 12 days.
- ■ 18 days.
- ■ 21 days.
- ■ 24 days.

Q2. From which consecutive sick day is a medical certificate required?

- ■ Day 1 — always required.
- ■ Day 3.
- ■ Day 4 onwards.
- ■ Only for absences of 2 weeks or more.

Q3. You have a genuine personal emergency on a working day. Which leave type should you use?

- ■ Annual Leave.
- ■ Sick Leave.
- ■ Casual Leave.
- ■ Leave Without Pay.

Q4. Your casual leave balance reaches zero in August. You have another emergency in September. What leave type covers this?

- ■ You are not entitled to any further leave.
- ■ Sick Leave, to preserve annual leave.

■ Annual Leave.

■ LWOP automatically applies.

Q5. You want to submit a fertility treatment leave application. Who do you submit the form to?

■ Your line manager.

■ The HR Business Partner only — not the line manager.

■ Finance.

■ You do not need to notify anyone.

Q6. Can you carry forward unused casual leave to the next leave year?

■ Yes — up to 5 days.

■ Yes — up to 3 days.

■ No — casual leave lapses on 31 March each year.

■ Yes — the full balance.

Q7. Your manager declines your annual leave application verbally. What should they also provide?

■ Nothing — a decline is a decline.

■ A specific operational reason in HRMS and an offer of an alternative period within 60 days.

■ A written apology.

■ HRBP approval for the decline.

Q8. You want to take 6 days of annual leave. What is the minimum advance notice required?

■ 5 working days.

■ 10 working days.

■ 15 working days.

■ 20 working days.

Q9. You suspect your manager is treating your leave applications differently from your colleagues' because of your religion. What should you do?

■ Accept it — leave approvals are managerial discretion.

■ Raise the concern with the HRBP or through the anonymous Whistleblower hotline at ethics@arjuntech.in.

■ Take leave without applying.

■ Raise it at your annual appraisal.

Q10. You are on your annual leave when a close family member passes away. What happens to the annual leave days that overlap with the bereavement period?

■ They are lost — you were already on approved leave.

■ They convert to bereavement leave for the entitlement period, and the annual leave days are reinstated to your balance.

■ You must apply separately for bereavement leave after your annual leave ends.

■ The manager decides.

Full Name: _____ Employee ID: _____ Band: ___ Location: ___

Date: _____ HRMS Training Reference: _____

Result (HRMS system): _____ / 10 correct | Pass ■ Fail ■

Appendix M: Master Leave Entitlement Register — All Types, All Bands

This register is the single authoritative reference for all leave entitlements across all bands at Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd., effective 01 April 2024. Maintained by HRBP Operations. HRMS is configured to reflect these entitlements exactly. Any discrepancy between HRMS and this register must be reported to HRBP Operations for correction within 2 working days.

Leave Type	Band 1	Band 2	Band 3	Band 4	Band 5	Band 6	Band 7	Band 8	Carry-Fwd	Encashable	Lapses
Annual Leave	21d	21d	21d	21d	24d	24d	24d	24d min	10d (B1-4) 12d (B5+)	Yes — excess at separation	31 Mar; exceptions above
Sick Leave	12d	12d	12d	12d	12d	12d	12d	12d	None	No	31 Mar
Casual Leave	8d*	8d*	8d*	8d*	8d*	8d*	8d*	8d*	None	No	31 Mar
Maternity Leave	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	26/12/14wk	N/A	No	N/A — event driven
Paternity Leave	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	N/A — 90d window	No	90 days after birth/ad
Adoption Leave (Primary)	14/8wk	14/8wk	14/8wk	14/8wk	14/8wk	14/8wk	14/8wk	14/8wk	N/A	No	N/A — event driven
Bereavement Leave	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	5/3/2d	N/A	No	N/A — event driven
Caregiver Leave	5d	5d	5d	5d	5d	5d	5d	5d	None	No	31 Mar
Study Leave	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	10d	None	No	31 Mar
Compensatory Off (TOIL)	Per OT	Per OT	Per OT	Per OT	Per OT	Per OT	Per OT	Per OT	30-day rolling window	No (ex…	30 days after accrual
Sabbatical Leave	4–12wk (5+ yrs)	4–12wk	4–12wk	4–12wk	4–12wk	4–12wk	4–12wk	4–12wk	N/A	No	N/A
Volunteer Leave	2d	2d	2d	2d	2d	2d	2d	2d	None	No	31 Mar
Fertility Treatment Leave	5d/cycle (max 3 cycles = 15d)	Same	Same	Same	Same	Same	Same	Same	None	No	31 Mar
Leave Without Pay	Discretionary — max 60 working days per rolling 12 months								—	N/A	No	N/A
Public Holidays	3 national + state holidays (14–17 days per location)								—	—	N/A	No	N/A

** Karnataka employees receive 12 days casual leave per the Karnataka SE Act 1961 statutory minimum — the HRMS is configured accordingly for all Bengaluru HQ employees.*

Appendix N: Annual Leave Planning Template — Manager Version

Use this template at the start of each leave year (April) to map out your team's leave coverage across the year. Identify peak periods, minimum staffing requirements, and ensure all team members have a realistic opportunity to use their full annual leave entitlement. Review in July and again in November. Available as an editable Excel file on HRMS under HR Services → Leave Management → Team Planning Template.

Team Member	Band	AL Entitlement	Q1 (Apr–Jun) Planned Leave	Q2 (Jul–Sep) Planned Leave	Q3 (Oct–Dec) Planned Leave	Q4 (Jan–Mar) Planned Leave	Total Planned	Balance At 31 Mar	Carry-Fwd Risk?
1.									■ Yes ■ No
2.									■ Yes ■ No
3.									■ Yes ■ No
4.									■ Yes ■ No
5.									■ Yes ■ No
6.									■ Yes ■ No
7.									■ Yes ■ No
8.									■ Yes ■ No
9.									■ Yes ■ No
10.									■ Yes ■ No

Manager name: _____ Business Unit: _____ Leave Year: 01 April ___ to 31 March ___

Known blackout periods for this team this year: _____

Minimum staffing at any one time: _____ Notes on coverage arrangements: _____

Manager guidance: carry-forward risk arises where a team member is on track to hold more than 10 days (Band 1–4) or 12 days (Band 5+) of unused annual leave at 31 March. Proactively facilitate leave for at-risk team members before the end of Q3. Employees cannot forfeit entitlement due to operational constraints — it is the manager's responsibility to ensure the operational plan creates space for leave.

Appendix O: Complete Policy Acknowledgement and Four-Segment Summary

All employees acknowledge all four segments of the Arjun Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework through the HRMS annual SEC-101 Policy Refresher module. New joiners complete within 5 working days of their joining date. The acknowledgement confirms receipt and understanding of all provisions.

LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE POLICY ACKNOWLEDGEMENT — HR-LAP-001-v3.2 — ALL FOUR SEGMENTS

Full Legal Name (print clearly)	
Employee ID	
Job Title	
Band	
Office Location	
Employment Type	■ Permanent ■ Fixed-Term ■ Probation ■ Part-Time ■ Contractor (where applica
Date of Joining	
I confirm I have received, read, and understood all four segments of the Leave and Attendance Policy v3.2:	■ Segment 1 (Attendance, Annual Leave, Sick Leave, Casual Leave) ■ Segment 2 (Maternity, Paternity, Adoption, Bereavement, Study, Caregiver, TOIL, ■ Segment 3 (International, Long-Term Absence, Organisational Change, Workforce ■ Segment 4 (Manager Training, Scenarios, Policy Reference, Glossary, Appendi
Employee Signature	
Date	
Manager Name and Signature (confirms Day One completion for new joiners)	
Date	
HRBP Acknowledgement	
Date	
HRMS SEC-101 Completion Reference	

Complete Policy Summary — All Four Segments

Segment	Sections	Key Topics	Pages	Status
Segment 1	1–6 + Extended	VP-HR Message · Attendance Framework · Hybrid Model · Bradford Factor · Annual Leave · Sick Leave · Casual	1–40	Published April 202
Segment 2	7–21 + Appendices A–F	Maternity · Paternity · Adoption · Bereavement · Caregiver · Study · Compensatory Off · Sabbatical · Annual	41–80	Published April 202
Segment 3	22–26 + Appendices G–J	International / Expatriate Leave · Long-Term Absence Management · Occupational Health Policy · Return	81–120	Published April 202
Segment 4 — This Document	27–31 + Appendices K–O	Manager Training Programme · Employee Leave Literacy Programme · 36-Scenario Reference Bank · Glossary	121–168	Published April 202

Complete Leave and Attendance Policy and Procedures Framework — Document Reference: HR-LAP-001-v3.2. Owner: Ms. Priya Menon, Vice President — Human Resources. Legal Review: Mr. Sandeep Iyer, General Counsel. Approved: Mr. Rajesh Arjun, Chief Executive Officer. Effective: 01 April 2024. All four segments available on the HRMS portal under Policies and Documents. For queries: hr@arjuntech.in | For anonymous concerns: ethics@arjuntech.in (24/7, anonymous).